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Ashadha 21, 1941 (Saka)

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(English Version)

First Session

(Seventeenth Lok Sabha)

सत्यमेव जयते

(Vol. II Contains Nos. 11 to 20)

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LOK SABHA DEBATES

LOK SABHA

Friday, July 12, 2019, / Ashadha 21, 1941 (Saka)

The Lok Sabha met at Eleven of the Clock.

[HON. SPEAKER *in the Chair*]

[Translation]

HON. SPEAKER: Question Hour.

Q. No. 281. Dr. Mohammad Jawed.

… (Interruptions)

SHRI ADHIR RANJAN CHOWDHURY (BAHARAMPUR): Hon. Speaker, Sir, I had given the notice of adjournment motion. Dalits are being attacked once again in Gujarat and several other states… *(Interruptions)* Dalits are being killed in Gujarat… *(Interruptions)* Dalits in UP…. *(Interruptions)*

11.01 hrs

ORAL ANSWERS TO QUESTIONS

[Translation]

HON. SPEAKER: Mohammad Jawedji, Please ask you question.

… (Interruptions)

DR. MOHAMMAD JAWED: Thank you Hon. Speaker Sir. I would like to thank the hon. Minister also for giving a very detailed information. As per his information, there are about 9.25 lakh doctors, which come to about one doctor per 1456 persons. But, this figure is different in Bihar which is 3382 persons per doctor instead of one doctor per 1456 persons. It is a matter of concern that as per NHP and the report prepared by the CBHI in July 2018, which was presented by the then Health Minister, Naddaji, this ratio was one Government doctor for 11,000 persons. As far as Bihar is concerned, this ratio is one Government Doctor per 19,000 persons approximately. I belong to Kishanganj. There is only one Government doctor for 45,000 persons. This leads to many problems.

HON SPEAKER: Hon. Member, I request you to be brief so that maximum questions can be asked.

DR. MOHAMMAD JAWED: Hon. Speaker, Sir, I will put my question very briefly.

Sir, in India, about 65,000 doctors pass out each year, but only 1100 doctors pass out in Bihar. Recently, in Muzaffarpur and its adjoining areas, about 200 poor and dalit children died due to Chamki fever. This scenario is still prevailing. Just one or two days ago, six children died in Gaya. As I said about Kishanganj, the ratio of doctors needs to be increased.

HON. SPEAKER: Do not limit yourself to Kishanganj, talk about entire Bihar. The ratio of doctors will increase in the entire country and the states also.

DR. MOHAMMAD JAWED: Hon. Speaker, Sir, I am coming to this very point. The situation is very dismal in Bihar and especially in my Parliamentary Constituency. Land was also identified for setting up of AIIMS in Kishanganj.

Hon. Speaker, Sir, I would like to know from the Hon. Minister about the number of medical colleges likely to be set up in Bihar and Kishanganj and the time by which the Government proposes to set up these?

DR. HARSH VARDHAN: Hon. Speaker Sir, I appreciate the concern of the hon. Member. His figures are right. If we talk about allopathic doctors, there is roughly one allopathic doctor for 1,456 persons. But when we include the doctors working under AYUSH (Ayurveda, Homoeopathy and Unani) then there is one doctor per 867 persons. Thus, this figure improves.

There is no doubt what the hon. Member has said. As per the data available with us for entire Bihar, there are about 40,649 doctors, and out of those, 80 per cent doctors are available in the system. If we consider that

around eighty per cent doctors out of 40,649 are available then it comes to 32,519.

[English]

SHRI A. RAJA: Sir, please also club Question No. 285.

[Translation]

DR HARSH VARDHAN: As per 2011 census, the latest population of Bihar is 10.41 crore. So as per this data, there is one doctor per around 3201 persons in Bihar, which is certainly less than the national average.

You have asked about the Government's planning in this regard. I want to inform you that in the past five years, the plan was formulated to open 82 medical colleges by converting district hospitals in two phases - 58 and 24 medical colleges will be opened in the first phase and the second Phase respectively.

In Bihar, where the ratio of doctors is low, three out of the first 58 medical colleges, have been sanctioned for Bihar on priority basis, and out of 24 medical colleges in the second phase, five have been sanctioned for Bihar. It means that the Government has planned to sanction a total of eight medical colleges to Bihar.

The Union Government is providing full assistance to the state with regard to whatever necessary requirements are there such as the land availability and other requirements, which are being completed and the Union

Government is fully committed to help the state. Apart from this, we support the states through programme implementation, called PIP, and wherever and whenever demands are made by the state governments under National Health Mission for strengthening and whatever plans are submitted by the them, we extend our support in all those things and our support will continue in future too. If you forward any of your schemes to us through the state Government, we will examine all the things critically and objectively. The Government of India will cooperate to improve the situation in Bihar and in your constituency too but it is necessary that the entire initiative must be taken by the Bihar Government. There will be no discrepancy in any kind of support on our part.

DR. MOHAMMAD JAWED: The reply of the hon. Health Minister was very encouraging. He talked about opening eight Government medical colleges, but I would like to say that this number should increase. As I mentioned that the land was made available in Kishanganj for AIIMS.... *(Interruptions)* The present Government has launched comprehensive awareness programme regarding Ayushman Bharat which is a good initiative.

Hon. Speaker Sir, an amount of Rs 6400 crores has been allocated and per family rupees five lakh rupees is being given as grant. In this way, as many as 1.5-2 lakhs families are being covered. However, in view of the present infrastructure in India, especially in Kishanganj of Bihar, as it was mentioned by me to the Health Minister, this facility will not reach to the poorest of the poor. The Health Minister himself is a doctor. He has mentioned about the

figure of 40,000 doctors in Bihar. But I would like to tell about 35,000 doctors in service. Out of about 35,000 doctors in service, 15,000 are in Delhi and NCR. The actual figure of doctors available in Bihar would be 15,000-20,000 only. Therefore, in view of tha fact that there are no doctors at PMCs under Ayushman Bharat and it seems that the benefit would therefore will go to the insurance companies and the private doctors. This situation must be improved, because as the poor patients cannot go to cities, due to which the disease aggravates, I would like to know from the Hon Minister as to what is the specific scheme or proposal for their care?

DR. HARSH VARDHAN: The Hon. Member rightly said that 'Ayushman Bharat Yojana' was launched 8-9 months ago, and at that time, the list of people of several categories was prepared based on the 2011 census data and as per the socio economic status. These categories were covered under the 2011 census at that time and the number of people covered was 10.8 crores. This number is being taken under the first phase of 'Ayushman Bharat Yojana'. All types of facilities are being offered, such as the expense of rupees five lakh per family. For this, more than 16,000 private and government hospitals across the country have been registered. They are also being given e-card etc. After coming to power again, we have started working on it more seriouly and comprehensively again. A large number of people who are not included in the 2011 list, but really qualify to be included in any category, and are deprived from the social economic criteria, deserve to be included and should get such assistance from the government. For this, we are working very seriously to

realise the Hon. Prime Minister's vision of New India, 2022, under his leadership.

Hon. Speaker, Sir, in the coming days, we will expand this scheme to cover all the poor people of the country who are poor and deprived of all facilities and are not in a position to afford health facilities themselves and are excluded from the list based on 2011 census. Along with this, the second part envisages about the setting up 1.5 lakhs Health and Wellness Centers in the country and we are pursuing this very aggressively and proactively. At present, about 19,000 centres have been set up. Our target is to set up 1.5 lakhs centres by 2022. In such centers, not only the patients will get treatment, but the greater focus would be to promote promotive health, preventive health, positive health, especially regarding other communicable diseases, which are preventable through vaccine, and for it, we will try to provide vaccine to all children. But with regard to non-communicable diseases, through early diagnosis we can protect the people from a number of diseases or we can provide right treatment on right time. There are several types of cancers. Some days ago, I had mentioned about oral cancer in different context. We are working very seriously to make it a positive movement by setting up 1.5 lakhs centers. For this, we would like to involve the people of the society and the the non-governmental organizations. We are also appealing to the motivated doctors to adopt 2-5 Health and Wellness centers in their areas.

They should develop a positive movement for societal health in their areas. People should be educated on all aspects of health, so that they do not

fall ill. This is our very ambitious programme. We are working on it very seriously. You are already aware that 30-32 lakh persons have been benefited from Ayushman Bharat Yojana. Our aim is to provide assistance to each and every person in the country who needs some assistance.

HON. SPEAKER: Question No. 281 and 285 are of the same nature, so, I club them.

Shri Pinaki Misra.

[English]

SHRI PINAKI MISRA: Hon. Speaker Sir, thank you very much for having given me this opportunity. The difficulty with getting answers in the morning is that it is really very difficult to check the facts and figures. *[Translation]* It is very difficult. It contains so many facts and figures…*(Interruptions)*

HON. SPEAKER: I will direct the secretariat to look into it.

SHRI PINAKI MISRA: Kindly get it checked. ... *(Interruptions)*

HON. SPEAKER: Hon. Members, I will direct the secretariat to look into your issue, so that the proper reply can be obtained.

SHRI PINAKI MISRA: The reply must be made available at least a day before. Take the case of Odisha. Hon. Speaker Sir, I would like to tell about the actual problem. The actual problem is related to what is the central share and the total central share released. The hon. Minister is showing everywhere that the Union Government has released the total central share. I cannot believe that the Union government has become so much efficient, that *(English)* there is 100 per cent release on every issue. So we have to check those facts and

figures. I am only requesting the Hon. Minister that you can responsibly *(Translation)* say whether the 100 per cent amount shown as released, has really been released?

[English]

DR. HARSH VARDHAN: I think whatever we have conveyed to you, is on record. *[Translation]* I want to say that theoretically or going by the record of the previous Governments, it may not seem possible to you. But under Modiji Government, all this is possible.

SHRI PINAKI MISRA: Perhaps, I knew this would be your reply. My second supplementory is that you have left one column blank. Nothing has been given to Jajpur. Can you explain why this has happened regarding Jajpur? If you know, you can tell me. Otherwise, you can inform me later in writing.

,

DR. HARSH VARDHAN: I am aware of it. For setting up each medical college, the Government has to look into the availability of land etc. Regarding this particular medical college, the state government had to complete basic formalities regarding the particular medical College. The Odisha government delayed it inordinately. Moreover, I can share the latest information with you that the necessary information which was to be sent by the state government was sent two- three days ago of the last week. This has also been approved in the meeting held yesterday. Hence, the funds will be transferred under the blank column to which you are refering.

[English]

SHRI MAGUNTA SREENIVASULU REDDY: Hon. Speaker, Sir, thank you very much.

As per the standards of World Health Organisation, doctor to patient ratio is 1:1000, whereas, in our country, it is 1:1681. There is a shortage of medical colleges. You are also very well aware that the Ministry has organised NEET examination. Last year, around twelve lakh students were registered for this exam and out of the same, only seven lakh students could qualify. This year also, around fifteen lakh students were registered for this exam, but out of the same, only eight lakh students qualified the exam. There are only 60,000 seats in our country. Hon. Speaker, Sir, it is a good Session. In your constituency also, it will be useful. The Government of India and the Health Ministry have stated that each State will have one medical college sponsored by the Central Government, whereas in Andhra Pradesh, for the past three years, there is no Government medical college sanctioned so far.

Through you, I would like to request the hon. Minister of Health and Family Welfare to open medical colleges in rural areas, like Markapuram, which comes in my parliamentary constituency, so that the rural people will also be benefitted from medical healthcare.

DR. HARSH VARDHAN: Sir, the hon. Member has asked two questions. One is about the available seats for the children who have got selected in NEET. I think on the other day also when there was a discussion on Medical Council of

India here, I had informed this House that after we had the Board of Governors superseding the previous dispensation in MCI, in the last couple of months itself, we have been able to increase over 15000 MBBS seats. So, right now from that 60000, the number of seats available for those who qualify NEET is 75000. This is a record of all times. It has never happened in the history of Medical Council of India or in the history of medical education in this country.

Regarding the other issue that you wanted something in your own district, as I had informed earlier, the Government, in fact, came out with the proposal of having 82 new medical colleges, which will be converted from the district hospitals. There was a set criterion for choosing those places like the districts which did not have a medical college or those districts where there was a district hospital with say 200 beds etc.

Now in the future planning, as we have promised in our Party's manifesto also, we will come out with a plan to add another 75 colleges in the coming years. Preferably, when we deliver a new India to all Indians by 2022, in that new plan, we have added in our criteria a preference to the aspirational districts and also that will be in a challenge mode. Any district in the country where there is no medical college facility, there is no medical college and of course, if there is a district hospital with 200 beds and preferably if it falls within the aspirational districts which the Prime Minister has very passionately pursued in the last 4-5 years, we have provided to give all possible services to everyone there with a very motivated and highly energetic campaign. Our

ambitious plan is that in every district of the country, there should be something happening for strengthening the medical education component. It could be even a DNB course in a private hospital. It could be a medical college or an upgradation of district hospital or it could be an AIIMS or anything. But we want that medical education component should be strengthened in every district.

So, I would suggest that for your own district, you have to pursue the matter through your State Government. You see whether you fall into that domain of parameters and then I can promise you that we will take it up very passionately.

[Translation]

SHRI RAJIV RANJAN SINGH 'LALAN': Hon. Speaker, Sir, there is a Darbhanga Medical College and Hospital in Bihar, which is very old. I think that this is several decade old hospital. Dr. Sanjay Jaiswal had also raised the question in this regard. The State Government has sent a proposal to the Union government to convert Darbhanga Medical College and Hospital into All India Institute of Medical Sciences. It also has hundred acres of land available. I, through you, would like to know from the Central Government that the time by when the Centre is likely to take decision on the proposal of the State Government to covert Darbhanga Medical College into AIIMS , so that medical facilities are available to the people of Bihar also.

DR. HARSH VARDHAN: Hon. Speaker, Sir, after the formation of the new government and after being given the responsibility of the department to me, this matter has come to my notice that the state government of Bihar wants to convert the Darbhanga Medical College into AIIMS. The department is trying to complete the technical feasibility studies etc. in this regard. There are some heritage structures etc. connected with that medical college. Apart from this, that area is a bit low lying and due to certain technical issues there is some difficulty in giving the approval to the proposal at once. *[English]* but we are genuinely assessing the whole thing very objectively. As soon as proper decision is taken, we will convey it to the state government. *[Translation]*

SHRI ARVIND KUMAR SHARMA: Hon. Speaker, Sir, there are two aspects to it. On the one hand the Government is increasing the PG seats but this is increasing inadequately compared to the UG seats. I would like to draw the attention of the Minister towards it and request that the PG seats may be increased further. The second aspect is related to the admission to MBBS courses done through NEET. The government colleges follow the merit system. But the private colleges do not follow the merit system at all after the one or two rounds of counseling. Admission is given on first come first serve basis to those who gave a hefty donation or fee. They follow only this criteria. Through you, I would like to know as to how it is going to help in realising the dream of the Prime Minister to give admission to candidates of weaker sections in medical colleges. Through you, I would like to know whether the ten

per cent reservation which has been implemented, would be implemented in the private medical colleges also. Hon. Speaker, Sir, it is a very important issue. The students belonging to the poor families do not get admission anywhere. Will the Minister take action in this regard or will he find a way out for the candidates of the poor families?

DR. HARSH VARDHAN: Hon. Speaker Sir, the hon. Member has asked two questions. The first is regarding PG seats. Regarding this, I have to say that the number of PG seats increased during the past 8-9 months is perhaps unprecedented in the history of the country. Secondly, our government has taken some policy decisions regarding increasing PG seats, which have been conveyed by the Board of Governors. Since the government intends that the number of UG seats too should be increased. PG doctors are inadequate in the country in comparison. Earlier, one PG student was attached to a professor or the Head of the Department. Particularly in all subjects instead of one, two and in clinical subjects three PG students have been attached to each professor. This is compulsory for each medical college. Earlier, the colleges were up to the Graduation level. It was not necessary that such colleges would offer PG courses also. But now it is compulsory for each college that ultimately after three years, they have to apply for offering PG education. Also, as I just now mentioned, we have also improved the status of DNB etc. courses. DNB courses have been brought at par with MD, MS and other courses. If someone has done DNB in a hospital having a capacity of more than 500 beds, it is at

par straight away. Otherwise, he/she becomes at par with MS/MD after completing one more year of residency. This is regarding PG courses.

The second issue is regarding economically backward. The decision regarding this was taken by the Prime Minister in the Cabinet. It was not informed here. But efforts are being made to implement it in all sectors. I am happy to inform you that this year only, around 4800 seats have been provided for economically backward students for MBBS through NEET.

[English]

Whatever we have promised and whatever we have taken as a decision, we are implementing it in letter and spirit and the Board of Governors of the Medical Council of India are all supporting it. It is being implemented. *[Translation]*

HON. SPEAKER: Shri Ganesh Singh. Be very brief. My effort is that maximum questions may be asked, so that all Members get all information regarding all departments in the country. Do you agree or not?

SHRI GANESH SINGH: I will be brief.

Hon. Speaker, Sir, I want to congratulate you for new records being set by this House under your able leadership. Yesterday, you conducted the House till twelve midnight and you yourself were present. It is a big thing. Many many congratulations to you for the same.

Hon. Speaker, Sir, through you, I would like to ask the hon Minister that under the centrally sponsored scheme for setting up new medical colleges, Madhya Pradesh was sanctioned seven medical colleges in first phase, and in the second phase, the medical college was sanctioned for my Lok Sabha Constituency,Satna.

The State, through the district administration has made land available. Tenders have been issued, but work is yet to begin. Would the government inquire about the amount released to the State? Can classes be started for the sanctioned medical college, until the buildings are constructed? We can make building available there. The 400 bed hospital too can be made functional. I would like to know this from the Hon. Minister.

DR. HARSH VARDHAN: Hon. Speaker, Sir, I feel that perhaps it is not feasible practically to conduct classes without buildings. For the proposed medical college at Satna to which the hon. Member was refering to, the Government of India has already given Rs. 93.43 crores to the state government in this regard. Regarding his concern about starting the classes there at the earliest, after studying the actual ground situation, and assessing whether it is practically feasible or not, I will push for it if there is any possibility.

(Q. No. 282)

HON. SPEAKER: Sakshi Maharaj ji- not present.

Shri Bhola Singh.

[Translation]

SHRI BHOLA SINGH: Hon. Speaker, Sir, you gave me an opportunity to seek information on the research being done on the diagnosis of diseases such as cancer. Hon. Speaker, Sir, the disease is growing day by day. In my Parliamentary Constituency, among the patients referred to AIIMS, who come to us, out of ten such patients, about seven have cancer. I thank the Hon. Minister for the very detailed reply, which shows how much the Hon. Minister is concerned about cancer patients, and the extensive research being done by the government for their treatment. I want to thank the Minister. Through you, I would like to ask a small question as whether the National Institute of Science, Technology and Development Studies, a body working under the Council for Scientific and Industrial Research(CSIR) has any future plans for research to investigate the damage to normal cells of the body during the course of cancer treatment?

DR. HARSH VARDHAN: Hon. Speaker, Sir, in my view the reply given to the Hon. Member covers this. The comprehensive reply has been given. I would like to inform that not only any one particular institute, but in several institutes, including at least in seven laboratories of CSIR, research on cancer is being done. In our bio-technology department, a lot of research in this regard is being undertaken. ICMR is doing a number of research in this field. A lot of research is being undertaken in Tata and other hospitals through the Department of

Atomic Energy. Specially the Bio-Technology Department is a major founding member of International Consortium of Cancer Genome. And in association with the most prestigious Cancer Institute of Kolkatta, the Consortium has entrusted India with a leading role in a way in many subjects of reserach especially research on oral cancer. Advanced research is being undertaken especially in oral cancer, breast cancer and also cervical cancer to arrive at early diagnosis, and to find out the genes responsible for mutation. Can we really find out early cancer symptoms through mass survey of population? Research is being undertaken in labs to develop cancer vaccine, discovery of new tracks regarding cancer. Work is being done in the labs to discover medicines for cancer which are used in cure of other diseases. More important than all this is that our AYUSH Department is performing crucial research in this regard, in which serious research is being under Ayurveda, Homeopathy and Unani systems of medicine.

In this regard, I have to say that the ICMR has indicated a linkage between cervical cancer and human papillomavirus etc. When vaccine is given as a prophylaxis to a girl child, it leads to a lot of decrease in such incidents. We know that cancer is a very dreadful disease, causing a lot of pain. A family with a cancer patient suffers economic hardships, as well as mental hardships. For research in this regard, the Government of India is doing the best possible. We are in active collaboration with 44 nations in science and technology as per the needs, covering cancer, drug discovery and other fields. I feel that India is

doing adequate efforts in this regard. We are committed to undertake the required research in future too.

HON. SPEAKER: It is a very serious issue. We will certainly have a detailed discussion on this subject of cancer in the next session. It is a matter of concern for the whole country.

Adhir Ranjan ji, please be brief, and the Hon. Minister too should reply briefly, as a detailed discussion will take place in the next session on cancer and its remedies.

[English]

SHRI ADHIR RANJAN CHOWDHURY: Sir, actually, I appreciate the Minister that he has given an elaborate response. However, this kind of response is inscrutable in terms of its medical jargon. We are not aware of this kind of medical jargon, let alone the common people of our country. However, you have given an elaborate answer on this issue. I must appreciate that.

Sir, the thing is that cancer in India has already assumed the proportion of an epidemic. We do not know how many people of our country have been infected by cancer. Already, 100 different types of cancer are reported. Out of that, you have just referred to five most occurring cancers in our country. India contributes to 7.8 per cent of global cancer burden and 8.33 per cent of global deaths due to cancer. *[Translation]* More than half of the cancer patients in our

country die. And this happens because they do not have the information. This is due to ignorance.

The question I want to ask you is about the number of the cancer patients registered in India, how many cancer patients get admitted, and what is their survival rate? There is an adage in English – "A stitch in time saves nine." If cancer is diagnosed early, we can save a number of cancer patients. Kindly furnish information in this regard.

[English]

DR. HARSH VARDHAN: I feel so surprised and sorry to know that the Leader from the Opposition Party, I think, wants me to talk about all the 100 cancers. …(*Interruptions*)

[Translation]

SHRI ADHIR RANJAN CHOWDHURY: I did not say so….*(Interruption)*

[English]

DR. HARSH VARDHAN: I have just given a sense of the idea and have spoken about the three most common occurring cancers in the country. If you want, I can talk in detail about every cancer but this is, I think, not the place to talk in detail about it. The question was related to research about cancer. As far as the data is concerned, there is perfect data for every cancer patient who is reported, all over the country. The strategies are accordingly planned. You know that there is a big institution coming up in Jhajjar which was planned by

our Government, and then in the last five years itself, we created that. There is a lot of international collaboration within and outside the country. I think, we are doing our best.

As I mentioned in reply to the earlier question, at all these 1.5 lakh health and wellness centres, our focus is more about ensuring that we are strengthening the preventive aspects. We are able to diagnose every disease at an early stage, and we do not allow it to become Stage-III and Stage-IV and become a big burden for the family as well as the patient.

So, the whole focus of the health policy under the Ayushman is on preventive and promotive aspects apart from providing treatment when unfortunately somebody falls ill. There also, in some of the 31 components, early diagnosis of cancer is a very, very important component. I was very happy that the hon. Speaker has proposed a discussion on cancer and I will be happy to answer anything related to cancer or about any particular cancer in this House to the hon. Members.

[Translation]

DR. SANJAY JAISWAL: Hon. Speaker, Sir, my question is simple. The hon. Minister made a very detailed reply. Harsh Vardhanji is holding the portfolio of the Ministry of Science and Technology as well as the Ministry of Health and Family Welfare. As we have disruptive technology, such as gomma knife, which is not available is any RCT centre. Target Cell Delivery Therapy is also not available in any Regional Cancer Centres. So, I would like to know from

the hon. Minister as to by when these new technologies will be made available in various Regional Cancer Centers in the country?

DR. HARSH VARDHAN: Sir, we are working on various regional and state cancer centers and it is a very ambitious plan *[English]* and obviously, when a centre is exclusively dedicated to the treatment of a particular cancer, all these disruptive technologies and modern technologies and the equipment related to that are supposed to be there. They are available at many places, but ultimately, we promise that they will be available to everybody. There are a lot of new things. My people are informing. But I do not want to confuse this House with all those things. But I promise that whatever is required for the best possible treatment of cancer more particularly in a cancer centre, whether it is a regional or a State cancer centre, we will provide all possible help.

[Translation]

HON. SPEAKER: Question No. 283

Shrimati Aparajita Sarangi.

SHRIMATI APARAJITA SARANGI: Hon. Speaker, Sir, through this question, I want to raise a very important issue- Artificial Intelligence.

Hon. Speaker, Sir, Artificial Intelligence is being used in a lot of work in USA, UK, Sweden and China. It is being widely publicised. If we want to make our public health system efficient, we need to adopt Artificial Intelligence in a big way in our country.

Hon. Speaker, Sir, through you, I want to know from the Hon. Minister regarding the work being done in our country in this field, and the types of challenges we can face if we promote it and make use of it?

Hon. Speaker, Sir, if other countries can adopt it, how can it be adopted in India? We have make our public health system very efficient and Artificial Intelligence is one way. I would like to know in this regard.

DR. HARSH VARDHAN: Hon. Speaker, Sir, I have given a detailed reply to the question raised by the hon. Member. The following are the potential fields in public helath on which we are working *[English]* they are Tele-radiology; Tele-ophthalmology; Clinical Decision Support System; Natural Language Processing for health data; disease surveillance; Tele-medicine, early detection of diseases; health data analytics, remote monitoring through

wearables, particularly for elderly care/special cases; research in bio-technology; and under Ayushman Bharat, reducing fraud and abuse in Pradhan Mantri Jan Arogya Yojana ecosystem viz., fraud and abuse by empanelled hospitals, insurance agencies, third party administrators etc.; preserving privacy of personal information of PM-JAY beneficiaries; to address the gaps in Artificial Intelligence ecosystem and realize its economic impact, Government of India has prioritized building our Artificial Intelligence technology capabilities.

Hon. Speaker, Sir, in certain fields, the initative has been taken and already significant work has been done such as - Imaging Bio-bank for Cancer with NITI Aayog, we aim to a build database of cancer related radiology and pathology images of more than 20,000 profiles of cancer patients with focus on major cancers prevalent in India, as I just now mentioned, along with the associated annotations and labels from clinical data for effective use of Artificial Intelligence in cancer management. Also, NITI Aayog is working on using Artificial Intelligence for early diagnosis of diabetic retinopathy and we are trying to integrate Artificial Intelligence capabilities with portable eye screening device using retinal imagining and APIs enables operators to get Artificial Intelligence powered insights even when they are working at eye check-up camps in remote areas. That is even in rural areas, early diagnosis of diseases can be done through artificial intelligence data by connecting the patients remotely. We get an intermittent connectivity to the cloud to detect diabetic retinopathy in a patient which is at a far away place in a rural village.

Similarly, our Department of Biotechnology has issued a call for pre-proposals on use of Artificial Intelligence in the area of cancer biology, tuberculosis and pulmonary diseases..

[Translation]

HON. SPEAKER: Hon. Minister, the hon. Member has read the full answer.

[English]

DR. HARSH VARDHAN: But again she wanted that to be repeated here. She asked the same question which she had already asked. *[Translation]* Sir, in this regard, I have to add 2-3 more points. In 2018, the NITI Aayog had carried an in-depth study in this regard on the basis of the directions of the Hon. Finance Minister given here one year ago. Niti Aayog in 2018 gave directions for extensive use of Artificial Intelligence in the country and also asked work to be undertaken in this regard. Four-five priority areas were fixed in this regard. *[English]* Health is one of them. Education is also one of them. Mobility is also one of them. *[Translation]* In the transport field, the congestion on roads etc. are included, and special focus has been given on such four-five fields. At present, regarding the field of health, I only want to say that we have immense data. If we are unable to process the data and feed in the Artificial Intelligence machine in a coordinated and integrated manner, it can lead to mistakes at times, which can cause a loss in the field of public health. There is a lot of sensitisation needed at present in this regard. Our Prime Minister, as you know, is very passionate about digital things. For the development of the

country, to solve the people's problems, be it public health or education extensive use of Artificial Intelligence is needed to strengthen all sectors. I have gone into details regarding the future plans as well as the difficulties in this regard. *[English]* I can assure that in Artificial Intelligence, we are going to be one of the important nations in times to come and we will use Artificial Intelligence in a big way to see that most of the unresolved issues of this country are helped and solved through the domain of Artificial Intelligence.

SHRIMATI APARAJITA SARANGI: The answer is very comprehensive and I thank hon. Minister for that. But the point is that our pace is very slow. There should be widespread awareness and we should compete with the best of the countries. US, UK and Sweden, as I mentioned, are doing great work as far as usage of Artificial Intelligence is concerned. So, I was just wondering whether we were facing many challenges. *[Translation]* Sir, my simple question is that the way it is propagated and used in other countries, why is it not being done in our country?

[English]

DR. HARSH VARDHAN: It may appear that our pace is slow, but I think we are moving ahead very systematically in a very, very, I would say, meticulous manner. We are taking care of everything, which we can apprehend as troubles. As I mentioned, if you do not use the data properly, you can be misguided by the data and by that misinterpretation, you can probably land

yourself into trouble and you can put the public health system of the country or any other particular system in jeopardy.

Maybe, we may not be using it to the extent to which USA or UK may be using, but I can tell you that our working in this field is comparable to any good nation of the whole world. In the times to come, you will find that this will be a big movement in the country.

You have asked this Question here, and I am really grateful to you because through your Question, we are spreading awareness about artificial intelligence and we are making people realise that this is one of the important domains that has to be considered. Even NITI Aayog, as you know, has come out with a national strategy. I talked about their Paper; and there is a lot more of details that are being worked out in the Government system. This is not the place where I can talk about all that, in detail. I have mentioned some of them in my answer, and if the hon. Member wants any specific information, we can provide that to her.

[Translation]

HON. SPEAKER: Q. No. 234

Shri P. P. Chaudhary.

[English]

SHRI P. P. CHAUDHARY: Sir, we know the importance of parameters of pathological investigations because they play a pivotal role for prescribing the medicines and providing the treatment by doctors.*[Translation]* Now the question is from where the parameters which have been fixed have originated? The hon. Minister in his reply has stated that these parameters are based on medical text books and reference books. When we look into it extensively as to from where the parameters have originated , we learn that these parameters in medical text books and reference books, as well as most of the parameters in diagnostic tests are those of the American Professional Associations and Professional Society. These are their parameters. As far as their accountability is concerned, it is a different issue. The Minister in his reply has said that views of these societies about parameters are different and a debate is going on in this regard as someone is saying that this should be the parameter and someone else is saying that should be the parameter. You said that if the procedure of lab differs, different parameters will show in pathological test, and it will vary. Different machines will yield different parameters. Same is with instruments. Doctors prescribe medicines on the basis of these pathological parameters. The entire medical service depends on these parameters.

Hon. Speaker, Sir, for example, take the case of Vitamin D. Our country is considered deficient in Vitamin D. Our farm workers work in broad sunlight.

Those working in villages, the hawkers and labourers in cities who work under sufficient sunlight are also said to be deficient in Vitamin D. Take the case of dairies; they fortify the milk with Vitamin D. You are a doctor, and you know that this will result in stones in the stomach in those who do not need Vitamin D.It will also cause other ailments.

Regarding Vitamin D, the Institutes of Medicine says that if it is below 12 mg then it is considered deficient. On the other hand, one American Society says that if it is below 20, there will be deficiency.

HON. SPEAKER: Hon. learned Member, will you yourself give the reply or allow the Hon. Minister to reply.

SHRI P.P. CHAUDHARY: My submission is that based on these parameters, medicines are being given to those who do not need it. This field is unoccupied and being unoccupied, there is no legislation. The second point is that we should have our own indigenous institute to review the parameters - whether issued by WHO, American Association or Society. After reviewing those parameters, the doctors should have single parameter for our continent. Else, different parameters will be followed. Some say such parameters indicate a disease, others disagree. My question to the Minister is that whether any exhaustive legislation will be brought? Will any legislation be brought for Institute of Excellence and to establish parameters for its research?Thank you very much.

DR. HARSH VARDHAN: I want to inform the Hon. Member that the basic parameters established are based on the consensus at the international level among the national and international professional bodies, where working professionals have a scientific approach and these parametres have been established on basis of it. These are not set arbitrarily by someone. In this regard, the upper limit and lower limit values undergo changes in the context of the country, for which studies are conducted in the country.

There are several ways to conduct pathology tests. There is one simple primitive method which I may have studied 40 years ago. With modern techniques led to the development of modern equipment, modern mechanisms, there is minor difference in parameters, and everything is well defined. The treatment by doctor is not based on whether it is 12 or 14.

As far as parameters are concerned, I have to say that no patient should be worried. There is neither honky-ponky nor any major confusion at doctors' level, which may result in wrong diagnosis of the patient or his wrong treatment. They should rest assured in this regard. There is no need to frame a law in this regard. As I said that minor variations may be there due to different conditions. We have a Clinical Establishment Act, formulated by the Government and is followed by some states, and some states do not follow it. The Government is of the view that it should be followed by all. This Act has prescribed treatment schedule for more than 200 diseases. It also prescribes the ideal treatment by doctors based on parameters meant for the patient and

the doctor. There should be no confusion broadly even for any lay man regarding these parameters. This is all broadly scientific. The difference within this can be explained through logical scientific reasoning.

SHRI P. P. CHAUDHARY: Sir, the reply given by you mentions complaints against several pharmaceutical companies. You have mentioned that complaints are sent to their association. Lastly it mentions that the Managing Director or the CEO of the pharma company is ultimately responsible for ensuring the adherence of the code. This is conflict of interest. A pharma company against which there is a complaint is responsible. This is my view as this also is one such unoccupied field where the regulatory measures in this regard should lie with the government. What will a pharma company itself take a decision on a complaint made against it? *[English]* They cannot be a judge of their cause. There must be some statutory authority and legislation in this field also.

[Translation]

DR. HARSH VARDHAN: In this regard, I would like to submit that the Department of Pharmaceuticals regulates the ethics followed by the pharmaceutical companies. They have formulated an universal code and sent it to the pharmaceutical companies. In the beginning, it was said that this code of ethics be followed voluntarily. Later it is felt that if the pharmaceutical companies do not follow the code of ethics voluntarily and earnestly, can we move forward towards framing statutory laws. Delibratians are going on in the

concerned Departments. The companies should follow the universal code voluntarily. A large number of companies follow the code scrupulously. They also develop state of the art systems. Hence, it may not be correct to say in general that code is not followed by any company.

12.00hrs.

The complaints received in this regard are sent to the concerned Associations of the related pharmaceutical companies. They take action as per their system.

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*WRITTEN ANSWERS TO QUESTIONS

Starred Question Nos. 286 to 300

Unstarred Question Nos. 3182 to 3411

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*Available in the Master copy of Original Version Of Debates plced in Librabry

[Translation]

HON. SPEAKER: I have received notices for adjournment motions on several issues from some Members. Although these matters are important there is no need to interrupt today's proceedings for them. These matters can be taken up at other occasions. Therefore, I have not allowed any notice of adjournment motion.

12.02 hrs

PAPERS LAID ON THE TABLE

HON. SPEAKER: Now, the papers will be laid on the table of the House: Shri Narendra Singh Tomar.

THE MINISTER OF AGRICULTURE AND FARMERS WELFARE; MINISTER OF RURAL DEVELOPMENT AND MINISTER OF PANCHAYATI RAJ (SHRI NARENDRA SINGH TOMAR): Hon. Speaker, Sir, I beg to lay on the Table a copy of the Detailed Demands for Grants (Hindi and English versions) of the Ministry of Agriculture and Farmers Welfare for the year 2019-2020.

[Placed in library, See No LT230/17/19]

THE MINISTER OF SOCIAL JUSTICE AND EMPOWERMENT (SHRI THAAWAR CHAND GEHLOT): Hon'ble Speaker Sir, I beg to lay on the Table

a copy of the Detailed Demands for Grants (Hindi and English versions) of the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment for the year 2019-2020.

[Placed in Library, See No. LT231/17/19]

[English]

THE MINISTER OF WOMEN AND CHILD DEVELOPMENT AND MINISTER OF TEXTILES (SHRIMATI SMRITI ZUBIN IRANI): Sir, I beg to lay on the Table:-

(1) A copy of the Memorandum of Understanding (Hindi and English versions) between the Cotton Corporation of India Limited and the Ministry of Textiles for the year 2019-2020.

[Placed in Library, See No. LT 232/17/19]

(2) (i) A copy of the Annual Report (Hindi and English versions) of the National Jute Board, Kolkata, for the year 2017-2018, along with Audited Accounts.

(ii) A copy of the Review (Hindi and English versions) by the Government of the working of the National Jute Board, Kolkata, for the year 2017-2018.

(3) Statement (Hindi and English versions) showing reasons for delay in laying the papers mentioned at (2) above.

[Placed in Library, See No. LT 233/17/19]

(4) (i) A copy of the Annual Report (Hindi and English versions) of the Central Silk Board, Bengaluru, for the year 2017-2018.

(ii) A copy of the Annual Accounts (Hindi and English versions) of the Central Silk Board, Bengaluru, for the year 2017-2018, together with Audit Report thereon.

(iii) A copy of the Review (Hindi and English versions) by the Government of the working of the Central Silk Board, Bengaluru, for the year 2017-2018.

(5) Statement (Hindi and English versions) showing reasons for delay in laying the papers mentioned at (4) above.

[Placed in Library, See No. LT 234/17/19]

(6) A copy each of the following papers (Hindi and English versions):-

(1) Detailed Demands for Grants of the Ministry of Women and Child Development for the year 2019-2020.

[Placed in Library, See No. LT 235/17/19]

(2) Detailed Demands for Grants of the Ministry of Textiles for the year 2019-2020.

[Placed in Library, See No. LT 236/17/19]

THE MINISTER OF HEALTH AND FAMILY WELFARE, MINISTER OF SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY AND MINISTER OF EARTH SCIENCES (DR. HARSH VARDHAN): Sir, I beg to lay on the Table:-

(1) A copy of the Detailed Demands for Grants (Hindi and English versions) of the Ministry of Earth Sciences for the year 2019-2020.

[Placed in Library, See No. LT 237/17/19]

(2) A copy of the Technology Development Board (Terms and Conditions of service of the Secretary and Employees) Amendment Regulations, 2018 (Hindi and English versions) published in Notification No. F. No.

TDB/64/2017/RR/Admin. in Gazette of India dated 18th July, 2018 under Section 23 of the Technology Development Board Act, 1995.

(3) Statement (Hindi and English versions) showing reasons for delay in laying the papers mentioned at (2) above.

[Placed in Library, See No. LT 238/17/19]

THE MINISTER OF ENVIRONMENT, FOREST AND CLIMATE CHANGE AND MINISTER OF INFORMATION AND BROADCASTING (SHRI PRAKASH JAVADEKAR): Sir, I beg to lay on the Table:-

(1) A copy of the Detailed Demands for Grants (Hindi and English versions) of the Ministry of Information and Broadcasting for the year 2019-2020.

[Placed in Library, See No. LT 239/17/19]

(2) A copy each of the following papers (Hindi and English versions) under sub-section (1) of Section 394 of the Companies Act, 2013:-

(i) Review by the Government of the working of the Broadcast Engineering Consultants India Limited, Noida, for the year 2017-2018.

(ii) Annual Report of the Broadcast Engineering Consultants India Limited, Noida, for the year 2017-2018, alongwith Audited Accounts and comments of the Comptroller and Auditor General thereon.

(3) Statement (Hindi and English versions) showing reasons for delay in laying the papers mentioned at (2) above.

[Placed in Library, See No. LT 240/17/19]

THE MINISTER OF STATE OF THE MINISTRY OF AYURVEDA, YOGA AND NATUROPATHY, UNANI, SIDDHA AND HOMOEOPATHY (AYUSH) AND MINISTER OF STATE IN THE MINISTRY OF DEFENCE (SHRI SHRIPAD YESSO NAIK): Sir, I beg to lay on the Table:-

(1) (i) A copy of the Annual Report (Hindi and English versions) of the North Eastern Institute of Ayurveda and Homoeopathy, Shillong, for the years 2012-2013 to 2015-2016, alongwith Audited Accounts.

(ii) A copy of the Review (Hindi and English versions) by the Government of the working of the North East Centre for Technology Application and Reach, Shillong, for the years 2012-2013 to 2015-2016.

(2) Statement (Hindi and English versions) showing reasons for delay in laying the papers mentioned at (1) above.

[Placed in Library, See No. LT 241/17/19]

(3) A copy of the Detailed Demands for Grants (Hindi and English versions) of the Ministry of AYUSH for the year 2019-2020.

[Placed in Library, See No. LT 242/17/19]

THE MINISTER OF STATE OF THE MINISTRY OF POWER, MINISTER OF STATE OF THE MINISTRY OF NEW AND RENEWABLE ENERGY AND MINISTER OF STATE IN THE MINISTRY OF SKILL DEVELOPMENT AND ENTREPRENEURSHIP (SHRI R.K. SINGH): Sir, I beg to lay on the Table a copy of the Detailed Demands for Grants (Hindi and English versions) of the Ministry of Power for the year 2019-2020.

[Placed in Library, See No. LT 243/17/19]

[Translation]

THE MINISTER OF STATE IN THE MINISTRY OF HEALTH AND FAMILY WELFARE (SHRI ASHWINI KUMAR CHOUBEY): Hon. Speaker, Sir, I beg to lay on the Table:

(1) (i) A copy of the Annual Report (Hindi and English versions) of the All India Institute of Medical Sciences, Bhopal, for the year 2017-2018, along with Audited Accounts.

(ii) A copy of the Review (Hindi and English versions) by the Government of the working of the All India Institute of Medical Sciences, Bhopal, for the year 2017-2018.

(2) Statement (Hindi and English versions) showing reasons for delay in laying the papers mentioned at (1) above.

[Placed in Library, See No. LT 244/17/19]

(3) (i) A copy of the Annual Report (Hindi and English versions) of the All India Institute of Medical Sciences, Patna, for the year 2017-2018, along with Audited Accounts.

(ii) A copy of the Review (Hindi and English versions) by the Government of the working of the All India Institute of Medical Sciences, Patna, for the year 2017-2018.

(4) Statement (Hindi and English versions) showing reasons for delay in laying the papers mentioned at (3) above.

[Placed in Library, See No. LT 245/17/19]

(5) A copy each of the following Notifications (Hindi and English versions) under Section 93 of the Food Safety and Standards Act, 2006:-

(i) The Food Safety and Standards (Food Products Standards and Food Additives) First Amendment Regulations, 2019 published in Notification No. F.

No. 02-01/ENF-1(1)/ FSSAI-2012 published in Gazette of India dated 31 January, 2019.

(ii) The Food Safety and Standards (Contaminants, toxin and Residues) Third Amendment Regulations, 2018 published in Notification No. F. No. 1-SP (PAR)-Notification-pesticide/stds- FSSAI-2017 published in Gazette of India dated 24th December 2018.

[Placed in Library, See No. LT 246/17/19]

[English]

THE MINISTER OF STATE IN THE MINISTRY OF ENVIRONMENT, FOREST AND CLIMATE CHANGE (SHRI BABUL SUPRIYO): Sir, I beg to lay on the Table:-

(1) (i) A copy of the Annual Report (Hindi and English versions) of the National Biodiversity Authority, Chennai, for the year 2017-2018, alongwith Audited Accounts.

(ii) A copy of the Review (Hindi and English versions) by the Government of the working of the National Biodiversity Authority, Chennai, for the year 2017-2018.

(2) Statement (Hindi and English versions) showing reasons for delay in laying the papers mentioned at (1) above.

[Placed in Library, See No. LT 247/17/19]

(3) A copy each of the following papers (Hindi and English versions) under sub-section (1) of Section 394 of the Companies Act, 2013:-

(i) Review by the Government of the working of the Andaman and Nicobar Islands Forest and Plantation Development Corporation Limited, Port Blair, for the year 2017-2018.

(ii) Annual Report of the Andaman and Nicobar Islands Forest and Plantation Development Corporation Limited, Port Blair, for the year 2017-2018, alongwith Audited Accounts and comments of the Comptroller and Auditor General thereon.

(4) Statement (Hindi and English versions) showing reasons for delay in laying the papers mentioned at (3) above.

[Placed in Library, See No. LT 248/17/19]

(5) A copy each of the following Notifications (Hindi and English versions) under Section 25 of the Environment (Protection) Act, 1986:-

(1) G.S.R.397(E) published in Gazette of India dated 31st May, 2019 regarding Sale and Use of Petcoke in Lime Kilns.

(2) S.O.1651(E) published in Gazette of India dated 25th April, 2019 regarding amendment of the Environmental Pollution (Prevention and Control) Authority.

(3) S.O.6314(E) published in Gazette of India dated 26th December, 2019 regarding Taj Trapezium Zone Pollution (prevention and Control) Authority at Agra.

[Placed in Library, See No. LT 249/17/19]

(6) A copy of the Hazardous and Other Wastes (Management and Transboundary Movement) Amendment Rules, 2019 (Hindi and English versions) published in Notification No. G.S.R.178 (E) in Gazette of India dated 5th March, 2019 under Section 26 of the Environment (Protection) Act, 1986.

[Placed in Library, See No. LT 250/17/19]

(7) A copy of the Notification No. G.S.R.419 (E) (Hindi and English versions) published in Gazette of India dated 13th June, 2019 making certain amendments in the Notification No. G.S.R.606 (E) dated 16th June, 2016 under Section 7A of the Public Liability Insurance Act, 1991.

[Placed in Library, See No. LT 251/17/19]

(8) A copy each of the following Notifications (Hindi and English versions) under Section 3 of the Environment (Protection) Act, 1986:-

(1) G.S.R.37 (E) published in Gazette of India dated 18th January, 2019, regarding coastal and Island Regulations

are mandate of this Ministry with a view to conserve and protect the unique environment of coastal stretches and marine areas, besides livelihood security to the fisher communities and other local communities in the coastal areas and to promote sustainable development based on scientific principles taking into account the dangers of natural hazards, sea level rise due to global warming.

(2) S.O.1242 (E) published in Gazette of India dated 8th March, 2019, regarding coastal and Island Regulations are mandate of this Ministry with a view to conserve and protect the unique environment of coastal stretches and marine areas, besides livelihood security to the fisher communities and other local communities in the coastal areas and to promote sustainable development based on scientific principles taking into account the dangers of natural hazards, sea level rise due to global warming.

[Placed in Library, See No. LT 252/17/19]

THE MINISTER OF STATE IN THE MINISTRY OF FINANCE AND MINISTER OF STATE IN THE MINISTRY OF CORPORATE AFFAIRS (SHRI ANURAG SINGH THAKUR): Sir, I beg to lay on the Table a copy each of the following papers (Hindi and English versions):-

(1) Detailed Demands for Grants of the Parliament, Secretariats of the President and Vice-President for the year 2019-2020.

[Placed in Library, See No. LT 253/17/19]

(2) Detailed Demands for Grants of the Ministry of Finance for the year 2019-2020.

[Placed in Library, See No. LT 254/17/19]

12.03 hrs

STATEMENTS BY MINISTER

(i) (a)Status of implementation of the recommendations contained in the 323rd Report of the Standing Committee on Science and Technology, Environment and Forests on Action taken by the Government on the recommendations/observations contained in 315th Report of the Committee on the Demands for Grants (2018- 19) pertaining to the Ministry of Earth Sciences*

[English]

THE MINISTER OF HEALTH AND FAMILY WELFARE, MINISTER OF SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY AND MINISTER OF EARTH SCIENCES (DR. HARSH VARDHAN): I beg to lay the following statements regarding the status of implementation of the recommendations contained in the 323rd Report of the Standing Committee on Science and Technology, Environment and Forests on Action taken by the Government on the recommendations/observations contained in 315th Report of the Committee on the Demands for Grants (2018-19) pertaining to the Ministry of Earth Sciences.

* Laid on the Table and also placed in Library, See No. LT 255/17/19.

(b) Status of implementation of the recommendations contained in the 317th Report of the Standing Committee on Science and Technology, Environment and Forests on Action Taken by the Government on the recommendations/observations contained in 309th Report of the Committee on the Demands for Grants (2018-19) pertaining to the Department of Biotechnology, Ministry of Science and Technology*

THE MINISTER OF HEALTH AND FAMILY WELFARE, MINISTER OF SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY AND MINISTER OF EARTH SCIENCES (DR. HARSH VARDHAN): I beg to lay the following statements regarding the status of implementation of the recommendations contained in the 317th Report of the Standing Committee on Science and Technology, Environment and Forests on Action Taken by the Government on the recommendations/observations contained in 309th Report of the Committee on the Demands for Grants (2018-19) pertaining to the Department of Biotechnology, Ministry of Science and Technology.

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* Laid on the Table and also placed in Library, See No. LT 256/17/19 .

12.04 hrs

BUSINESS OF THE HOUSE

[English]

THE MINISTER OF STATE IN THE MINISTRY OF PARLIAMENTARY AFFAIRS AND MINISTER OF STATE IN THE MINISTRY OF HEAVY INDUSTRIES AND PUBLIC ENTERPRISES (SHRI ARJUN RAM MEGHWAL): Hon. Speaker, Sir, I rise to announce that Government Business during the week commencing Monday, the 15th of July, 2019 will consist of :-

1. Consideration of any items of Government Business carried over from today's order paper: - *[it contains (i) Further discussion and voting on Demands for Grants under the control of the Ministry of Railways for 2019- 20; (ii) Consideration and passing of the Central Universities (Amendment) Bill, 2019; and (iii) Discussion and voting on Demands for Grants under the control of the Ministry of Road Transport and Highways for 2019-20.]*

2. Discussion & Voting on Demands for Grants of the following Ministries for 2019-20:-

   (i) Rural Development and Agriculture and Farmers' Welfare

   (ii) Youth Affairs and Sports

3. Guillotining of outstanding Demands for Grants in respect of Union Budget for 2019-20.

4. Introduction, consideration and passing of the Appropriation (No.2) Bill relating to the Demands for Grants for 2019-20.

5. Consideration and passing of the Finance (No.2) Bill, 2019.

6. Consideration of passing of the following Bills:-

   (i) The DNA Technology (Use and Application) Regulation Bill, 2019.

   (ii) The Unlawful Activities (Prevention) Amendment Bill, 2019.

   (iii) The National Investigation Agency (Amendment) Bill, 2019

   (iv) The Protection of Human Rights (Amendment) Bill, 2019

   (v) The Consumer Protection Bill, 2019

   (vi) The Jallianwala Bagh National Memorial (Amendment) Bill, 2019.

[Translation]

SHRI ARJUNLAL MEENA (UDAIPUR): Hon'ble Speaker Sir, first of all, I would like to express my thanks to you. The following matters may be included in the next week's List of Business:

1. The "Meena" and "Mina" should be considered as same under Scheduled Tribes in Rajasthan state.

2. Mangarh Dham is situated on the border of Gujarat and Madhya Pradesh in the Banswara district of Rajasthan. I, through you, would like to demand from the Government that the Mangarh Dham should be declared as Tribal National Monument.

SHRI MAHABALI SINGH (KARAKAT): Hon'ble Speaker Sir, the following matter may be included in the next week's List of Business:

1. There is an important scheme of Union Government for construction work of rail line from Aurangabad to Bihta in Bihar. The work on this scheme is being undertaken at slow pace. The said important scheme should be completed at the earliest in the public interest.

[English]

SHRI THOL THIRUMAAVALAVAN (CHIDAMBARAM): I request you that the following matter may be included in the next week's List of Business:

1. In 1965, the Lokur Committee appointed by the Central Government had recommended that the Narikuravar alias Kuruvikkarar community be given ST status. I urge upon the Union Government to bring the constitution (Scheduled Castes & Scheduled Tribes) orders (Amendment) Bill 2019 to extend the Scheduled Tribes status to Narikuravars.

[Translation]

SHRI HANUMAN BENIWAL (NAGAUR): Hon'ble Speaker Sir, the following matters may be included in the next week's List of Business:

1. It should be considered to set up a Sainik School in Nagaur district in view of the number of families of soldiers residing there.
2. It should be considered to set up additional Kendriya Vidyalayas in Nagaur district in view of the large area and huge population there.

SHRI JANARDAN SINGH SIGRIWAL (MAHARAJGANI): Hon'ble Speaker Sir, through you, I urge that the following matters may be included in the next week's List of Business:

1. It should be considered to set up rake point on the vacant land near Maharajganj and Chainwa railway station in Varanasi Division of North Eastern Railway in my Parliamentary constituency.
2. It should be considered to set up Software Technology Park and NIE LIT – National Electronics and Information Technology in Jalalpur in Chhapra District of Bihar in my parliamentary constituency.

SHRI KAUSHLENDRA KUMAR (NALANDA): Hon'ble Speaker Sir, the following matters may be included in the next week's List of Business:

1. At present, Commerce & Science streams are being offered in intermediate in Kendriya Vidyalaya, Rajgir in my Parliamentary constituency, Nalanda, but Arts stream is not offered there. I would like to demand from Hon'ble Minister of Human Resource Development that teaching of Arts in Intermediate should be introduced in Kendriya Vidyalaya, Rajgir from the academic year 2019-20.
2. Only 60 lakhs families have been included in BPL category in Bihar as per new norms of BPL whereas one crore thirty three lakhs families are living below poverty line, which need to be included in the BPL category.

SHRI SUMEDHANAND SARASWATI (SIKAR): Hon'ble Speaker Sir, the following matters may be included in the next week's List of Business:

1. Discussion should be held on sale of fake DAP by Government Agency to the farmers of Sikar and Jhunjhunu districts of Rajasthan.
2. Discussion should be held on the serious problem of drinking water in Rajasthan including Sikar, Jhunjhujnu districts.

[English]

SHRIMATI SUPRIYA SADANAND SULE (BARAMATI): I request you that the following two matters may be included in the next week's List of Business:

1. Fatal pedestrian accidents on NH4 stretch from Bavdhan to Ravet of Maharashtra. I request the Government to take cognizance of urgency and construct foot overbridges, underpasses to ensure pedestrian's safety.
2. There is high unemployment and lack of jobs in the country. There is also lack of sufficient work under MGNREGA in drought hit regions of Maharashtra. I urge the Centre to release sufficient funds for drought.

SHRI KODIKUNNIL SURESH (MAVELIKKARA): Sir, I request you that the following two matters may be included in the next week's List of Business: -

1. The proposed Kendriya Vidyalaya Kottarakkara, Kollam district, Kerala should be commenced from this academic year.
2. Pathanapuram is one of the Taluks of my Parliamentary constituency in Kerala. Pathanapuram Taluk is the most backward and thickly forested area. There is a proposal to set up an FM Radio Station there, and I urge the Government to take action in this regard.

SHRI N. K. PREMACHANDRAN (KOLLAM) : Sir, I request you that the following two matters may be included in the next week's List of Business: -

1. Denial of admission to the wards of insured persons in ESI medical colleges due to the verdict of Madras High Court.
2. Revival package for cashew industry giving relief to lakhs of poor cashew workers.

12.10 hrs

ELECTIONS TO COMMITTEES

(i) Central Supervisory Board

[English]

THE MINISTER OF HEALTH AND FAMILY WELFARE, MINISTER OF SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY AND MINISTER OF EARTH SCIENCES (DR. HARSH VARDHAN): Sir, I beg to move the following:-

“That in pursuance of clause (f) of sub-section (2) of Section 7 read with clause (a) of sub-section (1) of Section 8 of the Pre-Conception and Pre-Natal Diagnostic Techniques (Prohibition of Sex Selection) Act, 1994, the members of this House do proceed to elect, in such manner as the Speaker may direct, two women members from amongst themselves to serve as members of the Central Supervisory Board subject to the provisions of Section 15 of the said Act and the rules made thereunder."

[Translation]

HON. SPEAKER: The question is:

"That in pursuance of clause (f) of sub-section (2) of Section 7 read with clause (a) of sub-section (1) of Section 8 of the Pre-Conception and Pre-Natal Diagnostic Techniques (Prohibition of Sex Selection) Act, 1994, the members of this House do proceed to elect, in such manner as the Speaker may direct, two women members from amongst themselves to serve as members of the

Central Supervisory Board subject to the provisions of Section 15 of the said Act and the rules made thereunder."

The Motion was adopted.

(ii) Post-Graduate Institute of Medical Education and Research (PGIMER), Chandigarh

[English]

THE MINISTER OF HEALTH AND FAMILY WELFARE, MINISTER OF SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY AND MINISTER OF EARTH SCIENCES (DR. HARSH VARDHAN): Sir, I beg to move the following:-

> "That in pursuance of Section 5(g) read with sub-section (1) of Section 6 of the Post-Graduate Institute of Medical Education and Research, Chandigarh Act, 1966, the members of this House do proceed to elect, in such manner as the Speaker may direct, two members from amongst themselves to serve as members of the Institute Body of Post-Graduate Institute of Medical Education and Research, Chandigarh subject to the other provisions of the said Act and the rules made thereunder."

[Translation]

HON. SPEAKER: The question is:

"That in pursuance of Section 5(g), read with sub-section (1) of section 6 of the Post-Graduate Institute of Medical Education and Research. Chandigarh Act, 1966, the members of this House do proceed to elect, in such manner as the Speaker may direct, two members from amongst themselves to serve as members of the Institute Body of Post-Graduate Institute of Medical Education

and Research, Chandigarh subject to the other provisions of the said Act and the rules made thereunder."

The Motion was adopted

(iii) Jawaharlal Institute of Post-Graduate Medical Education and Research (JIPMER), Puducherry

[English]

THE MINISTER OF HEALTH AND FAMILY WELFARE, MINISTER OF SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY AND MINISTER OF EARTH SCIENCES (DR. HARSH VARDHAN): Sir, I beg to move the following:-

> "That in pursuance of Section 5(k) read with sub-section (1) of Section 6 of the Jawaharlal Institute of Post-Graduate Medical Education and Research, Puducherry Act, 2008, the members of this House do proceed to elect, in such manner as the Speaker may direct, two members from amongst themselves to serve as members of the Institute Body of Jawaharlal Institute of Post-Graduate Medical Education and Research, Puducherry, subject to the other provisions of the said Act and the rules made thereunder."

[Translation]

HON. SPEAKER: The question is:

"That in pursuance of Section 5(k) read with sub-section (1) of Section 6 of the Jawaharlal Institute of Post-Graduate Medical Education and Research, Puducherry Act, 2008, the members of this House do proceed to elect, in such manner as the Speaker may direct, two members from amongst themselves to serve as members of the Institute Body of Jawaharlal Institute of Post-Graduate Medical Education and Research, Puducherry, subject to the other provisions of the said Act and the rules made thereunder."

The Motion was adopted.

(iv) National Tiger Conservation Authority

[English]

THE MINISTER OF ENVIRONMENT, FOREST AND CLIMATE CHANGE AND MINISTER OF INFORMATION AND BROADCASTING (SHRI PRAKASH JAVADEKAR): Sir, I beg to move the following:-

> "That in pursuance of clause (c) of sub-section 2 of Section 38(L) of the Wild Life (Protection) Act, 1972, the members of this House do proceed to elect, in such manner as the Speaker may direct, two members from amongst themselves to serve as members of the National Tiger Conservation Authority, subject to the other provisions of the said Act."

[Translation]

HON. SPEAKER: The question is:

"That in pursuance of clause (c) of sub-section 2 of Section 38(L) of the Wild Life (Protection) Act, 1972, the members of this House do proceed to elect, in such manner as the Speaker may direct, two members from amongst themselves to serve as members of the National Tiger Conservation Authority, subject to the other provisions of the said Act"

The Motion was adopted.

12.13 hrs

MOTION RE: 3rd REPORT OF BUSINESS ADVISORY COMMITTEE

[Translation]

SHRI ARJUN RAM MEGHWAL: I beg to move:

"That this House do agree with the Third Report of the Business Advisory Committee presented to the House on 11th July, 2019"

HON. SPEAKER: The question is:

"That this House do agree with the Third Report of the Business Advisory Committee presented to the House on 11th July, 2019"

The Motion was adopted.

12.14 hrs

UNION BUDGET, 2019-2020

DEMAND FOR GRANT

Ministry of Railways … Contd

[Translation]

***SHRI VINOD KUMAR SONKAR (KAUSHAMBI):** The grants for Railway for 2019-20 is also a roadmap of coming 10 years along with the current one. The required development and modernization of Railway has not taken place as much as it should been due to short sightedness of previous governments. As a result, the pace of development of Indian Railway could not match with that of other countries and lagged much behind of the work and an amount of Rs. 50 lakh crores is required to complete it at present. The Hon'ble Minister of Railways has proposed for public private partnership model for modernization and development of railways which will certainly accelerate the pace of modernization, upgradation and development of Indian Railway and provide employment opportunities to lakhs of youths. The Government has presented a good budget and every section of the society has welcomed it. The Government has provided relief to train passengers by not increasing the passenger fare in the budget. Our Government has taken following important steps to widen the safety mechanism: The smart coach having diagnostic

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* Speech was laid on the Table

system provides early information about the condition of wheel and track. Besides, the coach is equipped with the facility of wheel slip protection monitoring. The fire safety mechanism is being further streamlined to provide announcement and information system for emergency exit of the passenger along with installing integrated fire and smoke identification unit for safety in case of fire. The video analytic facility is being provided for phased identification and to beef up safety and security in case of unusual incidents. The Indian railways has taken a decision to completely transform the manufacturing of main line coaches into the coaches having LHB design from 2018-19. The production of LHB coaches has continucously been increasing in the production units during last few years. The production of LHB coach from 2004-05 to 2013-14 was 2327 whereas 5548 coaches were manufactured from 2014-15 to 2017-18. During 2018-19, 4016 coaches are proposed to be manufactured.

The cases of train accidents have come down from 104 to 73 during 2017-18 in comparison to accidents occurred in the corresponding period of last year due to tireless efforts made by railways. These cases of train accidents have reduced from 51 to 44 during 2018-19 (from 1st April 2018 to 30th November 2018) in the corresponding period of last year.

The following table provides the category wise details of accidents:

Types of Accidents	**April to March (2016-17)**	**April to March (2017-18)**	**1st April to 30th Nov. (2017-18)**	**1st April to 30th Nov. (2018-2019)**
Collisions	5	3	3	0
Derailment	78	54	39	35
Accidents at Manned Level Crossings	0	3	1	3
Accidents at Unmanned Level Crossings	20	10	8	3
Fire in trains	1	3	0	2
Miscellaneous	0	0	0	1
Total	**104**	**73**	**51**	**44**

3478 unmanned level crossings have been eliminated so far during the current year. Effectively, all the unmanned level crossings except one have

been eliminated on the broad gauge lines of Indian Railways. It will also be eliminated during current financial year. Now, there is no unmanned level crossings on the broad gauge lines in the 15 out of 16 Zonal Railway. The numbers of accidents have come down from 20 to 3 at unmanned railway crossings in the current year up to December, 2018. The total length of 4405 km. of railway track has been renovated so far in 2017-2018 and length of 5000 km. of railway track is planned to be renovated during current year with the outlay of Rs. 11,450 crores. The work on the length of 2812 km of railway track has been completed so far during the current year. A special RRSK Fund worth Rs. one lakh crores has been created for security related works including track renewal for a period of 5 years. An annual budget outlay of Rs. 20,000 crores was made in 2017. The testing of the ultrasonic broken rail detection system has been started at the length of every 25 km each in NR and NCR to detect the broken track/weld. After the successful completion of this test, the said system will be used in Indian Railways to receive the information about broken track/weld fracture on time.The GPS based trackers have been provided to keymen and trackmen to know the real time information in respect of any untoward incident/emergency. The VHF based train warning system has been tested in five zonal railway to give early warning to trackmen working on the operational track about the arrival of any train and the instructions have been issued to implement this system on Golden Quadrilateral and its diagonal routes of Indian Railways. It will help in ensuring the personal security of trackmen while working on the track.

On an average basis, 117 machines have been sanctioned with the cost of Rs. 1547 crore to ensure complete mechanization during the year 2014-18, whereas it was 63 in 2014 with the cost of Rs. 560 crores. The highest number of machines i.e. 538 machines have been sanctioned with the provision of Rs.7268 crores made in the Budget of current year to promote mechanization.

Subject	Year			
Average sanction Of machines	2004-09	2019-14	2014-18	2018-19
Fund (in crores)	433	563	1547	7268
Machines (in numbers)	63	52	117	538

For the first time, seven high output integrated track machines have been included in the fleet meant for maintenance of Indian Railway which is likely to provide 60% more output in the same period of effective block hours. The orders have been placed for such 22 more machines and 24 other machines will be used to cover all busy routes in the current year. These machines will be used to achieve the target of 'Better Security and low

Expenditure' in respect of machines to be used to maintain the tracks on busy routes along with the better use of transportation block on the busy routes. It is proposed to introduce stabilizer and Ballast Monitoring System alongwith High Output BCM (HOBCM) from March, 2019 to double the present production capacity of machines for the first time in Indian Railways. It will also make better use of maintenance slot on busy routes in respect of track maintenance and will bring about improvement in safety and affordability. A new 3D state-of-the-art tamping simulator has been installed and made operational for the first time in Indian Railway Track Machine Training Centre (IRTMTC), Allahabad for operation of machines meant for advanced track maintenance, and for skill development of track machine operators and to impart them practical hand on training. Such advanced technology simulator is available in only 5 countries including India. As a result, the training being imparted to ensure better use and maintenance of modern tamping machine will be improved. The best technology has been used to reduce the dependence on human interface and best available technique has been selected to bring down the dependence on the judicious allocation of resources and improve safety. It has been decided to enforce and expand the following new techniques for better inspection, maintenance and monitoring of tracks.

In place of the present practice of monitoring the condition of the surface of stone chips (clearing ballast cushion, preparing ballast shoulders (Pindika) and putting ballast in the cleared space) and examining the track condition at

an interval of 500 GMT or 10 years, apart from Ground Penetration Radar (GPR) facility, it is planned to install Accele Box art Mounted Accelerometer in 40 rakes of the high speed trains operating on high density trunk routes on pilot basis to facilitate deep and intensive examination of the track. Besides, with a view to issue daily alerts to draw immediate attention on track requirements and thus to maintain the track, track component condition monitoring system along with machine vision is planned to be installed in 16 LHB based OMS coaches through zonal railways for intermediary inspection. These measures are planned to be taken to minimize our dependence of manual inspections by getting the list of defects in track components through such systems. There is a plan to cover all the tracks of Indian Railways with rail grinding machines and RIV along with the supplementary switch grinding machines for the maintenance of rail and to check the fractures occurred due to friction caused rolling of wheels. This will enhance reliability of the assets by minimizing the fracture. For the first time in the Indian Railways, orders for 2 Switch Rail Grinding Machines (SRGM) and 2 Rail Inspection Vehicles (RIV) have been given. **Operation of Long Rail Panel:-** With a purpose to bring improvement in the performance of railway service, state-of-the-art machine based system for loading and unloading of long rail panels has been sanctioned so that the operation of long rail can be secured. USFD Vehice (SPURT CAR) has been sanctioned to cover entire Indian Railway network after making improvement in the track security after monitoring and identification of track/weld defects. The Laser based Integrated Track

Recording Cars equipped with the facility of Component Monitoring, Axle box measurement and Clearance measurement System, has been sanctioned in order to cover the entire Indian Railway network. Only 5970 km of Doubling/third and fourth line related works were included in the budget 2009-2014. Moreover, the progress in respect of most of the projects was not satisfactory till 2013-14, due to overall limited availability of funds. This has resulted into serious traffic constraint and drastic decline in the availability of traffic maintenance blocks on the existing network and the safety concerns have also arisen. Since 2014-15, a length of 14,480 km of Doubling/third and fourth line works has been included in the budget. The funds were mobilized through institutional financing in order to ramp up these capacity enhancement projects. Besides sufficient funds are being allocated for each project on the basis of physical progress of the projects, and last mile connectivity projects and also for decongesting the existing routes.

The work of gauge conversion on the length of 970 Km of raiway line has been completed in the North Eastern region during the last 4 years. Thus all MG sections have been converted into BG and no MG line is in operation in the entire North East region. The work relating to 353.15 km of New Line/Gauge Conversion/Doubling commissioned per year during the period from 2014-15 to 2017-18 as against on an average of 110 km was undertaken per year in the NE Region in the period 2009 to 2014. 15 projects of new railway lines of 1,397 km involving the cost of Rs. 47,695 crore are in different

stages of Planning/Sanction/Execution, which partly or fully fall in the states of NE Region. 06 projects of doubling of lines of 482 km involving the cost of Rs. 9,305 crore are in different stages of Sanction/Execution, which partly or fully fall in the states of NE Region.

Seven-sister States of North-Eastern India (Assam, Meghalaya, Nagaland, Tripura, Mizoram, Manipur and Arunachal Pradesh) are connected with one another through Rail Network. Meghalaya was brought on the rail map by the honourable Prime Minister, Shri Narendra Modi, on 29.11.2014, when he flagged off the first ever train from Mendipathar in Meghalaya to Guwahati. Tripura was brought on Broad Gauge Map of Railway on 31st July, 2016 when the then Minister of Railways, Shri Prabhu flaged off Agartala - New Delhi "Tripura- Sundri Express". The Agartala - New Delhi Rajdhani Express was started from 28th October, 2017. It is the longest route (2422 kms.) for any Rajdhani Express in service. Jiribam, the first Railway Station in Manipur was linked with the Broad Gauge line. Hon'ble Prime Minister, Shri Narendra Modi, flagged off the first passenger train for Jiribam on 27th May, 2016. The Passenger train for Bhairabi in Mizoram was also flagged off by him. Lumding - Silchar broad gauge section was inaugurated on November 20, 2015 after gauge conversion, providing seamless broad gauge connectivity to Barak Valley of Assam.

According to the scenario of the North-Eastern region of Indian Railways, all the capitals of 8 North-East States will be linked with broad-gauge rail link by 2020-21. Earlier, only Guwahati was linked to broad gauge rail link. After that, the capitals of Arunachal Pradesh and Tripura States have been linked. India's tallest bridge with height of 141 mtr. is being constructed over Irang river at Noney in Tamenglong district, Manipur as part of Jiribham - Tupul - Imphal new line. Its height will be almost equal to the height of two Qutub Minar together. There will be 6 tall bridges with height more than 70 meters in the Bairabl-Sairang (51.3 km), a new line project. It is India's longest rail-cum-road bridge (4.94 km long). This bridge across river Brahmputra near Dibrugarh in Assam was dedicated to the nation by the Hon'ble Prime Minister on 25th December, 2018. This project was sanctioned in 1997-98 with cost of Rs.1000 crore and in April, 2002, the work on this project was commenced by Bharat Ratna Sh. Atal Bihari Vajpayee, the then Prime Minister of India. The total cost of the project is estimated to be Rs. 5,820 crore. In 2016-17, DEMU services were started in Tinsukia division of NF Railways. New coaching depot have been made operational at Silchar in Barak Valley of Assam and Agartala in Tripura. Through these measures, the isolated North-Eastern region has been provided with better connectivity. In 2017-18, the workshop for renovation of LHB Bongaigaon coaches in New Bongaigaon at a cost of Rs.90 crore was sanctioned. The Diesel electric multiple unit/ mainline electrical multiple unit shade at Lumding with the cost of Rs.73.67 crore has been included in Pink

Book 2018-19. Tender has been awareded and is ready to be made operational soon.

Indian Railway has launched a new initiative for the station beautification with wall art of paints and murals or local arts in collaboration with local artists, private groups and volunteers. All 65 Stations across zonal railways have been beautified under this initiative by utilizing skills of local artists, mostly using local art form, painting style, local themes or contemporary arts. This initiative has provided forum for expression of the emerging regional talents in the area and an apportunity for travelers to see the local art forms. Balharshah and Chandrapur Railway Stations (Central Railways), Madhubani Railway Station (East Central Railways), Madurai Railway Station (Southern Railways) Gandhidham Railway Station (Western Railways), Kota Railway Station (Western Central Railways) and Secundrabad Railway Station (South Central Railways) etc., have been beautified. Indian Railways has also commenced work on soft modernization of 68 stations. This is targeted to be completed by 31st March, 2019. The initiative is meant for bringing about substantial improvement in respect of various passenger amenities like Traffic circulation, inter-platform transfer, waiting halls, entry gate improvement, lighting and accessiblility of stations to Dviyang. The Cabinet approved the plan on 03.10.2018 for redevelopment of railway stations, through simplified procedures adopting various business models, commercial as well as residential development at railway stations. It has been given on lease for 99 years.

Indian Railways Station Development Corporation (IRSDC) has been entrusted with the task of conducting techno-financial feasibility studies and prepare the business plan for all stations. The works in four stations, i.e. Habibganj (Bhopal), Gandhinagar, Lucknow (Charbagh), Lucknow (Gomtinagar) are under progress. The work in Habibganj and Gandhinagar is targeted to be completed by February, 2019.

Indian Railanys has launched the following new modern train conches:- The Hamsafar trains having additional amenities in the coaches have recently been introduced for providing comfortable air-conditioned 3 Tier travel. So far, 29 Hamsafar rakes (9 rakes in 2016-17, 10 rakes in 2017-18, 10 rakes in 2018-19 upto 30.11.2018) have been manufactured by the production units.

Following major features have been introduced: GPS Based Passenger Information System, Public Announcement System, Dustbins in each way, Coffee Vending Machine, pleasing colour scheme for Improved Aesthetics.

Closed-Circuit Television (CCTV) based Surveillance System, Integrated Brail displays, etc. In the long distance fully unreserved train, the facilities of LHB general second class coaches with vestibules, cushioned luggage racks, additional hand-hold in doorway area for the comfort of standing passengers, provision of hooks near longitudinal luggage racks for hanging carry bags, enhanced numbers of mobile charging points, more pleasing colour scheme for interior and exteriors, provision of MU cable in each coach for running train service with loco at both ends have been provided. So far, 15 Antyodaya rakes

(3 rakes in 2016-17, 10 rakes in 2017-18 and 3 rakes in 2018-19) have been manufactured by the production units. Main additional features of Deendayalu Coaches are cushioned luggage racks, additional handhold in doorway area, provision of hooks for hanging carry bags near vertical luggage rakes, toilet occupation indication display board, enhanced mobile charging facility, fire extinguishers alongwith anti-theft arrangement, water-level indicator, pleasing interiors, improved exterior color scheme with anti-wall paing coating, polymerised floor coating in toilets. More than 1100 Deendayalu coaches have so far been manufactured by production units. Mumbai CST- Karmali Tejas train between Mumbai CSTM and Karmali/Goa has been started on 24.05.2017. Two more Tejas rakes have been manufactured by the production units in the current year. These ultra modern trains with speed potential of 200 km/ph have following major distinguished features: Automatic Entrance doors; Passengers Information Display System (Electronic Reservation Chart System); GPS based Passenger Information System; Fire and Smoke Detection System; Superior Toilet fittings; Sealed Vestibules; LED lights; CCTV; Aesthetically pleasing Colour scheme. These coaches provide enhanced viewing area including roof to enable tourists to enjoy panoramic view while travelling. These facilities have been properly provided. Total of four such coaches are in service in scenic areas. Model rakes include following features:

• Modular Panels

• Superior Material for Panels

• Ergonomically designed ladders

•Aesthetically appealing Toilet Modules

• Large Size Mirrors

•Platform washbasin

• Controlled discharged water taps

• Odour control system and

• Dustbin inside the toilet

First model rake was started in Mahamana Express between New Delhi -Varanasi in January, 2016. Bhopal MLR workshop has manufactured more than 120 model rake coaches. ICF has also manufactured 24 model rake coaches. A total of 4 such rakes are in service on date. Project Swarn was started to upgrade the condition of Rajdhani and Shatabdi Express trains with the objective of significantly improving the passenger experience across 9 dimensions which include coach interiors, toilets, onboard cleanliness, staff behaviour, catering, linen, punctuality, security. Giving real time feedback is also a part of project Swarn. Under this scheme, total 29 trains have been covered @ Rs.50 lakh per rake. Project UTKARSH has been launched to improve condition of 66 important Mail/ Express trains, @ Rs.60 lakh per rake, in which 140 rakes have been included. As a part of this project, improvement in coach interior, coach exterior, toilets, lighting and passenger amenities will be improved. This is targeted to be completed in 2018-19. Phase II of Project

UTKARSH has also been sanctioned in which 500 rakes of mail/ express trains are targeted to be upgraded in 2019-2020.

The CFL/FL lights in all TL/AC and self propelled (EMU/MEMU/DEMU) coaches have been replaced with LED lights which is likely to save cost of electricity to the tune of Rs. 19764/- per AC coach per annum and Rs. 8424/- per non AC coach per annum.

No. of coaches from 2014-15 to 2016-17	**No. of coaches during 2017-18**	**No. of coaches during 2018-19**
820 coaches	4180 coaches	6465 coaches

To promote cashless and digital transactions, the Ministry of Railways took the following steps:

Installation of Point of Sale (POS) machines at various Passenger Reservation System (PRS)/ Unreserved Ticketing System (UTS) booking offices & Parcel and Goods location for acceptance of payment through credit/debit cards;

Acceptance of Unified Payments Interface (UPI)Bharat Interface for Money (BHIM) as a payment option for booking of reserved/unreserved tickets; Withdrawal of service charge on online booking of tickets; Withdrawal of transaction charges applicable on transactions against credit/debit cards for purchasing journey tickets at PRS/UTS counter; 0.5% discount on season tickets purchased through digital means; 5% discount on reserved counter ticket subject to maximum discount of Rs 50 for tickets of value of Rs100/-or more for payments made through UPI/BHIM; Provision of 5% commission of the recharge value as bonus at the time of recharging; R-wallet in case of unreserved ticket booking through mobile phone; Provision of 3% bonus on every recharge of Automatic Ticket Vending Machines (ATVM) card as an incentive for promotion of ticket booking through ATVM.

To provide passengers with an elevated level of comfort and a highly satisfying experience, the Ministry of Railways has taken the following steps: Introduction of ticket booking through mobile phone - UTSONMOBILE App for unreserved ticket booking and IRCTC RAIL CONNECT App for reserved ticket booking; Establishment of Yatri Ticket Suvidha Kendras (YTSK) on public private partnership basis for issuing of tickets; Launch of the Next Generation E-ticketing System (NGeT), improvement in accessibility e-ticketing; introduction of defence Travel System enabling online booking of tickets for defence personnel; Provision of concessional online ticket booking facility to persons with disabilities and accredited press correspondents; and

streamlining of computerised Passenger Reservation System to facilitate timely preparation of Reservation Charts and transfer of vacant berths to next remote location; introduction of Alternate Train Accommodation Scheme known as VIKALP scheme on all trains to provide confirmed accommodation to waitlisted passengers; Provision of SMS alerts facility to passengers in case of change in train running status like cancellation/delay of trains for more than one hour etc.The downloaded Andhaar (e-Andhaar) & m-Aadhaar has also been recognized as one of the proof of identity for undertaking journey in any reserved class. The concept of "Train Captain' as a single person/leader responsible for coordinating the entire team and facilitating all services during the complete journey of the train has been introduced. For the first time, passenger amenities are being provided at stations on the basis of earnings from passenger as well as passenger footfalls. Revised criteria for categorization of stations has been issued on 22.11.2017. The revised criteria aim at providing higher level of amenities at bigger stations, commensurate with the earnings/passengers dealings. Revised comprehensive instructions for provision of passenger amenities at various categories of stations have been issued. Foot Over Bridge and High Level Platforms have been included in minimum essential category for all stations and accordingly all stations of Indian Railways will be provided with FoB and High Level Platforms in a phased manner. Also all new stations shall now be constructed with High Level platforms and Foot Over Bridge at all categories of stations on broad gauge including Halt stations. Complete decentralization of powers to DRM and Field

officer for fixation of Price for Parking, Pay & Use Toilet, charges for Retiring Rooms/dormitory, Portage charges etc.

Divisional Railway Managers (DRMs) have been empowered to extend the period of contract of physically handicapped PCO booth holders up to one year at a time on the basis of satisfactory performance of licensee.

Zonal Railways have been advised to provide one wheelchair per platform and in case of island platforms one wheelchair per two platforms at all A-1 and A category stations. General Managers have also been authorized to reduce/ increase the number of wheel chairs to be provided at stations based on the passenger traffic at the station and assessed requirement of wheel chairs at the stations**. Provision of a segregated area within waiting halls to be known as feeding corner for feeding the babies by lactating mothers.** Online booking of retiring Rooms with the provision of hourly booking. Launch of 'Sarathi Sewa' for provision of Battery Operated Vehicles (BOVs) at stations through publicity route or CSR. Launch of "Yatri Mitra Sewa' at major stations for booking of wheel chair service cum porter services etc.

Integrated mechanized cleaning was provided at 488 Railway stations up to March 2018. It is now provided at 697 stations.Independent third party Survey of passenger perception on Cleanliness standards of 407 major railway stations was carried out first time in 2016 and repeated in 2017 and 2018. On Board House Keeping Service (OBHS) is being provided since 2008-09. Starting from 2008-09, OBHS was provided in 416 pairs of trains up to March, 2014. 448 pairs of trains were added to it in 3 years from 2014-15 to 2016-17

Another 139 added to it in 2017-18 and 65 more in 2018-19. A total of 1068 trains are presently having facility of this service.

All Rajdhani, Shatabdi, Duronto and other important long distance Mail/Express trains are provided with OBHS for cleaning of coach toilets, doorways, aisles and passenger compartments during the trains-operation. "Clean-my-Coach" service has been provided in 1059 trains on the basis of SMS service. Increasing the "Coach-Mitra" service from 2017-18, at present 1020 trains have been covered. Railways are setting up mechanized laundries for improving quality of washing of linen provided to AC coach passengers. Starting from 2009-10, 25 Mechanized laundries were set up till March, 2014. 32 more mechanized laundries were set up from 2014-15 to 2018-19. Orders for 14 more mechanized laundries with total capacity of 81 tones per day (TPD) have been placed. Nearly 283 TPD is presently being supplied from mechanized laundries. It is targetted to cover 100% linen washing requirement by mechanised laundries in next financial year.

These not only clean exterior of coaches more effectively and efficiently, they also reduce the direct water requirement by avoiding wastage. In addition, these also come with water recycling facility thereby further reducing the requirement. Based on the location feasibility, initially 122 locations have been identified for provision of ACWP. 10 plants have been installed and LOA has been issued for 7 more locations. The work on tender is being done. 10 plants have been installed and LOA has been issued for 7 more locations. As a part

of "Swachh Bharat Mission," Indian Railways is proliferating bio-toilets on all its coaching stock so that no human waste is discharged from coaches on to the track. During 2017-18, against the target of 40000, 57429 biotoilets have been provided in 15017 coaches, as compared to 3374, 3961 and 8788 biotoilets in 10159, 15442 and 34134 coaches during the last three years.

	2004-2014	**2014-2017**	**2017-2018**	**2018-19 (upto Nov)**
Bio Toilets	9587	59735	57086	40937
Coaches	3647	16123	15017	11107

The Vacuum flushing system substantially reduce the requirement of water for flushing in the toilets and at the same time it ensures, effective/ proper flushing of faecal matter from the pans. Bio-vacuum toilets have been provided in “the Tejas" train running between Mumbai & Goa. The Vacuum toilets are being provided on all newly manufactured Tejas and Humsafar coaches from 2018-19 onwards.The process of providing another 2000 bio-vacuum toilets is going on.The Railways has been instructed to provide Bio-vacuum toilets in coaches of all premium trains to ensure proliferation of

vacuum toilets at an accelerated pace. PUs shall be providing these facilities in all new coaches w.e.f. 2019-20. Modern Coach factory (MCF) has manufactured a smart coach in September,2018, which provides better safety passenger facilities as well as enables predictive maintenance. Diagnostic system monitors bearing vibrations and provides advance information on health of wheel & track. Moreover, coach has been provided with wheel slip protection monitoring, water level indicator, Wi-Fi, infotainment system with emergency communication facility and passenger announcement and information system alongwith digital destination board. Further, improvements are being brought about to provide and monitor improved air conditioning which will monitor pollutant particles in the coach along with quantum of fresh air and power consumption inside the coach. Fire safety through fire and smoke detection unit integrated with passenger announcement and information system for emergency evacuation and video analytics with phased detection and unusual occurrence features would further enhance safety and security. A 'SAMANVAY' portal (www.railsamanvay.co.in) has been developed to receive online information about the issues pending with State Governments with regard to infrastructural developmental projects which are being undertaken by different Railway agencies. The Concerned State Governments have been requested to sort out the pending issues of Railways in their respective States which are uploaded on 'SAMANVAY' portal and do the needful action to help Railway to expedite its developmental/expansion projects.

At last, while supporting the Budget, I would like to urge you to approve my following demands placed before you. A survey was approved to be conducted for doubling and electrification of Prayag to Unchahar via Kunda-Harnamganj rail line in the Budget of 2018-19 and it should be completed and work should be started on this line at the earliest; an over-bridge should be constructed in Biganpur Village at the earlist; the construction of an over bridge should be started in Kunda; the Kolkata bound trains should be provided stoppage at Sirathu Railway Station; the condition of small railway stations from Manouri to Athsarai is very bad; the Sources of basic amenities including teenshed made for protection from sunlight, rain and cold are in dilapidated condition; these should be repaired or constructed urgently. I t would like toreques Hon'ble Minister to pay attention towards it. Facilities for, drinking water and toilets are required to be provided there; a new platform should be constructed and one foot rest should be constructed to connect platform 1 and 2 at Sirathu Railway Station; One foot rest should be constructed at Bharwari Railway station to connect platform one and two; the stoppage should be provided to up and down Sangam Express at Manouri Railway Station; Intercity Express train between Kanpur and Prayagraj should be provided stoppage at Paryanwan Railway Station. I would like to request the Hon'ble Minister to run intercity which originates from Kanpur in the morning and reaches Prayag in the evening should be run from Prayag in the morning to Kanpur. At last, I support the Grants for Railway 2019-2020.

***SHRI KAPIL MORESHWAR PATIL (BHIWANDI):** First of all, I would like to thank the Hon'ble Minister of Railways who dedicated the developed Railway services to the public by keeping in mind the basic principle of "Sabka Sath, Sabka Vikas" of our popular Prime Minister.

It is the railways which takes development to everyone. Before 2014, all the Ministers of Railways made announcements to start new rail projects one after another in 20-25 years, but most of them remained confined in papers only. In those years, many of my colleagues demanded from the Government to start the rail projects in their respective constituencies but those demands could not be sanctioned. Many of such projects could not come to the ground.

The steps mentioned to be taken by the Hon'ble Minister of Railways in the budget i.e. providing better facilities to all the classes of passengers, ensuring safety of their luggage and quality of journey, maintenance of cleanliness of the railways, improvement in quality of catering, ensuring timely operation of trains and increase in the existing speed of trains are extraordinary. Introduction of unreserved trains for the first time for the poor passengers is a good step. Thus, it can be said that the rail budget has been prepared to make railways modern, self reliant, progressive, efficient as per convenience of every passenger.

An amount of Rs. 65,837 crore has been allocated in the rail budget to take care of the passenger facility. The budget of the Financial year 2019-20 which allocates Rs. 7,255 crore for laying of new lines, Rs. 2,200 crore for Gauge Conversion, Rs. 6,114.82 crore for rolling staff is intended to cater to the

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* Speech was laid on the Table

needs of 130 crore Indians (rich or poor), entrepreneurs and industries and created new opportunities for them.

My Parliamentary Constituency is Bhiwandi, Maharashtra, My constituency has a lot of expectations from Indian Railways. I would like to figure them out. Railway Network is required to be expanded in entire Maharashtra including my constituency Bhiwandi.

There is Murbad Tehsil in my constituency. It should be connected with rail route at the earliest. It has been passed in the previous budget. The construction of this new route should be started at the earliest after identifying the final location, conducting the survey and preparing the detailed Project Report for this sanctioned new Titwala-Murbad rail line. A Gurawali station between Titwala-Khadavli stations should be constructed. New local trains should be introduced from Dahanu-Karsa-Karjan and Dahanu-Diwa-Panwel at the earliest. The rail service should be extended on Panwel-Diwa-Bhiwandi Road on Basai road route. The Chamtoli station should be constructed between Vagni-Badlapur Station. Approval should be granted for the construction of Piplas station on Diva-Basai route. RUB 98/2 between Aadh Aanv and Tamshet stations of Central Railway should be widened at the earliest so that the rail projects should completed on time in entire Maharashtra.

The bullet train is being introduced for the development of country. All citizens of our country are waiting for this bullet train. The service roads are required to be constructed on all routes of Bullet Train Project. The accidents continue to take place on either side of the locations where bridges are proposed to constructed on the rivers or valleys. It will bring about a great relief to the passengers if the service roads are built there.

The religious places and tourist spots of Maharashtra are proposed to be developed in the rail budget to promote rail tourism. I thank the Hon'ble Minister of Railways for this effort and support demand for grants of the railways.

***SHRI PARBHUBHAI NAGARBHAI VASAVA (BARDOLI):** I support the Demands for Grants of Rail Budget and lay my suggestions on the table.

The development work of railway, which has been carried out during last five years in our country is the result of the efficient leadership of our illustrious Prime Minister, Shri Narendra Modi ji and efforts made by present Minister of Railways. It is a commendable work. It will take more time if I go into its details work. The dream of countrymen for Bullet Train from Ahmedabad in Gujarat to Mumbai has been fulfilled by Hon'ble Shri Narendra Modi ji. I congratulate him for this. A new rail line is being laid, railway is being electrified, platforms are being cleaned and mission for sanitation inside the train goes on daily. A booking counter is required to be opened at Bardoli railway station in my constituency Bardoli, which is the work place of Sardar Patel. There is no train from Surat to Gorakhpur via Bardoli. Such a train is required to be introduced. It is urgently required to provide stoppage to any of two trains out of Surat-Bhagalpur, Bandra-Patna, Navjivan Express at Bardoli Station. Simultaneously, there is a Vyara railway station in my constituency which falls under Tapi district where platform is required to be expanded and beautified. The stoppage should be provided to Bandra-Bhusawal (Khandesh Express, train no. 19003/19004) at Vyara Station. The train bound for Uttar Pradesh and Bihar, Udhna-Varanasi train should be run on daily basis. Ahmedabad-Prayagraj Bandra-Patna,

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* Speech was laid on the Table

Hamsafar Express trains should be provided stoppage at Vyara Railway Station. An underpass should be constructed on Udhna Jalgaon railway line, L.C. Gate No.3, Chalthan Taluka, Palsana in the public interest because the city is situated on both sides of railway line. A new rail line should be laid by Koushamba to Umarpara converting narrow gauge railway line into broad gauge for which Rs. 20 lakhs were allocated in the rail budget of 2015-16. The construction work of Railway Bridge near Dastan railway crossing on Surat-Dhulia National Highway-53 has been stalled for a long period. It should be constructed immediately. An overbridge is required to be constructed over (Limbayat) railway line under South Eastern Railway Zone in the public interest. A new MEMU train from Surat to Nawapur via Vyara Taluka should be introduced. I support the Demands for Grants brought by the Hon'ble Minister.

***SHRIMATI SHARDA ANIL PATEL (MAHESANA):** Soon after the formation of his government, the Hon'ble Prime Minister, Shri Narendra Modi ji has taken a vow to strengthen the infrastructure. The latest example in this regard is 14.2 k.m. long "Zozila Tunnel", for which Prime Minister has laid foundation stone. This tunnel being constructed at the height of 3100 meter will provide all weather connectivity among Srinagar, Kargil and Leh Laddakh and 5 hours journey will be reduced down to 15 minutes. It is a golden picture of the process of building new India. The rail budget of 2019-20 will take the Indian Railways to new dimensions. I congratulate the Hon'ble Prime Minister and the Minister of Railways for their efforts made to strengthen the rail infrastructure and undertake development work speedily.

An overbridge is required to be constructed over railway track near M.N. College and APMC in my Lok Sabha constituency, Mahesana. This road having

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* Speech was laid on the Table

railway crossing is a very busy road in my constituency. This road is very useful for transportation towards APMC famous pilgrimage Ambaji and local educational institutions. When train passes through here, huge traffic remains on road resulting in waste of time.

Therefore, I would like to request the Ministry of Railways to ensure smooth transportation on the said road at the earliest.

***SHRI RAHUL KASWAN (CHURU):** I place my views on Demands for Grants of Railways.

First of all, I would like to thank the Hon'ble Prime Minister Shri Narendra Modiji and the Hon'ble Minister of Finance, Shrimati Nirmala Sitharaman who have presented a great budget by keeping every class in mind. This budget will certainly catapult India into the category of developed countries and it has the potential to increase Indian economy to 5 trillion dollar in the coming time.

Indian Railways is major mode of transport for the citizens of the country. Indian Railways is life line for the country. It is India's railway network which is the largest railway network in the world. But even today there any many major places in the country which are bereft of rail service. First of all, survey is conducted by the Railways for laying new rail time. More often than not, these areas are denied rail service by the Railways on the basis of ROR negative report in the survey. Similarly, a new rail line is required to be laid on Sardar shahar Sadulpur- Taranagar, Sardarshahar-Hanumangarh, Adampur-(ber) Bhadra and Sikar-Nakha Routes in my Lok Sabha constituency, but because of conducting survey many times, these areas are receiving negative

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* Speech was laid on the Table

RoR and these areas are still deprived of the rail services. These routes are very important even from the strategic and economic point of view. Therefore, I would like to request the Government to make changes in the policy and such areas, where freight is low and passenger footfalls are high, should be connected with rail facility keeping in view the public convenience.

The Government has created Rashtriya Rail Sauraksha Kosh to finance various works proposed to be undertaken. For want of level crossings in the rural areas, the villagers have to cross railway line for going to their fields and villages which is considered as illegal under the Railway Rules. The responsibility of constructing an under-bridge on rail line lies with the State Government, but the State Government shows its indifference to this need. Therefore, I would like to request the Government to include the construction of rail under-bridge and level crossings in the Rashtriya Rail Sanranksha Kosh keeping in view the said problem of farmers and villagers.

In my parliamentary constituency, the work relating to electrification on Sadulpur to Hanumangarh, Sadulpur to Bikaner, Rattangarh to Sardarshahar and Rattangarh to Dagana routes under North Western Railway is being undertaken. The Churu Lok Sabha constituency is very large in terms of area. This area is situated in the centre of Delhi, Sriganga Nagar, Bikaner and Jaipur. There will be a lot of rail traffic in future here. This area is backward also from the employment point of view. If EMU(Electrical Multiple Units) shed is opened in Churu Lok Sabha Constituency for maintenance of these trains, it will immensely benefit the public as well as railway and provide employment opportunities to local people. It is, therefore, requested to accord approval to open EMU shed at Sadulpar railway station for maintenance of electric engines. Regarding operation of new trains:- After gauge conversion, not a single direct express train is running from Sriganganagar to Jaipur and

from Sriganganagar to Delhi. Hence new trains need to be introduced for Sri Ganganagar-Jaipur (via Sadulpur, Churu, Sikar), Shri Ganganagar-Delhi (via Sadulpur, Rewari), Sri Ganganagar-Jodhpur (via Sadulpur, Churu, Dagana), Bikaner-Jaipur (via Ratangarh, Churu), Bikaner-Degana (via Ratangarh) and Jodhpur-Haridwar (via Ratangarh-Sadulpur). This will enable people of Churu, Sikar, Bikaner, Sriganganagar and Hanumangarh to get the facility of direct rail connectivity to Jaipur and Delhi. Regarding railway extension and stoppage:- There has bee a demand by the people of the area for a long time to extend the Churu-Ludhiana Exress train operated under the North Western Railway to Ratangarh, along with the stoppage of Tilak Bridge Fast Passenger train at all the stations after Nohar till Sadulpur and the stoppage of the Antodya Express train at Sighmukh station. Demand for this is being raised again and again by the people of my area. Providing these stoppages would also be appropriate considering the income of the Railways. Keeping the sentiments of the common people in view, the Churu-Ludhiana Express should be extended upto Ratangarh, The stoppage of the Antodaya Express should be provided at Sidmukh and the stoppage of Tilak Bridge fast passenger trains at all the stations after Nohar.

Regarding Construction and Strengthening of Platforms: Two additional platforms had long been sanctioned for construction at Sadulpur Junction under North Western Railway, but the work thereon has not been started as yet. Most of the trains have to be stopped at outer signal for a long period for want of platforms. As a result, the trains get delayed and a lot of problems are caused to passengers. Hence the said work should be started as early as possible after releasing required funds. The height of platforms built at Chhapar, padihara on Ratangarh- dagana section and Bhadara and Nohar railway stations on Sadulpur-Shriganganagar section is very low. Their height should be increased after strengthening them. The facilities relating to sheds and drinking water are

required to be provided at Ratangarh, Sujangarh, Churu, Sadulpur, Sardarshahar, Nohar, Bhadara, Chhapar, Padihara, Sidhmukh and Anupshahar railway stations in view of the shortage of passenger facilities. Therefore, I would like to request the Government to allocate additional funds for providing facilities of tin sheds and drinking water and others. Moreover, the additional budget should be allocated to extend these facilities available at 'A' class stations to "B" and "C" class stations. Regarding construction, Strengthening and Repair of Under-bridges: A demand is being made for a long time for construction of rail under-bridges at rail k.m. 60/45 between Bhukarka-Khinania railway stations for going to 79 RPM and other villages from Dhani Lalkhan in Nohar Tehsil under North Western Railway. It is also being demanded to construct rail under-bridges between 340/7 and 340/8 to the east of Rajaldheshar railway station on Ratangarh-Bikaner section and mid of 337/6-7 km between Bharpalsar and Bhravendeghar. The small under-bridge no. 10 constructed near Ratangarh cabin station on Ratangarh Sardarshahar section should be enlarged.

Besides, many rail under-bridges constructed on Sadulpur-Ratangarh, Sadulpur-Sriganganagar, Ratangarh-Bikaner and Ratangarh-Degana section in my parliamentary constituency get water logged during rainy season and ways to villages get blocked. Loss of life and property is caused to people. Many times, untoward incidents have taken place. To solve this problem, water from these bridges should be diverted, water should be drained out through borewell, sheds and tanks should be constructed and arrangements should be made for water harvesting for storage of water.

A rail under-bridge had been constructed at sadulpur near C-43 Sadulpur-Hanumangarh section but it could not be operated due to its wrong design and opposition by local people. In this regard, my suggestion is that status quo should be maintained in respect of C-43 and construction of the said under-

bridge should be completed by leveling it up by 3 feet in order to ensure smooth movement of small vehicles. There was a C-66 rail under-bridge at km. 115/1-2 on the South-East side of Bhadra railway station which was stopped later on. A proposal for construction of 4X5 meter rail under-bridge at the said kilometer was sent, which was not considered to be feasible by DMR, Bikaner. In this regard, I would like to suggest that an under-bridge of 4X3 meter (reducing the height) can be constructed on the said place with due cooperation of State Government. It is very important. The residents of Bhadrahas have long been raising demand for it . The Rail level crossing at C-24 the East of Sardarshahar Railway Station has been closed. In place of it, a rail under-bridge at C-42 to the west of above station should be constructed. This route connects Sardarshahar Bus Stand and city with many villages. The demand is being made in this regard for a long time. At present, rail under- bridge is being constructed by railway officials at C-24 which is not going to benefit common people and there is neither any inhabitation, nor any inhabitation is likely to come up because this land belongs to cowshed only. There is a railway level crossing Sardarshahar-Bikaner road route at the distance of only 200 meter from proposed rail under-bridge. There is no need to construct any rail-under bridge at this place. Therefore, this rail under-bridge should be constructed at k.m. 42 in the South West of the railway station for which people are making their demand.

Once again, I would like to express my thanks to the Hon'ble Prime Minister and the Hon'ble Minister of Finance for presenting this good budget.

***SHRI DEVAJI PATEL (JALORE):** While participating in the discussion, I support the demand for grants of Railways being presented in the first joint budget of Independent India.

'Jahan Na Pahunche Railgadi Wahan Pahunche Marwadi'

Even today, rail is the cheapest and easiest means of transport for short and long journeys in India. There is no other means of journey better than the railways for travelling from one corner to another in the country. Indian Railway is the life line of the country. Its contribution in the progress of the country is significant. The culture is the identity of civilization. It unites India. It provides lakhs of employment opportunities directly or indirectly. The role of railway right from the sphere of cinemas, stories, travelogue to economic sector is commendable. We can say that Indian Railway is the backbone of the country. Hon'ble Prime Minister Shri Narendra Modi had signalled to transform railway soon after the formation of the government. The hon. Prime Minister has aimed to make the railway backbone of the progress and economic development of the country.

I want to draw your attention towards the problems relating to my constituency Jalore Sirohi so as to enable the citizens of Jalore Sirohi to keep pace with the country. An announcement was made to connect Jalore Sirohi, Udaipur and Ambaji Abu Road with rail fine but the work in this regard has not been started so far. There is a magnificent temple of Sundha Mata ji in

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*Speech was laid on the Table

Jaswantpura in my parliamentary constituency Jalore Sirohi. This is 900 years old temple situated on a high hill. The idol of Mata Sundha ji has been installed in this temple. The first ropeway of Rajasthan is situated there. The temple of Sundha Mata ji is situated at a height of 850 meters where lakhs of devotees from all over the country come for 'Darshan'. The Lakhs of devotees have faith in Sundha Mata ji. You are, therefore, requested to name the Sabarmati Express 14819/20 originating from Bhagat Ki Kothi as Sundha Mata ji Express. The Chennai-Jodhpur Express Up-Down 16125/16126 covers the long distance spanning 3 days. A lot of inconvenience is caused to the passengers travelling by this train due to the non-availability of pantry car in this of long distance train. The facility of pantry car should be provided in this train and its frequency is also required to be increased. The Jalore district has not been connected so far with Jaipur Headquarters despite lapse of many decades since independence. This train(22478) originates from Jaipur at 6 a.m. and reaches Jodhpur at 10.40. This train remains stationed at Jodhpur throughout the day. This train can be extended 233 kms further up to Raniwara. It will immensely increase revenue of railway and the travelling upto Jaipur will become easy for the local people. Samdari-Bhilbi rail line under North Western Railway was converted into broad gauge about eight years ago but there is acute shortage of passenger facilities. The number of passenger trains being run on this route is negligible. About 7 lakh people of my parliamentary constituency Jalore Sirohi live in different cities of South India. Besides, lakhs of people of Barmer, Jaisalmer, Pali, Jodhpur districts also live there. They keep visiting Bengaluru, Chennai, Davangiri, Coimbatore, Hubli, Erode, Hyderabad for their business. But they have to face a lot of difficulties in the absence of direct rail service. All the tickets for the trains from Ahmedabad to South get booked as soon as the ticket window is opened. If this area is connected with South, it will increase the revenue of railway and provide a lot of facilities to the people. Therefore, at present, Jalore and Palanpur should be connected through direct

rail service. Rail service should be provided from Bengaluru, Hyderabad, Coimbatore and Chennai to Jodhpur via sandari-Bhildi. The DMU (79437/79438, 79431/79432) fast train originates at 5 a.m. from Abu Road and reaches Ahmedabad at 10 a.m. It originates at 3.30 p.m from Ahmedabad, and reaches Abu Road at 8.15 p.m. This train remains stationed at Abu Road throughout the night. If this train is extended upto Fhalna, then rural farmers and businessmen will get the facility to travel to Palanpur, Mahesana and Ahmedabad and it will also increase the revenue of the railway. There is no train for going to Jodhpur Medta Bikaner from Sawarupganj Railway Station. Bikaner Bandra Bikaner (14707/14708) always passes through Sawarupganj. There are inhabitants of 100 villages around Sawarupganj. The road route is very costly and inconvenient. The Bikaner- Bandra-Bikaner train should be provided stoppage at Sawarupganj Railway Station to facilitate the rural people. If Ashram Express (12915/12916) and Haridwar Mail (19105/19106) are provided stoppage at Sawarupganj Railway Station, it will provide a lot of facilities to the people. The first train ran in Jalore eight decades ago i,e. on 15th March, 1929. Today, there is population of more than 20 lakhs in Jalore Sirohi district, but passenger facilities have not been provided so far in the district. Sanchore is sub -division of the district which has been declared as international border area and is a very backward area. A survey was announced in the rail budget eight years ago but Sanchore has not been connected with rail service so far. The introduction of rail service here will increase employment opportunities. The local people will get the benefits of cheaper and confortable journey. It will connect main villages and towns of border area with the rail service and ensure movement of our army also.

***SHRI VISHNU DAYAL RAM (PALAMU):** Any expert, who knows the working of railway, will first say after going through the general budget of 2019- 20 that Hon'ble Minister of Finance has taken the right decision by not announcing introduction of any new rail in the budget proposals. Actually, there was a tendency during the last years that many Ministers of Railway used to announce introduction of new trains by making popular promises to gain political mileage while the infrastructure situation remained the same.

After coming to power at the Centre, the Government headed by Hon'ble Prime Minister, Shri Narendra Modi has checked this tendency of making popular promises of introduction of new trains. At present, the government pays its attention to lay new tracks. Hon'ble Minister of Finance, Shrimati Nirmala Sitharaman has stated in the budget also that development in the railway will take place on the basis of PPP model. An amount of Rs. 50 lakh crores is required to be invested during the period from 2019 to 2030 in order to strengthen the railway infrastructure. An amount of Rs. 50 lakh crores is required to be invested during the period from 2019 to 2030 for the development of railway infrastructure. Keeping this in view, capital outlay of railways ranges from Rs. 1.5 to 1.6 lakh crore annually. It will take many decades to complete all sanctioned projects. Therefore, railway has proposed to use PPP Model to accelerate development, to lay rail lines, to manufacture rolling stock and to deliver passenger, freight services. The sub urban service has been very successful in metros like Mumbai and Delhi. The Ministry of Railways will expand the sub urban railway through Special Purpose Vehicle. The investment will be made through PPP model for this service also. The sub urban and long distance services of Indian Railways are working well in the metros like Mumbai and smaller cities.The railways will be encouraged to

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*Speech was laid on the Table

invest more in suburban railways through the special purpose vehicle (SPV) like the proposed Rapid Regional Transport System (RRTS) on the Delhi-Meerut route and will complete the dedicated freight corridor part scheme by 2022 which will free the present railway network for passenger trains. To make the train journey comfortable and pleasant for the citizens, the modernization program of railway stations will be undertaken this year on a large scale. For the continuous expansion of metro network, a new metro train network, and a new metro train project of 300 Km stretch was sanctioned during 2018-19. At the same time operations on about 210 Km of metro lines has started in 2019. With this, about 657 Km of metro rail network is operational in the country.

Few of my suggestions for the Ministry of Railways are as follows- the topmost priority of the railways should be safety, security, punctuality and cleanliness; the operational ratio needs to be reduced; down- sizing of staff should be done; the railway board is top heavy which should be decreased; railways should not give the accounting work only to the officers of Indian Railway Account Services but should also appoint the officers from Indian Audit and Accounts Services on deputation; and CSO (Chief Safety Officers) should be Senior to GM rather than of equal rank.

It is a welcome step that the Government has decided to do away with the unmanned level crossings, but my request is that the sudden closing of railway RUB or crossings without any alternate arrangement (constructing RUB or ROB) is causing many problems to rural people. In my constituency Palamu (Jharkhand), the closing of many railway crossing has made the villages inaccessible. The closing of railway crossings like Dali, Panjrikala, Lalgarh etc is causing many problems to the rural people. I just want to draw your attention to the practical problems arising out of it and keeping the difficulty of people in mind and I want some alternate arrangement to solve this problem. I have a

suggestion in this regard that the problem can be solved to a great extent by constructing LHS at unmanned level crossing or places adjacent to it wherever possible. I am ready to provide some funds from my MP fund, if required, for the construction of LHS so that the transportation problem can be solved. The Transportation should be allowed to continue through the railway crossings till some alternate arrangements (construction of RUB or ROB) are made.

Along with this, I would like to present briefly some demands related to my constituency Palamu. The New Delhi-Ranchi Rajdhani Express should be run daily. Immediate attention should be paid on constructing broad gauge to Daltonganj via Rafiganj. 12877/12878 Ranchi-New Delhi Garib Rath via Barkakana-Daltonganj which runs 3 days a week should be run daily. 18613/18614 Ranchi-Chopan Express which runs 3 days a week to Barkakana should be run daily via Tori Lohardaga. 11447/11448 Howrah-Jabalpur Shakti Express daily train should be extended till Mumbai. The reservation quota for Daltonganj in 12453/12454 Ranchi-New Delhi Rajdhani Express which runs twice a week should be increased. 13025/13026 Howrah-Bhopal express weekly which was stopped due to the closing of Dhanbad-Chandrapura line should be started again as the services on Dhanbad-Chandrapura line has resumed. 18631/18632 Ranchi-Ajmer Garib Nawaj Express weekly should hava a halt at Banasthali Niwai because a lot of girls from here study there and have to return from Jaipur. Palamu Express should be provided halt at Rajhara, Karkata and Kajrat, Nawadih Stations. MMU should be run between Garhwa to Ranchi, Train No 14372/14371 (Triveni Link Express) should be extended upto Ranchi. Train No. 14372/14371 (Triveni Link Express) runs till Barwadih Chopan and get joined with Triveni Express in Chopan to run till Tanakpur via Lucknow, Bareilly. This train No 14372 (Triveni Link Express) starts from Chopan at 05.57 in the morning and reaches Barwadih at 10.30 am via Renukoot, wyndhamganj, Nagar Untari, Ramuna, Meral Gram, Garhwa, Rehla (Godhwa

Road), Daltonganj. This train remains stationed at Barwadih yard and starts at 13.00 hours the next day as 14371 up Triveni Link from Barwadih to Chopan. If this train 14372 is extended beyond Barwadih to Latehar, Tori (Chandwa) via Lohardaga to Ranchi then the people of Palamu, Gadhwa, Latehar will have the benefit of one more train to reach their capital Ranchi. Again this train should be started as 14371 Triveni Link Express in the morning form Ranchi then it would be the most useful utilization of this rake. In order to run this train from Chopan to Ranchi via Lohardaga, the railways will not require extra manpower.

In the end, I support the railway related demands. Thank you, Jai Hind.

***SHRI RAJU BISTA (DARJEELING):** There is a need for modernization of the New- Jalpaiguri Junction; It is a major Junction of North-east and North Bengal. Siliguri Town station is a historical railway station which was started in 1878 but now this station remains deserted. If major trains start halting at this station then load on NJP Station will decrease. The Gulma Railway station is at a distance of 15 Kms from NJP station and 3 Kms from Sukna Railway Station. If the Darjeeling Mail train is run between Gulma to Sealdah then it will be convenient for the common people and the tourists coming to Darjeeling and Sikkim, and local employment will also increase. If we talk about Railway crossings then there is an unmanned railway crossing at the Bagrakot station between ward no. 28 and ward no. 20 near the siliguri Town-Station. Thousands of people including school children risk their lives everyday. An underpass or a flyover should be constructed there. The entire Dooars is famous for its bio-diversity and animals like Elephant, Tiger, Bear, Leopard and Bison are found in large numbers. But, unfortunately, during the last five years, more than 500

***Speech was laid on the Table.**

animals especially Elephants have died after being run over by the trains. So, wild life corridor should be made from Siliguri in Darjeeling to Kokrajhar in Assam. The DHR was the first mountain train in the world to be recognized as the world heritage by the UNESCO in 1999. The damage caused by the landslide at the DHR Engine shed at Darjeeling Railway Station has not been repaired yet. The DHR workshop is continuously being ignored.

***SHRI JUGAL KISHORE SHARMA (JAMMU):** The NDA govt. was formed at the Centre with full majority in 2014 under the leadership of Narendra Modi ji and since then major changes have taken place in the Railways. There was a time when the railways was in a sorry state but now it is in good shape. Operation of trains like Vande Mataram is a clear example of this. Our Government is connecting the small and big cities of the country through railways because Hon'ble Speaker Sir, the overall development of a place is not possible if it lacks railway services. Then are many places in my constituency Jammu which are still not connected through railways,

I very well know the pain of not being connected through the Railway. Some places in my constituency are vey backward just because there is no rail facility, Hon'ble Speaker Sir, I am feeling very proud to say that the survey on laying of railway tracks from Jammu to Poonch has been completed. The NDA Government under the leadership of Narendra Bhai Modi ji was formed with the full majority at the Centre in 2014. There are many tourist and

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***Speech was laid on the Table.**

religious places in my constituency Jammu, Lakhs of People from the country and abroad come here everyday via trains as tourists and pilgrims.

Several major benefits including inclusion of the Jammu Station in my constituency in the list of Adarsh Railway station have been given for which, I would like to express my gratitude to the central government and Hon'ble Narendra Bhai Modiji.

With the blessings of Bhartiya Janata Party and the trust of the people of my constituency, I have been elected to this House again in the 17th Lok Sabha and the Government of Bhartiya Janata Party under the leadership of Narendra Bhai Modiji has again been formed at the Centre.

I would like to draw the attention of the Ministry of Railways towards my constituency, Jammu wherein there are many places where,accidents happen regularly due to lack of Railway over bridge or under-bridge. A Railway over bridge or under bridge should be constructed immediately in places like Chak Bajalta, Vijaypur, Samba. The work done at the Jammu station during the last five years is quite good and more needs to be done. Two more escalators need to be installed and three new platforms should be constructed immediately. The shortcomings with regard to the security of the Jammu Railway Station need to be mitigated. The walls of the Station are broken and CCTV cameras are few and the ones which are installed do not work.

The Ministry of Railways in the past five years has done many development works related to railways. They have taken Railways to new cities. I would like to express my gratitude for considering the demand of the

people of Rajouri, Poonch and completing the survey on laying of railway track from Jammu to Poonch. Now, I would request the Hon'ble Minister to allocate funds in the budget to start the work of laying of railway track from Jammu to Poonch so that the people of Akhnoor, Naushera, Rajouri and Poonch could also benefit from railways and the people of this region can commute to Jammu and other parts of the country through trains.

Thank you.

***SHRI PASHUPATI NATH SINGH (DHANBAD):** I support the railway budget 2019-20 presented by the Hon'ble minister of railways. Special attention has been paid towards the convenience of common people in this budget and there has been no hike in the railway fare or freight charges amidst the rising inflation. The vision and skilled leadership of Hon'ble Prime Minister Shri Narendra Modiji is reflected in the Railway budget. It will boost the development of the Country. On the suggestion of the Hon'ble Prime Minister, the railways is working on finding other sources to increase the railway revenue instead of increasing the freight charges and fare.

There are many provisions in the railway budget for modernisation and development of railways.

Work is going on to stop the encroachment on railway land since 30 years but still 2033 hectares of land is under illegal occupation and 159323

***Speech was laid on the Table.**

cases have been filed in the courts regarding encroachment and 39733 cases are still going on related to this in courts. These encroachments are mainly in the cities and it is very dangerous from the railway security point of view and Northern railways is more affected with 1145 cases of encroachment. Railway officers are also involved in the illegal encroachments.

The freight volume of railways is increasing by 3.2 percent and the railways income from freight is increasing by 8% rate. The income from freight in the total revenue of railway is 66% out of which the share of coal and fertilisers is about 45% and 3.7% respectively. It is often seen that the farmers need Urea during the sowing season but it keeps lying in the railway godowns and becomes useless. It does not reach the destination. Likewise there are many industries which require coal but don't get it on time due to which their factories remain closed for days. The railway wagons go fully loaded, but return empty. Thus, the railway wagons are not being utilised fully. The shortage of wagons is also not being addressed. The income of railways will increase by properly utilising the railway lines.

The railways has 10.65 lakh acre of land out of which 10% i.e 1.13 lakh acres of land is lying useless, and 3760 acres of land has been used commercially and the rest is still lying vacant. The Government says that it will be used in the future railway projects but it should be used in the interest of the nation at present.

Regarding the railway development of my constituency, Dhanbad I demand that a train from Dhanbad to New Delhi should be started; the Hatia-Yashwantpur Express should be extended till Dhanbad; new train service from Dhandbad to Ahmedabad should be started; the trains which halt at the border station of Bengal should also halt at the border station of Jharkhand; passenger trains should be started from Gomo station to Asansol with 10 rounds daily; Passenger trains with 10 rounds from Bokaro via Bhojudih should be started; the work of laying of railway line from Bhojudih to Bokaro via Chandankiyari Chas should be completed; Express trains should halt at Chas station; the work of sanctioned plan of laying railway line from Dhanbad to Giridih should be completed; Bokaro should be made rail division or else it should be connected with Adra chhod Dhanbad or Ranchi division; a new zone consisting of Divisions of Jharkhand region, and Dhanbad, Chakradharpur should be created in Jharkhand by excluding Adra Railway.

I support the Demand of grants by the government.

[English]

[*]**DR. SUBHAS SARKAR (BANKURA) :** I would like to thank Shrimati Nirmala Sitharaman, Minister of Finance and Shri Piyush Goyal, Minister of Railway for such a citizen friendly visionary Budget.

[*] Speech was laid on the Table.

But any opposition leader and Member have not uttered a single sentence that this Budget has not given any burden on passenger fare.

I would like to place the following demands for Jangal Mahal area of West Bengal, Chhatna – Mukutmanipur Railpath – 48 km; Year of sanction 2005-2006; Purulia – Jhargram – Railpath ; Bishnupur – Tarakeswar; Bowaichandi – Khana Jn. and Escalator at Bankura Jn.

[Translation]

***SHRI KRISHNAPALSINGH YADAV (GUNA):** My Constituency is backward from the railway point of view. There is no direct train from Ashok Nagar of my constituency to Delhi. First, we have to go to Gwalior or Bhopal and then take a train from there to Delhi. The main demands for my constituency are: There was a train from Jabalpur-Indore but it has been stopped now. I request you to immediately start this train again. Funds have been allocated for construction of railway under bridge in Ashok Nagar district headquarters but the work has not started yet; there is no passenger waiting room at Ashok Nagar Railway Station till date and the modernisation of Ashok Nagar railway Station is very much needed; the survey of Sawai Madhopur -Shivpuri- Jhansi railway line has been completed but work has not started there yet. It is very necessary to start the work at the earliest; an under bridge or over bridge should be constructed on Guna-Bamori Road; the primary survey of Piprai-Lalitpur rail line has been completed but here also no work has started yet. The budget of 395.52 crore rupees for the 80 km rail line to connect Piprai and Lalitpur via Chanderi should be allocated soon; Super fast train should be started from Ashok Nagar to Delhi: an underbridge or over bridge should be constructed on Gram Shadhora railway crossing; work on around 348 Km long 'Guna-Etawah via Shivpuri-Gwalior-Bhind new rail line has not started yet; Various trains passing from Guna-Bina railway division have been stopped temporarily by the railway

department which is causing a lot of difficulty to the people of this region. The trains which have been temporarily stopped in this division are as follows:-

SL.NO	Train Name & No.	Present Status
1.	Train –up 59341 Nagda-Bina Train-down 59342 Bina-Nagda	Has been temporarily stopped from Guna to Bina
2.	Train-up 11701 Jabalpur-Indore Intercity Train-down 11702 Indore-Jabalpur Intercity	Has been temporarily Stopped for 1½ year from Guna to Bina
3.	Train-up 19659 Shalimar-Udaipur Express Train-down 19660 Udaipur-Shalimar Express	No stoppage at Ashok Nagar district headquarters

So, keeping in view the problem of the common people the above trains should be started as early as possible and given stoppage at Ashok Nagar district headquarters which is very necessary.Till now, only VVIP candidates were elected from my constituency Guna. But, unfortunately there has been no development in my constituency in railway sector along with other developmental works. I request you to pay special attention to my demands so that the people of my constituency can also benefit.

***PROF. S. P SINGH BAGHEL (AGRA):** I support the Demand for Grants on the Railway Budget.

I thank Hon'ble Prime Minister and Hon'ble Railway Minister Piyush Goyal ji for this public welfare Budget.

I demand that the circulating area of the Agra Cantt. Railway Station should be extended and second entry and exit should be provided towards Sarai Khwaja; Various technical training and courses like signal, Telecommunication, Gangman, Trolleyman, Pointman etc should be started in multidisciplinary training centre of railways in Gadhapada, Belanganj in Agra; Over bridge should be constructed at Shahganj Arjun Nagar in Agra, Tin Shed should be installed near the side bridge of Chamunda Devi at the Rajamandi railway station. Beautification of Agra city station should be done and reservation centre should be provided. Escalators should be installed at Firozabad and Tundla railway Stations so that the senior citizens get relief, the long pending budget lying with railway board for the beautification of Tundla

railway station should be released. Train no 04191/04/92 Etah- Agra fort passenger special, which was stopped in November 2017, should be restarted; Submersible Pump boring for drinking water should be installed at Barhan railway junction. In addition to these, the arrangements for passengers and

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* Speech was laid on the Table.

waiting room should be made available, Puri and Sangam Express should be provided stoppage at Barhan Junction railway station; the Rajdhani Express (Train No-222 222/222 221) which runs from Nijamuddin to Mumbai should be provided stoppage at Agra Cantt. Station every day; Prayagraj express (Train No 12417/12418) running from Allahabad to New Delhi should be provided stoppage at Tundla Junction; Muri Express (Train No-8101/8102) and (Train No 4114/4164) Sangam Express should have a stoppage at Barhan Junction; Vande Bharat Express train should have a stoppage at Tunda Junction and Lucknow - New Delhi Gomati Express (Train No12419/12420) should have a stoppage at Jalesar Road Station.

[English]

***DR. SUBHASH RAMRAO BHAMRE (DHULE):** Indian Railways (IR) is one of the world's largest rail networks with 67,368 route kilometres of route length. It has 61,680 Route kms. of broad gauge, 3479 kms. of metre gauge and 2209 kms of narrow gauge as on 31st March, 2017. With it's more than 150 years old history, Indian Railways is a State owned public utility of the Government of India under the Ministry of Railways. As a national common carrier transporting passenger and goods over its vast network, Indian Railways have always played a key role in India's social and economic development. It is a cheap and affordable means of transportation for millions of passengers. As a carrier of bulk freight viz. ores and minerals, iron and steel, cement, mineral oils, food grains and fertilizers, containerized cargo etc., the importance of Indian Railways for agriculture, industry and the common man is well recognized. On an average, Indian Railways carried 22.24 million passengers and 3.04 million tonnes of freight each day.

Rail infrastructure would need an estimated investment of Rs. 50 lakh crore between 2018-2030. PPS will be used to help with faster development and completion of tracks, rolling stock manufacturing, and delivery of passenger freight services. Indian Railways will be encouraged to invest more in suburban railways through Special Purpose Vehicle structures such as the Rapid Regional Transport System proposed on the Delhi- Meerut route.

* Speaker was laid on the Table.

Transit Oriented Development will be encouraged to ensure commercial activity around transit hubs. To make railway travel a pleasant and satisfying experience for the common citizen, a massive railway station modernisation programme will be launched this year. In 2019-20, the gross budgetary support from central government is proposed at Rs 66,105 crore. This is a 25% increase from the revised estimates of 2018-19 (Rs 53,060 crore). Budget Estimates under Gross Traffic Receipts for the year 2019-20 have been placed at 2,16,675 crore involving an increase of Rs. 19,961 crore over the Revised Estimates 2018-19. The targeted increase is 10.1%. While the passenger earnings at Rs 56,000 crore are based on a 2.9% growth in originating passengers, the goods earnings at Rs 1,43,000 crore are keeping in view an incremental loading of 58 million tonnes of revenue earnings freight and an average freight lead of 564 kilometres. Railways has got a budgetary allocation of Rs 65,837 crore and the highest ever outlay for capital expenditure amounting to Rs. 1.60 lakh crore from Union Finance Minister Smt. Nirmala Sitharaman in her Budget. Last year, the outlay for the railways was Rs 1.48 lakh crore while the Budget allocation was Rs. 55,088 crore.

In the budget, funds of Rs 7,255 crore have been allocated for construction of new lines, Rs 2,200 crore for gauge conversion, Rs 700 crore for doubling, Rs 6,114.82 crore for rolling stock and Rs 1,750 crore for signaling and telecom. Complete elimination of unmanned level crossings on Broad Gauge network has been achieved in 2018-19. Now, the national transporter is aiming to eliminate all 2,568 manned level crossings, present on

Golden quadrilateral and diagonal routes in mission mode by building ROBs/ RUBs. The electrification of Indian Railways' broad gauge network will be done by 2021-22. In 2019-20, 7000 route kilometres has been targeted for electrification. Also, for 2019-20, the target of new lines, doubling ‘tripling, gauge conversion, etc. is 3750 kilometres as against 3596 kms. in the last financial year. In a bid to enhance safety, create additional capacity and increase train efficiency, the Railway Budget 2019 also talked about introducing an Automatic Train Protection (ATP) system using a mix of European Train Control System as well as an indigenously developed system.

Indian Railways has launched a massive programme for modernization of railway stations, making railway travel a pleasant and satisfying experience for passengers. The railways has also introduced fully indigenous semi high-speed Train 18 under 'Make in India'. Indian Railways is providing free Wi-Fi at all railway stations (excluding halt stations) in a bid to improve rail travel experience and bridge the digital divide between urban and rural India. So far, the facility has been provided at 1,603 stations and the remaining 4,882 stations are targeted for the provision by 31 August 2019. Indian Railways to provide CCTV cameras at all stations (excluding halt stations) as well as in trains to enhance the safety of passengers. So far, CCTV cameras have been provided at 455 railway stations and the balance stations are targeted by 2020-21. Similarly, CCTV cameras have been provided at 1,203 coaches and the rest of the passenger carrying coaches are targeted by 2021-22. The Railway Budget 2019 said to launch a scheme of Integrated Skill Development, where

all 13 lakh railway employees will be given a foundational training. The programme will focus on 3Cs- Customer, Cost, and Work Culture. The employees, who demonstrate high learning agility, as well as greater skill mastery, shall be offered an Advanced Program.

The Indian Railways has witnessed tremendous growth in the first innings of the Modi government, registering the best ever performance in the areas of rail safety and modernisation.The Railways managed to go from a state-run operation, ignorant to the needs of the passengers and obstinate to change, to sleek, comfortable and consumer-friendly. Customer service has undergone a major change. The Railways has built a robust customer-interface ecosystem across social media platforms. Real-time complaint redressal is now just a message away. Instances of people getting diapers or medical help delivered on moving trains with just a tweet are part of this success story.UPA government shied away from finalising the Ahmedabad-Mumbai Bullet Train project, the NDA government lost no time in approving it. It advanced the deadline by a year to 2022 as Prime Minister Modi took his Japanese counterpart Shinzo Abe to Ahmedabad to lay the foundation stone for the project. The land acquisition process has started, and the project is on course.The induction of modern, engine-less train sets, the first proper rolling stock upgrade since the LHB coaches in India, will happen later this year.The

NDA government spent the last five years on long-term infrastructure building in railways. Laying of second, third and fourth lines on the busy routes to enhance network capacity and bringing in Northeast connectivity through broad-gauge conversion have been top on the government's to-do list.

Railways Budget 2019-20 Summary

■ **Table 3: Railways Revenue and Expenditure for 2019-20 (in Rs. Crore)**

		2017-18 Actuals	2018-19 Budget	2018-19 Revised	% Change (2018-19RE/ 2018-19BE)	2019-20 Budget	% Change (2019-20BE/ 2018-19RE)
	Receipts						
1	Passenger	48,643	52,000	52,000	0%	56,000	8%
2	Freight	1,17,055	1,21,950	1,29,750	6%	1,43,000	10%
3	Other traffic sources	13,027	26,890	14,964	-44%	17,675	18%
4	**Gross Traffic Receipts (1+2+3)**	**1,78,725**	**2,00,840**	**1,97,214**	**-2%**	**2,16,675**	**10%**
5	Miscellaneous	204	250	500	100%	260	-48%

6	**Total Internal Revenue (4+5)**	**1,78,930**	**2,01,090**	**1,97,214**	**-2%**	**2,16,935**	**10%**
	Expenditure						
7	Ordinary Working Expenses	1,28,947	1,38,000	1,41,000	2%	1,55,000	10%
8	Appropriation to Pension Fund	45,798	47,500	47,300	0%	50,000	6%

9	Appropriation to Depreciation Reserve Fund	1,540	500	500	0%	500	0%
10	**Total Working Expenditure (7+8+9)**	**1,75,834**	**1,86,000**	**1,88,800**	2%	**2,05,500**	9%
11	Miscellaneous	1,430	2,100	2,400	14%	2,400	0%
12	**Total Revenue Expenditure (10+11)**	**1,77,264**	**1,88,100**	**1,91,200**	2%	**2,07,900**	9%
13	**Net Surplus (6+12)**	**1,666**	**12,990**	**6,014**	-54%	**9,035**	50%
14	Appropriation to Development Fund	1,506	1,000	1,000	0%	1,000	0%
15	Appropriation to Capital Fund	-	6,990	14	-100%	3,035	21579%
16	Appropriation to Debt				-	-	-

	Service Fund						
17	Appropriation to Railway Safety Fund	160	-	-		-	
18	Appropriation to Rashtriya Rail Sanraksha Kosh	-	5,000	5,000	0%	5,000	-
19	**Operating Ratio**	**98.4%**	**92.8%**	**96.2%**		**95.0%**	

***SHRIMATI SUMALATHA AMBAREESH (MANDYA):** The Indian Railway's contribution to national integration has been unparalleled. It has knit India together by connecting all the regions, and almost all the states, in a single transport network. Railways is serving all the sections of the society. It focuses on the underprivileged and the poor, and also it serves the more fortunate. It has always played a unique role in meeting the transportation needs of the common man, while simultaneously serving as a critical infrastructure facilitator for the carriage of goods. The Budget Speech of the hon. Finance Minister Indicates that the railway is moving towards privatization. We have proposed world-class railways stations. A lot has been told about it but in reality, world-class railway stations are not progressing in a very fast mode. The occupancy rate of the super quality trains like Palace on Wheels, Maharaja Express, Golden Chariot, Royal Rajasthan on Wheels and Deccan Odyssey has come down to less than 30 per cent. The NDA government has attached top priority for significance by emphasizing on "Swachh Bharat" initiative. However, cleanliness in Indian Railways is still a distant dream. Even though several initiatives have been taken by the government towards improvement of cleanliness in coaches it is not sufficient.

I would like to point out that INDIAN RAILWAYS is the premier transport organization of the country with the largest rail network in Asia and the world's third largest under one management.

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* Speech was laid on the Table.

But the ONE MANAGEMENT failed to notice the unhygienic condition of the compartments, worst toilets and food served to the public who pay quite a sum and suffers the lack of basic needs on long journeys in the train with tolerance. India claims having considerable high technologies but no effort taken or couldn't think of a way on the lavatory systems improved.

There is an urgent need to create more awareness of hygiene, cleanliness and the usage of public toilets with concern. There are huge complaints regarding cleanliness in coaches and foul smell from toilets. The compartments are very old. Toilets basically are unhygienic and disgusting in all compartments.There is no sufficient water. There is no health faucet in all new AC and non-AC coaches. No provision made for dustbins in Sleeper coaches and ordinary coaches. Foul smell in bio-toilets is unbearable. 'Coach Mitra' facility is there but no end to the problems. The railway has to improve cleaning standards further as there are huge complaints regarding cleanliness in coaches and foul smell from toilets. So these issues must be addressed immediately. Though it is expected to be cleaned at every other station, but the cleaners just flush out water and fill the tanks. It has not been brushed nor anti detergent applied for ages and it's unbearable. The compartments are very old. It has not been refurbished time to time. The window panels are dusty. The cleaners just flip with a wiper just for the sake of cleaning at every few stations when the train stops. Forget about the idea of sightseeing views.

I urge upon the Government to conduct a third party survey for assessment of cleanliness in all the railway stations and trains. And also take necessary measures to upgrade the facilities in the trains and railway stations. Regular inspections at various levels should be carried out and deficiencies are made good whenever noticed. Suitable action is taken against the contractors who are found wanting in the performance of their duties.

As far as transference is concerned Hon'ble Prime Minister, Shri Narendra Modi Ji's Government has focused on people of India and has become a Government accountable to every farmer, youth, poor, middle class and all those who have relations of any kind with this government. I welcome this as it is the responsibility of any Government to showcase its report card to public every year. I appreciate the steps taken by the NDA government in this regard. Rail Drishti Dashboard has been launched to make people of India aware of the projects going-on in Railways. The customer or railway passenger will get an exposure through this dashboard to the multifaceted transformation underway in Indian Railways across the country.

The Indian Railways are the country's largest employers with regard to employment opportunities are concerned. I would like to point out that women are not recruited in adequate number in the Indian railways. As far as employment of the women is concerned, the number of women employees in the Indian Railways is very insignificant. As per the available reports, around 3,650 women candidates have been given employment in the Indian Railways in technical categories in the last three years. It is very small in comparison to

men.It is learnt from the available reports of the Government that against notifications issued for various technical posts, a total of 2,79,60,224 applications were received. Out of these, only 46,76,928 (16.73%) applications were from women.

Therefore, I would like to suggest the government that wide publicity is given to railway recruitment notifications and every candidate, irrespective of gender, etc. fulfilling eligibility criteria is free to apply.Apart from this the government should scrap the application fee for women applicants. As of now the examination fee is collected from women candidates and it will be refunded to those who appear in the examination. I would like to suggest that the fee for women candidates should be scrapped to encourage more women candidate to apply for the posts notified by the Government.I would like to point out that the provisions of separate rest rooms, cloak rooms for women are made in all the railway stations of two tiers and three tier cities and towns also.

As far as E-catering services to passengers is concerned E-catering was started by IRCTC of Indian Railways in 2015 for trains without pantry and allows customers to order food online to be delivered at their seat from the list of over 500 partner restaurants including Domino's Pizza, Comesum, railrestr, and at some stations Haldiram and McDonald/s empanelled by the Government.

As per the information available, the revenue earned from the e-catering venture is less than the expenditure. In fact, the highest expenditure of Rs 3.9 crore was made in the year 2017-18 on e catering by the Indian Railways but

earned only Rs 1.8 crore. As per the reports the train passengers are not happy with the e-catering service as the quality and taste of the food is not good and also it is very expensive.

Therefore, I would like to request the Hon'ble Minister for Railways to kindly look into the e-catering service to ensure better quality food is served and also it should not incur loss to the exchequer of the Government.As far as the safety of train journey is concerned, since the last budget was announced, nearly 78 people have died in railway accidents across the country.While the railway ministry has repeatedly promised heavy investments into ensuring greater safety, continued accidents point to loopholes in the existing infrastructure plugging which could result in fewer tragedies. The government is yet to come close to its target of eliminating 4,267 unmanned railway crossings by 2020.

Indian Railways is the fourth largest network in the world, despite that it is yet to expand to welcome more passengers aboard from the different regions of the country. Several areas of the country still don't have easy access to trains. There are several existing railway lines which do not have adequate infrastructure to meet the growing demands for railways services of the people.Therefore, I would like to request the hon'ble minister to expedite the works pertaining to Conversion of entire railway network into broad gauge, Chalk out plan for doubling, third and fourth line woks of the railway lines as per increasing traffic of railways.

As far as redevelopment of railway stations is concerned still a large number of stations are not considered for the redevelopment. And there is no significant progress made in the installation of escalators at railway stations. As far as women passengers are concerned I would like to urge upon the Government to introduce a separate train for women commuters between Bangalore and Mysore railway line.

I also request to add more coaches to the existing trains to accommodate more passengers on the railway line between Bangalore and Mysore. It would be great help to people of my Parliamentary constituency Madya, which is situated between both the cities Bangalore and Mysore. Another railway line Kengeri (Hejjala) to Chamarajanagara via Kanakapura, Malavalli, Kollegala, was sanctioned in 1996. However it is still crawling due to paucity of funds and other issues. The project secured approval almost five years ago, but there is no budgetary support has been given to it. Against the estimated cost of Rs. 1,382 crore, it has received only Rs.10 crore by way of funding. There is no significant support for this new railway line. Hence I urge upon the Government to allocate and release adequate fund to expedite the project, it will bring vast parts of the Cauvery basin in the state of Kanakapura including commercial centres like Kankapura,, Malavalli and Kollegal, on the railway map of India.

Apart from this, Suburban Rail project should be taken up on priority. Bangalore has an estimated population of 12.34 million in its urban area in 2017, up from 8.5 million in 2011. The fastest growing Bangalore urban district

is crying out for an infrastructure of both rail and road. Bangalore city has added six times more people than neighboring Chennai in the last decade. There is an urgent need to implement the Suburban rail project. I would also request to allocate sufficient funds for the suburban rail project to decongest the roads in Bangalore city.The Union Government has proposed for construction of New Metro Rail Projects for a total route length of 300 kilometers during 2018-19. It is also a bold step taken by the Government for increasing the Metro Rail network in the country. I urge upon the Union Government to look into these demands and take all necessary steps to address them at the earliest.

*DR. HEENA VIJAYKUMAR GAVIT (NANDURBAR): I would like to first of all congratulate the Hon'ble Minister of Railways for changing the face and pace of Indian Railways under the visionary leadership of Prime Minister Shri Narendra Modiji. After getting elected as an M.P. of Nandurbar, the major projects undertaken taken by me are of Railways. I represent a tribal area and the work of Railways was a game changer for us. When for the first time the Railway Budget was implemented in Modi 1.0 Government, the most important doubling work and electrification work of the Surat Bhusaval Line which was pending for ages, got funds of Rs. 550 crores. I am happy to share that today this work is completed and functioning. The inauguration of this double line was done by the Prime Minister Modiji. Today, I also wish to share that the long standing demand of Nandurbar was starting of train from Nandurbar to Mumbai. This was also fulfilled by the Government during its last tenure and Khandesh Express was started. This train runs thrice a week. I request the Hon'ble Railway Minister to make this train daily as there is demand from my constituents. The train runs in full strength and it is also difficult to get tickets. This itself shows that this train is like a 'life line' for Nandurbar.

Also there is a demand for starting of a new train to Pune from Nandurbar. There are thousands of students from Nandurbar constituency who live and study in Pune. So, if a 'NEW TRAIN' is started, it will facilitate the people of Nandurbar constituency who want to travel to Pune as Pune is an educational hub. I also would like to request the Hon'ble Railway Minister if the

* Speech was laid on the Table.

demand of the stoppages of Railways of my constituency is fulfilled, it will benefit passengers of my constituency. At Nandurbar Railway Station, if an elevator is made available, it will benefit the senior citizens and handicapped persons. I congratulate the Minister and Government for bringing in new modernised technologies in Railways.

[Translation]

***SHRI SUDARSHAN BHAGAT (LOHARDAGA):** First of all, I would like to thank Hon'ble Finance Minster for presenting the budget dedicated to improvement and expansion of Indian railways.

Railways is the major mode of transport in the country. Specific efforts have been made during the last five years to make it useful for public, to make the travel easy and safe, to make railways reach difficult regions for freight transportation. Under the leadership of Hon'ble Modiji, many railway stations were beautified after being identified as "Model Railway Station" out of which Lohardaga railway station in my constituency was developed as model Railway Station for which I would like to thank you on behalf of Lohardaga and the people of Jharkhand.

I represent the tribal dominated Lohardaga Parliamentary Constituency of Jharkhand. This region abounds in agriculture and natural resources including forest produce. It is known for agriculture based life style. The prosperous cultural heritage is its identity. Agriculture is the main source of income for people of this region and the people of this region go to other states and cities also for jobs and business. Railway is an important mode of transport for the students going for higher education, patients going for the treatment and for the farmers going to the mandis. Due to the lack of trains,

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*Speech was laid on the table.

material related to mining have to be transported by trucks which is causing pollution and other problems to the local people.

I would like to specially mention that there are lot of possibilities/scope for small sacle and cottage industries in my constituency and nearby areas due to the availability of vegetables through agricultural works, availability of coal and bauxite as natural resources , man power, interest of the youth towards sports. If this area is connected through train services, then this area can also be developed. It is particularly important to connect Gumla district by train services. As it is a major district of Jharkhand and it also borders two other states (Chattisgarh and Odisha).

I request to pay special attention to my constituency through the ongoing discussion being held on the demand for grants of the Ministry of Railways for the budget 2019-20. In the interest of the public, I think the following points are most important for the development of this region: Ranchi New Delhi-Ranchi Rajdhani express should run via Lohardaga at least twice a week. It is very important to connect Gumla by trains, so Ranchi-Lohardaga-Gumla-Jashpur-Korba railway can be connected so that Bauxite and other minerals can be transported through the use of this railway line. Ranchi-Lohardaga-Turi railway line should be electrified as well as doubled. Train No 58659 Hatia- Raurkela Passenger should be operated upto Lohardaga; Train No-13320 Ranchi Deoghar Baijnath Dham Intercity express should be operated upto Lohardaga.

It is my responsibility to tell you on this occasion that the developmental works done by the Govt. under the leadership of Hon'ble Prime Minister Shri Narendra Modi Ji have good effect on the tribal dominated regions. They have got access to banks through bank accounts opened under the Jan Dhan Yojana, houses have been provided to the rural people on large scale under the Pradhan Mantri Awas Yojna, record number of toilets have been constructed in the country under the Swacch Bharat Abhiyan,the budget of Ministry of Tribal Affairs has been increased for the welfare of tribals in order to pave the way for opening 'Eklavya Adarsh Awasiya Vidyalyas' in every tribal dominated blocks. Special efforts have been made for the welfare of farmers and promotion of agriculture. New job opportunities have been created for the youth through skill developments and other means. So, I support this development-oriented railway budget. This budget will play a significant role in fulfilling the vision of 'New India'.

I request the Govt. to pay maximum attention to the extremism affected tribal areas so that the living standard of people living here may improve and they may contribute in nation building process by playing their part in the mainstream for the development of the country. So I would like to include the above demands through the discussion on the demands for grants under the Ministry of Railways for the budget 2019-20.

***SHRI RAJENDRA DHEDYA GAVIT (PALGHAR):** I come from Maharashtra. Since my constituency is near Mumbai, it is more sensitive particularly for railway passengers. Lakhs of passengers come to Mumbai every day.By noticing the crowd in the trains, it seems that people from the entire country are travelling in Mumbai trains for job, business, education and other works. There is a need to increase the number of local trains particularly women trains originatining from Mumbai. Many problems arise due to the overcrowding in local trains. Out of which the major problems are: safety of women , cleanliness of toilets, to provide reserved seat for senior citizen and pregnant women etc. Providing these failities are very necessary. Many trains pass via Virar, Palghar, Vodsar but the passengers have to face a lot of difficulties due to nonstoppage of many important trains and the burden falls on the other stations and it results in unnecessary crowding in local trains. The safety of train passengars particularly women and children is very sensitive matter.

There is a need of special recruitment drive for filling the vacancies reserved for scheduled castes, scheduled tribes and other backward classes in railways. It is aiso very important to increase the number of coaches in local trains. Incidents of irregularities in railway reservation keeps surfacing, it needs to be checked. Providing medical facilities at railway station and in trains should be made compulsory. It is aiso important to modernise railway station and railway colonies. In this Budget, emphasis has been given on passenger facility and PPP model. I request the Hon'ble Minister that its implementation is

very critical. Attention should be paid to house keeping in railway and fixing norms for hygienic food or quality of food. Fertilizers and food grains are transported through the railway stations during monsoon and these suffer extensive damage due to lack of sheds. So, it is very important to have shed and flooring on rake points .

I again congratulate the Hon'ble railway Minister for this budget and support the demand for grants of railway budget 2019-20.

***SHRIMATI KESHARI DEVI PATEL (PHULPUR):** I am an elected Member of Parliament of Bhartiya Janata Party from Phulpur Lok Sabha Constituency of Prayagraj district which is most populated district of the entire Uttar Pradesh. I would like to draw the attention of the Government and Hon'ble railway minister to the short comings related to the railway in Prayagraj district and would like to give the following suggestions in public interest and I would request you to include these suggestions in the budget discussion of Ministry of Railways.

Allahabad-Duranto runs thrice a week from Prayagraj district. This train is being discontinued which is not right. Kindly reintroduce this train. A new train (Humsafar Express) has been started from Prayagaraj to New Delhi. This train has all AC 3 tier coaches and this is operated under the flexi fare rule of

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*Speech was laid on the table

the railways . General Coaches may be attached in this train and flexi fare rule should be an discontinued. Prayagraj is an important junction not only in Uttar Pradesh but also in India, but there are many trains which do not have stoppages at this junction. The Sealdah Rajdhani express, New Delhi Kolkata Duronto Express, Bhubaneshwar Rajdhani Express etc are important trains which do not stoppage at Allahabad junction. Please ensure that all trains passing through Allahabad junction may halt at Allahabad junction and quota of seats should be fixed for this junction. There is a large number of passenger who travel between Prayagraj and Indore and the railways has also acknowledged the same and keeping this in view a Special train from Prayagraj to Indore has been started by the railways. The above Indore train should be regularized. There is a also a huge number of passengers who travel from Prayagraj to Mumbai; and so from this point of view, Allahabad-Mumbai Duranto express is being run from Allahabad to Mumbai which is twice a week only. The Allahabad-Mumbai Duranto Express should be run daily.

Lucknow is the capital of Uttar Pradesh and the Headquarters of many state level departments is in Prayagraj district. There is a large number of people travelling from Prayagraj to Lucknow and Lucknow to Prayagraj. So Shatabdi Express from Prayagraj to Lucknow may be run and if the above shatabdi express should be extended till Bareilly, then a major problem of the people of Prayagraj will be solved. The Ganga-Kaveri Express is an important

train which connects Prayaraj to south India and it is running for several years. The above train runs only twice a week and the quota of seats for this train from Prayagraj is very negligible. There is no direct air connectivity from Prayagraj to South India. So the Ganga-Kaveri Express should run daily and the berth quota of Prayagraj should be increased. The Ganga-Gomati Express was running from the Allahabad junction for Prayagraj to Lucknow for years but the operation of this train was changed from Allahabad junction to Prayagghat Junction few months back which is causing inconvenience to the people of Prayagraj. I request the Hon'ble railway Minister that if there is problem in operating the Ganga-Gomati express from Allahabad junction due to lack of space then this train may be operated from the newly constructed Subedarganj station. The Government of Hon'ble Yogi ji has changed the name of Allahabad to Prayagraj in Uttar Pradesh, which is a matter of pride for the people of Prayagraj. The name of the district has been changed but it is still known as Allahabad district in the railway department. Subedarganj railway station has been constructed in Praygaraj for the convenient train journey. The name Subedarganj creates confusion. So the name of Allahabad Junction may be changed to Prayagraj junction and that of Subderganj Station may be changed to Prayagraj cantt. or any other name connected with Prayagraj.

The Ministry of Railway has sanctioned the Bakshi Dam ROB but the construction work has not yet started. So the directions for starting the above construction work may be issued at the earliest.

***SHRI MUKESH RAJPUT (FARRUKHABAD):** The Indian Railways was established on 16th Apri 1853 and the first train was run between Mumbai and Thane. Since then the Indian railways have developed itself as the biggest rail network in the world. The Indian railway which takes more than 3.5 crore people to their destination everyday can be called the life line of India.

Special focus has been laid on safety,security and public convenience ever since the Government was formed under the leadership of Hon'ble Prime Minister Shri Narendra Modiji. Unprecedented changes have been seen with regard to cleanliness.There have been improvements in the cleanliness in trains and at railway station, pure drinking water, wifi facility at the stations and other public amenities, have been provided. Taking cognizance of the various problems tweeted by the passengers in running trains and solving them quickly is commendable. Indian railways has set an example with regard to women security.

The railway has taken important steps in the development of the railway infrastructure under the guidance of former Railway Minister Hon'ble Suresh Prabhu ji and Hon'ble Piyush Goyal ji. Work at fast pace has been done in direction of increasing the speed of trains and electrification of railways. On one hand trains like Tejas and Vande Bharat were started and on the other hand work is going on at fast pace for starting bullet train.

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*Speech was laid on the Table

There is a need to undertake some important works and introduction of new trains in my constituency which are as follows:

Four Railway overbridges were to be constructed in Farrukhabad out of which construction work on 2 has started, but there has been no progress in the construction of other two bridges. So they may be constructed at the earliest; new rail line from Kasganj to Aligarh may be constructed which is 63 Km long and it will lead to a new rail route to Delhi from Kanpur which will reduce the traffic on Howrah Delhi route and due to reduction in distance, time and money will be saved; Kanpur-Farrukhabad-Kasganj-Mathura rail line should be doubled. Electrification of this rail section is almost complete and the number of trains has increased; there is a problem of water logging in the underpasses constructed by the railways in the entire country. A young one died by drowning in the water logged in railway underpass in Farukkhabad last year and people have to cross the water logged in underpasses during the four months of monsoon. So, the the apprehension of collapsing of under passes which were constructed by spending crores of rupees will always remain due to water logging. So, arrangement for proper drainage from the under passes be made; An intercity express may be operated from Faruhkhabad to Harrat Nizzamuddin via Baba Neemkarori Dham- Mainpuri-Tundla-Agra-Mathura; a train should be started from Farrukhabad to Prayagraj. There is high court, headquarters of Uttar Pradesh Board and is a pilgrimage place and still there is no train from Farrukhabad and a train should be started from

Farrukhbad to Bareilly via Kasganj. Earlier many trains used to run when it was narrow gauge but since the gauge conversion there are no trains.

So, keeping the public interest in mind, these should be included in the demand for grants of the railways.

***SHRIMATI GITABEN V. RATHVA (CHHOTA UDAIPUR):** I beg to lay my speech on the Table in support of the railway budget.

Today, the expansion of railwaylines from east to west and north to south is being done in the country in the last five years after so many years. Necessary resources are being used more for more security of train passenger as compared to before. The country today is progressing in every field. The work of Vadodara to Alirajpur railway line has been completed and there is an atmosphere of joy among the people of our constituency and I thank and express my gratitude towards Hon'ble railway minister on behalf of my constituency Chhotta Udaipur (Vadodara) and people of tribal area og Gujarat. My constituency Chhotta Udaipur (Vadodara) is a tribal dominated area of Gujarat. The famous temple of Siddha Pitha Goddess Kali in Pavagarh and ‘Statue of Unity' have become tourist places and source of income. Due to the untiring efforts of Hon'ble Prime minister for the work of 'Statue of Unity', the people of this region are happy in my area also,as it has made country proud along with Gujarat and an era of New India has begun. So, a separate budget to complete the work related to new railway lines which is being demanded by people for a long time in order to further improve the railway amenities here in view of tourism. The people are happy particularly for 43 km from Chhota Udaipur to Umrali Road Dussehra Maidan sub-station, 48.5 km Chhota Udaipur to Alirajpur station in Seja, and 72.5 km long Chhota Udaipur

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*Speech was laid on the Table.

to Jobat and 90 km long Chhota Udaipur to the last point of the district beyond Jobat; Vadodra to Halol Pavagarh Shivrajpur Pani mines rail may be connected with Jaitpur as line has been demanded by the people for the last few years. There is also need to connect Dabhoi Purani railway line to 'Statue of Unity' via Chuchapur, Tom-Khla and there is also need to connect Ankleshwar to 'Statue of Unity' via Rajyamala , Alirajpur rail line of Madhya-Pradesh.

THE MINISTER OF RAILWAYS AND MINISTER OF COMMERCE AND INDUSTRY (SHRI PIYUSH GOYAL): Thank you very much Hon. Speaker Sir. The way you gave the opportunity to all the Members to speak for about 12 hours yesterday is a matter of pride for the Parliament and also for the fact that you allowed all the Members to discuss the demands for grants of the railway in detail. You have set a record in itself. I would like to thank you and all the Members and also our efficient officials who would have sat for their routine work even after 12 midnight and I would like to thank all those who worked to cooperate prior to this to run this House. I saw many of the media friends who were sitting till night and I would start my speech by thanking them. Today is an auspicious occasion and it is a matter of joy for all of us that we are taking the discussion forward on the occasion of Ashadhi Ekadashi. Ekadashi is celebated with joy and fervour in Maharashtra, Karnatak, Andhra Pradesh, and all other places.

I come from Maharashtra and lakhs of workers visit Pandharpur to worship and seek blessings of lord Vitthal today. I would like to put my point by seeking his blessings. Infact, the teachings of Lord Vitthal about universal brotherhood, peace and harmony, and that the country be run without any discrimination, every individual should work without any discriminiation, and I think that the Hon'ble Prime Minister Shri Narendra Modiji has worked for developement without any discrimination, shown concern about every section of the society and has taken every section along with him during the last five years. He took the nation on the path of development at the fast pace and similarly the Railways has also catched up the same pace during the last five years and contributed in the progress of the Nation. I would like to show some examples of the same. Before me, around 99 Members have spoken on this debate and I am fortunate to be the 100th speaker.....*(Interruptions)*

THE MINISTER OF STATE IN MINISTRY OF PARLIAMENTARY AFFAIRS AND MINISTER OF STATE IN MINISTRY OF HEAVY INDUSTRY AND PUBLIC ENTERPRISES (SHRI ARJUN RAM MEGHWAL): If we add Hon. Minister then it would be century. Suresh Angadi ji has spoken, so it is 100 now. ...*(Interruptions)*

SHRI PIYUSH GOYAL: I think that prior to me, Shri Sadanand Gowda Ji and Hon. Suresh Prabhu Ji had given impetus to all the works of railways. I have been given the responsibility of taking their vision for railways forward. Shri

Suresh C. Angadi Ji heard everybody yesterday for 12 hours without a break. The railways is progressing at very fast to a bright future with the guidance and effective steps of all.

Yesterday, it was 11th July, a sad day because on this day, 7 blasts had taken place in Mumbai trains killing around 209 people and over 700 were injured. It is another fact that it was the year 2006 and despite such an unfortunate incident, we did not retaliate and took no steps. *…(Interruptions)* Had it been the Modi Government then you can well imagine now a befitting reply would have been given. ...*(Interruptions)*

Sir, it is a good thing that the many achievements of railways were discussed here yesterday. There were a lot of good suggestions. Many Members have studied the railway budget in detail and put a number of new aspects before us. Hon'ble Speaker encouraged us by his ever smiling face and did not curtail anyone' speech. I think that with these discussions, new suggestions and ideas come forward which encourages us to improve the work of railways. In fact, if we see the history of India, since the freedom struggle Indian Railways had an important place. We are going to celebrate the 150th Birth Anniversary of Mahatma Gandhiji. If Gandhiji would not have been thrown out of the train in South Africa, then perhaps history would have been different. Therefore I would like to remember Mahatma Gandhi on this occasion and pay my tribute. ...*(Interruptions)*

Sir, Railway is an organisation which works round the clock throughout the year. Today, on this occasion I would like to thank the 13 lakh employees of Railways for their diligent efforts and round the clock services. It would not have been possible to expedite the works without the contribution of all these people during the last five years. I meet almost all the Members, and the new Members may not have met me. We have taken feedback from all the Members, and took care of their works and I am sure there is no Member for whom whom we did not try to help in some way or the other during the last five years but it is also true that the condition of the railway that we got in 2014 was pitiable. I would like to put forward only one data which will make the Members realise the change which has been brought about during the last five years. Yesterday, there were mentions of stoppages and new rail lines, and I intervened on some occasions too but actually the fact is that the railways is overburdened and the traffic volume is very high. I would like to present a few details before you. In 1950, there were 77609 track kilometres in the country.

In the year 2014, when the NDA Government under the leadership of Prime Minister Modiji came to power, there was 116,765 track kilometres and in the next five years this track kilometre increased to 123,236 km in 2019 *…..(Interruptions)*

Hon'ble Member is concerned that not much work has been done then I would like to say that the pace at which we have done various works be it gauge conversion-Narrow gauge to Broad gauge, doubling, tripling,

quadrupling or commissioning new lines we have achieved 59% increase. [In comparison with 2009 and 2014], Yesterday Shri Adhir Ranjan ji mentioned a surprising fact that during the UPA regime electrification of 3000 Km was done and in our regime we have done only 3300 km electrification. I was very surprised because as per my knowledge we have electrified 4000 Km during the last year itself. When I saw the detail, it was found that during the year 2009 to 2014, there only 3038 km electrification work of Indian railways was done which is around 600 Km per year. During the last five years, we have electrified 13,687 Km i.e four and a half times only in 5 years.... *(Interruptions)*

Hon'ble Speaker Sir, during the year 2013-14, electrification of around 650 km has been done in one year. In only one year (2017-18) we have electrified 4087 km....*(Interruptions)* and in the year 2018-19, 5200 km was electrified.

I think truth is bitter and very difficult to accept. Sometimes there is only one difference between the winners and the losers. The losers see the difficulties and winners move towards the goal. I think all the Hon'ble Members know very well that Railways is an essential service; we all want that it in our region, our village because Railway is more economical.

This truth should come before us and we should understand as to why the railway minister is not able to give stoppage or start a new train. I mentioned about the less amount of increase in railway tracks and routes but the freight loading has increased 1300 percent during the last 64 years.

Increasing load on the same track, you can understand how overloaded the capacity is. If we talk about the passengers, then there is an increase of 1642% in the passengers kilometer. When there is such increased demand and the investment on supply is not as expected, then it is natural that problems will arise. After formation of the Modi Government, the investment on Capex has increased 2.5 times during the last five years. It is because of this we have been to do so much work in the country. Atalji had said once and it is very appropriate in today's context... *(Interruptions)*

[English]

SHRI BENNY BEHANAN (CHALAKUDY): You should address the Chair. …(*Interruptions*)

SHRI PIYUSH GOYAL: Are you insulting the hon. Members? Sir, it seems he is insulting the hon. Members and I think I have every right to look where I want. …(*Interruptions*) *[Translation]* Atal ji had said that “I have never come with promises but come with intentions". I think Modi ji has given impetus to the intentions expressed by Atal ji. It is commendable the way Modiji has kept an eye on the entire working of railways and has provided guidance also. Modiji has expressed his concerns on different aspects of works and particularly our ministry has progressed under the guidance of Modi ji during the last five years. I would like to tell the House that only a *Chaiwala* who has sold tea on railway platform at a tender age can understand how important the role of railways can be.

Hon. Speaker, Sir, several things were said by the Hon'ble Members about the railways. All those things points were compiled throughout the night and it consists of around 74 pages, covering the issues raised by all the MPs. Many Members mentioned about the stoppages or new trains. You know that this all cannot be done overnight, the department will study the same and will write letters to you all on the related subjects. The leader of the largest opposition party raised some interesting issues at the beginning which I would like to present in the House. He said that *[English]* The sheen and glamour which were visible in the Railway Budget have been lost after the Railway Budget and the General Budget were combined. *[Translation]* I think that today the entire nation and world has appreciated the budget which was presented earlier only to misguide the country as well as the Hon'ble Members. Many trains, new tracks used to be announced to win the election and to make the people of their region happy. Earlier, the effort used to be made to produce a fantastic visualisation in the Railway Budgets but the Prime Minister has taken a firm departure from the previous time and has worked in the larger interest of the country and the countrymen. People may not be misguided and the work which can really be done ought to be presented before the nation.....*(Interruptions)*

HON. SPEAKER: Nothing will go on record except the Hon'ble Minister's speech.

…(Interruptions).

SHRI PIYUSH GOYAL: Hon'ble Speaker, many interesting facts were flogged during the debate. We always hear that whatever the issue is, it started in our time*... (Interruptions).* It is all right that there should be a dedicated freight corridor in the country. The country thanks you that you started it in the year 2007. But what did you do after 2007? You spent only 9000 crore rupees on this project during the 7 years from 2007 to 2014 and could not do track linking of even one kilometer; even tenders were not issued in the 7 years*... (Interruptions)* We gave pace to this work after 2014. We undertook the work in our hands and only in 5 years, we spent 39000 crore rupees on this project and we have completed 1900 kilometer of track linking till now. We will complete these two dedicated freight corridors by the year 2021*... (Interruptions),* not once, we are ready to debate as many times as you want*... (Interruptions)* whatever you did in 7 years, we have invested 4 times and did 1900 kilometer of track linking during the five years*. ...(Interruptions)*

They made some points on privatisation too. I have already replied on it in the Question Hour. But repeating the same thing will not change the truth. The truth is that if the railway facility has to be extended to every village and nook and corner of the country, then it is obvious that investment on large scale will have to be done. All passengers want a safe and comfortable journey. We want the railways to carry more freight. So, the Government has decided that we will encourage more public-private partnership in future and to increase our capacity, we will corporatize some units to attract investments.

This is not ours, it is also work of your regime. We are finishing the pending works left by you*... (Interruptions).* This is our work, perhaps this is why the people have elected us*....(Interruptions)* that we complete the work in which you failed, why are you shedding crocodile tears in the House today with regard to corporatisation. *.... (Interruptions)* We don't understand their purpose of saying this*... (Interruptions).* I think our Finance Minister said it with conviction that we would invest 50 lakh crore rupees in the next 10-12 years for the railway related facilities, it is a matter of courage. All the Members want this only. This is why we have been elected to this House. This is our responsibility.

Hon'ble Finance Minister said that this Government would work with new vision and new direction, I thank the Hon'ble Finance Minister for this. The elaborate picture that my sister presented before the nation about how the country and railways will progress, we are committed to that and we will work day and night to fulfil it.

HON. SPEAKER: Hon'ble Members, please do not talk among yourselves. The House functioned till 12 midnight yesterday there was some technical issue otherwise it would have continued till 2 at night. I gave the opportunity to the Member who wanted to speak still if there is something else that you want to say, I will let you ask the question, and it will be replied to. But Hon'ble Members, it is my request. I especially request the Hon'ble Members of this

side. Minister Ji is capable enough, so please do not interrupt him. Please do not speak while sitting on your seats. I have not allowed it. I have not allowed any Memeber to make any comments when Hon. Minister is speaking. Hon'ble Minister, you please continue.

SHRI PIYUSH GOYAL: Thank you Hon. Speaker Sir... *(Interruptions)*

HON. SPEAKER: I will get your queries clarified.

SHRI PIYUSH GOYAL: The 50 lakh crore rupees plan that we have estimated is that if we spend 6 lakh crore rupees in the high density networks places when there is large capacity constraints and high demand of trains, its capacity with increase manifold and facilities could be increased for the people. I think there is the nothing wrong in it. You all should welcome it. We have envisaged that there should be more dedicated freight corridors so that freight trains can be provided at places where there is demand of these. There will be an expenditure of about 4 and a half lakh crore rupees on it. There should not be any objection to this from anyone. In the same way, in the main Golden quadrilateral that leads from Mumbai to Delhi, Mumbai to Kolkata, if we spend around 1.5 lakh crore trains rupees on increasing the speed of trains on the main line and its intersection, it will be a welcome step. Likewise we have thought deeply on each and every subject, went to the root of the problem, analysed the root cause, without any political intervention, for the benefit of the

people, we have stressed on the aspects on which investment needs to be done so that the railways can serve the nation in a better way. You all are very well aware of the ICF coaches which existed earlier, there are many ICF couches still running in the country.

Hon. Speaker, Sir, the first design of LHB coach came from Switzerland, Germany 30 years ago. The work on it started but only few LHB coaches were built. Till the time we came to power ICF coaches were being built at a large scale. We decided that why not phase out the old ICF coaches which is causing major accidents and many people die and build only LHB coaches. Not a single ICF coach is being manufactured in the country today. We will phase out the old ICF coaches which are running, as and when their life ends. We will not reuse them after overhauling them but will replace them with LHB coaches. There will be a large scale expenditure in this. Now whether this expenditure should be done or not? Obviously, the people will want it to be done.

Hon. Speaker, Sir, the signaling system is very important from the security point of view. If more trains are run, then the capacity increases like there is a local train every 3-4 minutes in Mumbai for which automatic signaling system has been installed.

Why should the whole country not benefit from it and there should be automatic signalling system in the entire country? If the Government initiates and tries to bring huge investment for it, I think perhaps the Opposition will help us and appreciate us that good work is being done. Sometimes we should look beyond politics that how such good work can be executed and how can we contribute to it. But, if one has to make comments then I would like to say that there is no such subject that I cannot explain properly that how the work was done in earlier times and how it is done today. During the last term while giving a reply, I had made a mention of the Modern Coach factory which is located in Raebareli, Uttar Pradesh. This project was sanctioned in the year 2007-08 and work commenced.

Hon'ble Speaker, Sir, we came in the year 2014, at that time not even a single coach was manufactured there. Some shelves were brought there from Kapurthala and Chennai, they were painted, or some nuts were fixed in it and it was said that production is made. Leave all this, not even the General Manager was appointed, not even a single appointment was made, temporary staff was deployed there. When the hon'ble Prime Minister formed the Government, this serious issue came before him, he immediately ordered that recruitment should immediately be done in this organization. The officers should be appointed and production should be started. In August, 2014, the first coach came out of that factory. After that, see our working style, we are increasing production every year and today we are manufacturing 100% LHB coaches there. We are manufacturing good and safe coaches. You will be glad

to know that we continue to increase production day and night and in the year 2017-18, around 711 coaches were manufactured. Its manufacturing capacity is of thousand coaches and you can understand that in the government factory, if 70% capacity is utilised, people applaud themselves, but our Prime Minister is not satisfied with any work. The Honorable Prime Minister asked me, if 711 coaches are manufactured, why more coaches cannot be manufactured? I replied that sir, its capacity is 1000 and 700 are being manufactured. No factory is able to manufacture so much. He said that he himself would visit the factory. Hon'ble Prime Minister went to MCF. He took the round of the entire factory, met employees, discussed it with our young engineers and gave them directives that in the next year the production of this factory should be doubled. In the year 2018-19, we manufactured 1425 coaches. We manufactured 1425 coaches in the factory having capacity of manufacturing thousand coaches and doubled the production. I can give hundreds of examples where impossible has been made possible. If we make investment in it, bring technology and corporatise it, the factory located in Raebareli can become the world's largest factory having production capacity of 5000 coaches. You can imagine that as to how many people will get job from it, how many small ancillary units will be set up, how the small industries and trade will get impetus. This government has this kind of thinking. The trains, train set and coaches manufactured in India will be exported from there to the entire world…..*(Interruptions)*

HON. SPEAKER: Hon. Member, please.

Hon. Member, I am again requesting you and this is my last request in this House.

SHRI PIYUSH GOYAL: It is said many times that we are going to privatize the Railways. I get a sore throat easily, and I had repeated with emphasis many times that no one can privatize the Railways.

There is no question of privatizing the railways. But if some new facilities are provided, some new projects are setup, some new kind of technology is brought, new capacity is built, one wants to manufacture tracks, develop new routes, lines and some new stations and want to high speed train, semi high speed trains at some places, then I understand that it is in interest the country. The investment should be invited in this regard. … *(Interruptions)*

Hon. Speaker,Sir, many issues have been raised. Through you, I would definitely like to tell the Hon. Members that this Government had set safety and security as the main targets and worked in this direction. If I take the year 2009-10 as an example, because so many Hon. Members belong to that party, the leader of that party was the Minister of Railways at that time. In the year 2009-10, Rs 2,107 crores were spent on the security of women, children and

passengers in the railways. This year, we are going to spend around 5690 crores rupees on the security of passengers only, this in a very big change.

Hon. Speaker, Sir, if we see the number of accidents taking place between the year 2004 and 2009, around 206 accidents occur every year. From the year 2009 to 2011, 153 accidents occurred. During our regime, this figure has been brought down to less than a hundred. 95.6 accidents occured every year, it means that during our regime, less accidents occurred and number of casualties in the accidents that occurred from the year 2009 to 2011 was around 300 *….(Interruptions)* Today we have brought it down to around 50 *…(Interruptions)* Perhaps, the railways had never witnessed this kind of reform in the past …..*(Interruptions).*

Hon. Members ask about operating ratio. It is obvious that manpower cost is included in the operating ratio. Today around 12 to 13 lakh employees are working in railways at present, we have given them around 22000 crore rupees more after 7th pay commission. Despite that, railways is running in profit, the railways is able to function properly and is able to make investment. I believe that we are making improvement in parameters of efficiency which will lead to improvement in railway facilities and the people will get its benefit.

An issue was raised. I don't know from where figures were quoted. LIC borrowing was of Rs 2000 crore. If we add 5000 in it, it becomes 7000. There

are many issues which are totally baseless. Whenever we require, we will take money from LIC. If we don't need it, then whether we will forcefully borrow it and increase our interest? Whether anyone does this in his Ledger book that when there is no need, borrow money on Interest. Then also, I would like to apprise the Honourable Member that till now we have taken around 18000 crore rupees. Whenever we require, we will discuss it accordingly with them. Otherwise, there are other options of borrowing; we borrow from where we get money at cheaper rates.

Similarly, mention of many MoUs has been made, I have got its details. I will send it in writing how we have worked on each MoU and try to increase the facilities in Railways...*(Interruptions)*

They are not even aware that I never went to the USA to study for a long period. I definitely did many short courses. I have formulated a rule that every railway employee should undergo a one week compulsory training every year. This way re-learning takes place. Nowadays Hon. Speaker has also organised a training programme for newly elected Members of Parliament. Training is something, that is necessary for everyone. Eminent persons have also to re-learn, otherwise they had to live their lives as per history. It is unfortunate that some people do not remember that training programs are organised every year in our party. These programs are organised for party activists and MPs, so that we are able to evolve continuously and should be able to progress with the

world. But for your information I would like to tell you that I went to the USA for short courses. I have reached here by studying in this country only. I have become a Minister by studying in this country …..*(Interruptions)* They said that had there been no Congress, how I would have gone to the USA for studies? You had used this word, it is in the record. I have prepared this reply, by taking into account your verbatim transcript. ...*(Interruptions)*

Sir, they made mention of track renewal also. I failed to understand as to what they wanted to say …..*(Interruptions)* when we came to power, the tracks were in dilapidated condition. Track renewal was not undertaken for a long time, we look up all the work, carried these works forward and due to it, the figures of safety have improved. In the year 2013-14, the number of train accidents was 118 but in the year 2018-19 it has got reduced to 59 that accounts for almost half.

Sir, though I have given reply with regard to electrification, but I am sure and we have made resolution that the hundred percent electrification of the broad gauge network of Indian railways will be completed in the coming years*...(interruptions)* It will save diesel worth thousands and crores of rupees. The foreign exchange reserve of the country, which is spent on importing crude oil from foreign countries will be saved. Along with it, it will have a positive impact on the environment, all the trains coming to Delhi will be run by electricity, it will improve the environmental condition of Delhi and Mumbai, and

it will improve environmental conditions of all those villages from wherever these trains will pass.

Sir, the discussion on our manifesto was also held. I would like to tell that the Prime Minister, Shri Modi is so much concerned about the country that there is not even a single issue in our manifesto in regard to which the ministers do not have to monitor it regularly. I understand that this Government has undertaken many work mentioned in its manifesto during the last five years and no other government in the past has taken its manifesto so seriously.

Sir, I would like to tell for information' sake that earlier I had referred to a subject-track kilometer. I would like to revise that it was running kilometre. The staff should correct it and write 'running ‘kilometre' in place of track kilometre. ... *(Interruptions)* I think that I have the right to make corrections. I am amending the entire text.

13:00hrs

Only 30000 running kilometres was extended during the last 64 years. In our tenure, it has been extended by 5000 kilometres in only 5 years. Total track kilometre which was extended around 39000 kilometres in 64 years, was also extended 7000 kilometre in only 5 years during our regime. I would like to

correct here that I made a mistake in speaking the figures. I have made an amendment in it.

It is said that the 'Vande Mataram' train is not running with full capacity. It is very obvious because earlier no one dared to manufacture such a good train in India. We showed courage and it's for the first time ever that our engineers manufactured semi high speed train Vande Mataram designed fully indigenously in the country in the form of train set*....(Interruptions)* You had been the Minister of Railways, you are not even aware of the difference between the joining the coach and a train set. For the first time in the country, a train set which runs from Delhi to Banaras known as *Vande Bharat* has been manufactured. You would be glad to know that it is running with hundred percent occupancy since the very first day and is functioning properly. The vande mataram has been able to do cover the journey of more than 1 lakh kilometres. Some of my colleagues may recall as to how some people have made fun of our engineers, our employees due to a small glitch in *Vande Bharat*. I would like o request all of them that when engineers and employees of our country do some work, appreciate them. Please boost their morale. Do not show your pessimistic thinking before the country by ridiculing them.

I was told that we made mention about agricultural products and we did not undertake any work in this regard. You raise the issue of reducing the model share of railways from 89% to 30%. It is called harming oneself. Earlier model share was definitely 89%. ... *(Interruptions)* Before the year 1950, the

model share was 89% since independence, the Government of only one party ruled the nation; and much more than that one family ran the government directly or indirectly, it was 89% before the year 1950 and it got reduced to 34% in the year 2014. Now who is responsible for it? Please tell me whether they are ready to take the responsibility. why did it get reduced to such a low level?

I think that the way our government has tried to link agricultural products with trains and in future we are going to increase it further, this will provide impetus to the agriculture sector, our farmers and food-processing sector.

The effort was made to spread rumours. A very surprising data came that the work with regard to bio-toilets is progressing at slow pace. I got disturbed. I was surprised as to how it happened. Our work is progressing at a very fast pace. Hon. Speaker, Sir, you will be glad to know that bio toilets were to be set up in around 55400 coaches in which total around 2,40,000 bio-toilets were to be installed. Till date, we have already installed around 2 lakh 10 thousand bio-toilets. As per the previous target, bio toilets were supposed to be installed in all trains by the year 2021-22. I am glad to inform you and I feel that we would be able to install bio-toilets in all the trains in the next 12 months.

Then it was said that the Government should pay its attention towards escalators, lifts and differently abled persons. Many sermons were delivered. I welcome it, but I want to see the facts also.

Many ministers took charge of the office between the year 2004 and 2009. I have got the full list. Many ministers came to power and many left the office. Only 28 escalators and 19 lifts were installed in railways between the year 2004 and 2009. This figure improved from the year 2009 to the year 2014 and 115 escalators and 78 lifts were installed. What did we do in the last 5 years? We had installed 457 escalators and 377 lifts, it means that the figure of 19 lifts increased to 78 lifts and we had installed 377 lifts. The figure of 28 escalators rose to 115 escalators and we have installed 457 escalators. This is called a working style...*(Interruptions)* Many things were said about punctuality also. When our government came to power, we found that punctuality was really a matter of concern. All of us remember that all of us were affected by the issue of punctuality and it should be our priority that people should reach on time. It is a different story that enough tracks are not available and there is a shortage of trains, there is a need to in stop us infrastructure, therefore some sort of problems are natural. Signalling system is also very outdated and it will take time to rectify it. We saw that the people are suffering because of punctuality issues. The official figures say that punctuality is not so bad.

Sir, when we got to the bottom of this problem, we came across an amazing fact. Even after 67 years of independence, till the year 2014, the station master used to note down in his register the arrival and departure of the train from a particular station as this is how the punctuality record was maintained. It was considered to be true and punctuality figures work used to be published as per those records, and actual figures would not come to light. When our government came to power, it linked it with technology. We installed automatic data loggers so that cent percent accurate time of train may come before the country. As when we visit the doctor, he is able to treat us only if he is aware of our disease. Similarly when this problem came before us, we found its solution. When data loggers were installed overnight, punctuality figures decreased by 20% because facts came to light. After that, the entire railway department started working in the direction of rectifying it. I am glad to inform you that of late I have not heard these kinds of complaints and concerns over punctuality. Now, we monitor the number of minutes lost due to delay in any train, and how much delay is caused by each train and we maintain all these records and along with it, we present this information before the entire country through 'Rail Drishti' app. You can get all this information through 'Rail Drishti' app. You can get photographs of every station on this app and as to how the beautification of stations is being carried out, how cleanliness of stations is being maintained, how clean toilets are, photographs of all stations are uploaded as per the time limit on it. If we find that there is any shortcoming in

the cleanliness, the responsibility of officers is fixed. You can get information about all trains on 'Rail Drishti' App.

It is 1:09 pm, when we are here, we can see information of locations of all trains of the Indian railways, and as to from which station they are passing at present through 'Rail Drishti' app. We have made all the information public. There is transparency in it.

Sir, I can speak on many topics, but I have received the note that we can give this information later on, but I think it is my duty to present one to two points before the House.

Hon. Speaker, Sir, many things were said about West Bengal. 54 new projects are running in West Bengal-16 new railway lines, 4 gauge conversion, 34 doubling works. The estimated expenditure on these works is 42,000 crore rupees. You would be surprised to know that the oldest project which has been running in West Bengal, is running since 1974-75 ….*(Interruptions)*

Hon. Speaker, Sir, we have been able to commission only 43 kilometres till date in Howrah to Amta and Bargachia to Champadanga project because the State Government does not give us land. How could we work? Railway is not short of funds. If we get the land, we are ready to undertake work immediately. The second project is also very old. This is of the year 1983-84. The project is of around 163 kilometres between Eklakhi and Balurghat. The

work in regard to 76 kilometres stretch is held up, because the state government is not giving land. Similarly, there is a project of the year 1984-85, this project is of 168 km stretch from Tamluk to Digha. The work of 80-kilometre stretch is held up, because the State Government of West Bengal is not giving land.

Hon. Speaker, Sir, I can cite many more such examples. I repeatedly write letters. I had sent a letter giving project- wise details of the works halted to Honorable Didi on 15th June. If you people render assistance to me, I would be grateful to you...*(Interruptions)*

Sir, now come to Kerala. Many concerns were expressed in regard to Kerala. Today, nine projects are running in Kerala. There is a very important project in regard to which I understand that the entire House is concerned. This project is between Tirunvaya and Guruvayur. All devotees want to visit Guruvayur Temple. The railway has decided to undertake this project. This project has been running for the last 24 years but we are not able to conduct the location survey because the state government is not cooperating. There is another project between Angamali and Sabarimala. Everyone wishes to visit Sabrimala. Our morale is boosted after visiting Sabarimala. This project was also included in the Budget 20 years ago. All things are included in the Budget. In this regard, earlier in November, 2015 , the State Government of Kerala said that it would bear 50% cost. Now they are saying that they cannot bear it, they

will not give money. All other states give money for this. Be it Jharkhand, Maharashtra, Gujarat, Uttar Pradesh, all the states give money and provide assistance in setting up of the project, but the State Government of Kerala says that they will not give money. Here the state government is not able to give assistance to us in conducting the final location survey.

I can give many such examples. This time, I wrote a letter to the honorable Chief Minister on 15th June and apprised him that if they render assistance to us, it will be beneficial for all.

We are committed to set up many projects in Karnataka. A decision has been taken under the leadership of the Honorable Prime Minister Modi ji that suburban railway should be set up in Bengaluru of Karnataka. How can we minimize the commuting time of people and provide facilities to them? I am armed with requisite information relating to many projects of Karanataka. Not taking much time I would like to say that I would like to assure that I will give a written reply to all the issues raised by various Members. I would like to again thank all the honorable Members, Hon. Speaker and all staff and would like to request to oblige me by supporting and approving the Demands for Grants, Demand number 82 of railways relating to the Railways.

HON. SPEAKER: Hon. Members, from today , there is a new ruling from the Speaker that the Members who interrupt in the Honorable Minister' speech, will not be allowed to seek clarifications from today onwords and the Members who

listen to the entire speech of the Minister and seek clarification there after, I will aloow those to do so. Whether the entire House wants this ruling?

SEVERAL HON. MEMBERS: Yes, we want it.

HON. SPEAKER: This House should run with unanimity. If the House is run with unanimity and consent of all parties, it functions smoothly.

Adhir Ranjan ji, now you may ask the question.

SHRI ADHIR RANJAN CHOWDHURY (BAHARAMPUR): Hon'ble Speaker Sir, I would like to speak for 2-3 minutes because many things have been said. ....*(Interruptions)*

HON. SPEAKER: You don't have to make the new speech.

...(Interruptions)

SHRI ADHIR RANJAN CHOWDHURY: Sir, there will be no dispute. *...(Interruptions)*

HON. SPEAKER: Seek clarification only.

…(Interruptions)

SHRI ADHIR RANJAN CHOWDHURY: Sir, it will be implemented after today, Goyal Sahab, please see…. *(Interruptions)*

HON. SPEAKER: Adhir Ranjan ji, please address to the chair.

SHRI ADHIR RANJAN CHOWDHURY: Sir, we are friends ...*(Interruptions)*

HON. SPEAKER: If Honorable Minister speaks like this, I will interrupt him also. You should stay assured, even if an hon'able Minister or any other senior Member, who indulges in cross talking doesn't address to the chair, I will stop him her from doing so.

….*(Interruptions)*

SHRI ADHIR RANJAN CHOWDHURY: Sir, there will be no fight, I promise you. ...*(Interruptions)* To talk like this feels good. If someone calls Payal, Doyal or Koyal to Shri Goyal Sahab, it will not make any difference, because Goyal will remain Goyal only. Similarly, in whatever form we see railways, it will be railways only. In childhood, we used to listen to radio, afterwards TV came and thereafter mobile came, all these came because of Shri Rajiv Gandhi, but if you say that as you have brought the mobile, and we have done nothing, it would be wrong to say. Therefore,I would like to say that the progress being made by the Railways is an ongoing process, we have started dedicated freight corridor, high speed railway corridor, conceptualized bullet train,and at present it is an ongoing process. Since yesterday, we were trying to give suggestions, besides that we did nothing. I just tried to give the suggestions. Goyal sahab, you talk about safety and security, but 'C' and 'D' grade employees play an important role in ensuring safety and security. You may see

that 2 lakh 64 thousand vacancies of 'C' and 'D' grade are not being filled up in railways. What effect will it cause? It will have an impact on safety and security of railways. I would like to suggest them that as there is under provisioning in DRF, and it is called Budget. The Government says that the operating ratio is 9- 10% and it is for the 7th pay commission or others. It is all right but you should have said that you are not able to achieve the target. Do not think that we will not extend cooperation to you. Since yesterday, we have been telling you that we are ready to extend our cooperation to you. We are giving you an advice, please listen attentively. *[English]* A total of 49719 deaths were reported between 2015 and 2017.

[English]

SHRI N.K. PREMACHANDRAN (KOLLAM): Sir, I have a specific clarification and my clarification is regarding privatisation of the Railways. In the Budget of 2015-16, the then hon. Finance Minister had earmarked a five-year development programme for the Railways by which a sum of Rs. 8.5 lakh crore was supposed to be attracted from private investment by way of PPP and all those things. Now, the Government proposes to invest a sum of Rs. 50 lakh crore by 2030 for infrastructure development. I would like to know wherefrom this money would come …(*Interruptions*)

SHRI SUDIP BANDYOPADHYAY (KOLKATA UTTAR): Sir, first of all I would like to say that hon. Minister mentioned about the Eklakhi – Balurghat Railway line in his reply. I would like to invite him to board the Eklakhi – Balurghat

express train and I can assure him that it would be a joy for him to have travelled in that train. This train is running in full command.

Sir, I am raising a very crucial point. There are more than 1,74,000 railways bridges in this country. Of them, many are more than 100 years old and this is related to the question of safety and security of the Railways. What steps the Government proposes to take for these bridges which are more than 100 years old. I would like to know if any repair work of those bridges would be taken up or not. …(*Interruptions*)

[Translation]

DR. NISHIKANT DUBEY (GODDA): Hon. Speaker Sir, yesterday, I had asked a specific question that during the year 2008, the Congress Government was involved in a scam regarding domestic traffic and export traffic and thereafter. *(Interruptions)* Their ministers did it. CAG report mentioning loss of Rs. 30,000 crore was submitted in this regard, what are the actions the Government of India is taking in this regard….. *(Interruptions)*

SHRI NAMA NAGESWARA RAO (KHAMMAM): Through you, I would like to say one thing to the Honorable Minister. Yesterday, our two Members expressed their views on behalf of the TRS party. Hon. Minister said that he would reply to those clarifications. Please give priority to the issues related to railways under the A.P. Rehabilitation Act and complete it.

Secondly, there is only one point which covers Bhadrachalam, Sattupally and Kovurru and is related to two States. It was sanctioned in the year 2012. I would like to request that ours is a new state and please give attention towards it….*(Interruptions).*

[English]

SHRI BHARTRUHARI MAHTAB (CUTTACK): Hon. Speaker, Sir, I would like to inform the House about one thing. It is today, I think, that the return journey of Lord Jagannath. The hon. Minister is very much aware of it. I would like to remind the hon. Minister that there are two long pending projects – one is the Haridaspur – Paradip line. Land acquisition was a problem which has already been sorted out. The other is the Khurda Road – Bolangir line. The problem now has been sorted out by the State Government and the State Government also is participating in it. How long will it take to fully operationalise these two lines?

SHRIMATI SUPRIYA SADANAND SULE (BARAMATI): Sir, I would like to put just two to three quick questions. The hon. Minister talked about land acquisition issues in the States of Kerala and West Bengal. The bullet train was a flagship programme of this Government and it has now been over five years. It is your Government at the Centre and also at Maharashtra. So, why has there been no land acquisition in Maharashtra and why is the work of the Bullet train not started?

Sir, secondly, I would just like to elaborate on what Shri Premachandran ji said. You used words like `corporatisation' `SPV' `PPP' etc. Can the hon. Minister please elaborate on these?

Finally, my point is on the running kilometres and track kilometres. Can the hon. Minister please explain what exactly these mean? …(*Interruptions*)

SHRI JAYADEV GALLA (GUNTUR): Sir, this is regarding the Railway Zone for the State of Andhra Pradesh which the Government announced just before the elections. It was also mentioned in the AP Re-organisation Act also. You are saying now that it has been fulfilled. But I just wanted to know regarding the Waltier Division which has been split. The goods traffic has all been given to the State of Odisha and only the passenger traffic remains with the State of Andhra Pradesh now.

[Translation]

HON. SPEAKER: Honorable Minister, would you like to give clarification?

[English]

SHRI JAYADEV GALLA: So, all the incomes are with Odisha and all the expenditure are with Andhra Pradesh. Earlier the Railway Zone was considered unviable*… (Interruptions)*

[Translation]

HON. SPEAKER: Hon. Minister, do you want to give clarification?

SHRI PIYUSH GOYAL: Hon. Speaker, Sir, I am happy that many Members of Parliament listened to my speech attentively and therefore good questions

have been raised, I thank Adhir Ranjan ji for his support. He played with the words and cited an example of Koyal Goyal etc. and said railway will remain railway only, but the meaning of Piyush is *amrit* also. I will give *amrit* only don't worry. Premachandranji, we never talked about private investment of 8 and a half lakh crore rupees in the Budget, you may read the budget again. At that time I had said that the Railways will make investment of 8.5 lakh crore rupees through different mediums. Some investment have been done through the government expenditure, some with private investment, some with EBR borrowing, the railways has taken money from different mediums in this direction If we take into account all these mediums collectively, around 2.5 times investment has been made in comparison to the last 5 years. Sudeep Dada, has asked a very important question. Actually, the issue of bridges is a matter of concern for all of us. He has rightly stated that some bridges are more than hundred years old. All of us are concerned about it and I understand that probably every Railway Minister used to pray to God before going to bed at night ,that all the bridges may remain intact, but along with prayers, we regularly conduct audits of the entire Railway system. Audits of bridges are carried out in all divisions and zones and recently have started a new project in which hoarding depicting details in regard to the date of construction, last inspection held, details of inspection and action required and action being taken will be installed an every bridge, followed by the same with all ROBS and FOBs. It will give us some assurance that the work on bridges is being done and we will upload this data on 'Rail Drishti' app also.

With enhanced transparency, the people will become more responsible. The people and media will monitor it. It will also improve performance. Hon'ble Nishikantji, if any case is in court or with any investigating agency, if any corruption case is sub judice, our Government does not interfere in it. We let them do their work we keep ourselves confined, and busy with work related to development and progress. The agency too has responsibility to discharge its duties independently and with full sincerity.

Raoji mentioned a few lines, I will not be able to give a written reply in this regard on today itself. Mahtab Saheb reminded me, I thank him very much. Today, pilgrims of Lord Jagnnath will start their return journey. We have provided facilities of special train to devotees to visit there. I will give written reply of it in two sentences. Hon'ble Supriya ji talked about acquisition for bullet train in Maharashtra. Obviously, it is a very important project. Its work is going separately as per PERTH chart. A little delay has been caused in land acquisition in Palghar of Maharashtra but not a delay of 40 or 50 years old. A discussion is going on this delay for the last one and half year. Our Government works sensitively. We are holding discussions with tribal brothers and sisters that what we can do for them in their hard times, as to how we can help them, we will acquire land amicably and the train will start on its scheduled time. Corporatization, PPP, SPV etc. are different terms, these are different ways to bring investment. All these are good methods and we adopt all these methods in interest of the country.You have asked the difference between running kilometre and track kilometre. I had committed mistake and I

admit it because both figures got interplayed. Running Kilometres do count lines in the yard or shunting lines. Running kilometre is determined by excluding those lines.

At present, 1 lakh, 23 thousand track kilometres are there and running kilometres are 94,735, the difference is of shunting lines, yard lines and all that.

Honorable Gallaji had asked about the waltair division. Galla ji is a big industrialist; he understands how the economy and economic world run. We do not make any discrimination in providing investment or facilities as per the profitability of zones. The railways are concerned about trains of the entire country. It is obvious that profit and loss will vary in different areas. Here revenue come from more freight, if we see like it the Indian railways would have to make its entire investment in Jharkhand and its adjoining areas. A large quantum of mineral wealth comes from Jharkhand and Chhattisgarh. But, Railways do not invest like that. The railways take into account the locations of the entire country and makes investment as per the requirement. The brothers and sisters of Andhra Pradesh do not need to worry, narrow gauge lines may remain or may not or may go to another division, the Railways invests as per profitability of the entire railway network. There will be no discrimination ever against with Andhra Pradesh. Thank you.

HON. SPEAKER: Several Cut Motions on the Demands for Grants pertaining to the Ministry of Railways have been moved by the Members. I will put all

those Cut Motions for voting before the House, which have been considered as moved.

All Cut Motions were put for voting and were negatived

HON. SPEAKER: The question is:

"That the respective sums not exceeding the amount on Revenue Account and Capital Account shown in the fourth column of the list of Demands for Grants be granted to the President of India out of the Consolidated Fund of India,to defray the charges that will come in the course of payment during the year ending on 31st day of March, 2020 in respect of the heads of Demands entered in the second cloumn thereof against Demand No. 82 relating to the Ministry of Railways."

[English]

Demand for Grant for 2019- 2020 in respect of the Ministry of Railways voted by Lok Sabha

No. of Demand	Name of Demand	Amount of Demand for Grant on Account voted by the House on 31st March, 2020		Amount of Demand for Grant voted by the House	
1	2	3		4	
		Revenue Rs.	Capital Rs.	Revenue Rs.	Capital Rs.
82	Ministry of Railways	92040,83,00,000	76200,77,00,000	180194,57,00,000	151193,47,00,000

The motion was adopted.

[Translation]

HON. SPEAKER: The House stands adjourned till Thirty Minutes past Fourteen of the clock.

13.32 hrs

The Lok Sabha then adjourned for lunch till Thirty Minutes past Fourteen of the Clock.

14.33 hrs

The Lok Sabha re-assembled after Lunch at Thirty Three Minutes past Fourteen of the Clock.

(Shri Bhartruhari Mahtab in *the Chair*)

[English]

HON. CHAIRPERSON: We are taking up The Central Universities (Amendment) Bill, 2019.

SHRI N. K. PREMACHANDRAN (KOLLAM): Sir, I have a point of order. The financial business is listed in today's List of Business as item No. 21 i.e. discussion and voting on Demands for Grants under the control of the Ministry of Road Transport and Highways for 2019-20. As per Rules 220 and 221, when the financial business is incorporated in the List of Business, then, only after the completion of the financial business, the legislative business shall be taken up except the introduction of the Bill. You may kindly go through Rule 220. Rule 220 says:

> "Notwithstanding that a day has been allotted for financial business under rules 207, 208, 218 or 219, a motion or motions for leave to introduce a Bill or Bills may be made and a Bill or Bills may be introduced on such day before the House enters on the business for which the day has been allotted."

It means that only introduction of Bill is permitted when the financial business is listed in the List of Business. Also, Rule 221 gives ample powers and authority to hon. Speaker to conclude the financial business at the earliest. It is to protect the Government. I would like to know from the Government whether the financial bill or the financial business is more essential or this Bill is important. I would like to know whether this Bill is so important than the financial business of the Government. I would like a clarification from the Government. If Rules 220 and 221 are there, it is really a bar until and unless the Speaker directs it in a different way.

HON. CHAIRPERSON: Hon. Minister.

[Translation]

THE MINISTER OF STATE IN THE MINISTRY OF PARLIAMENTARY AFFAIRS AND MINISTER OF STATE IN THE MINISTRY OF HEAVY INDUSTRIES AND PUBLIC ENTERPREISES (SHRI ARJUN RAM MEGHWAL): Premachandran Ji has raised the valid issue, but he should keep in mind that BAC is supreme.

[English]

SHRI N. K. PREMACHANDRAN: BAC is not supreme.

HON. CHAIRPERSON: Let him complete.

SHRI ARJUN RAM MEGHWAL: As regards consideration and allotment of time, the BAC is supreme. It is mentioned in the Rules. …(*Interruptions*)

SHRI N. K. PREMACHANDRAN: Please do not mislead the House. BAC is not the supreme authority. Rules and Procedure is the supreme authority.

SHRI ARJUN RAM MEGHWAL: But who made the Rules and Procedure?

…(Interruptions)

HON. CHAIRPERSON: Hon. Member, let us first hear him.

[Translation]

SHRI ARJUN RAM MEGHWAL: It was decided in BAC, it was decided in BAC that National Highways and Road Transport will be taken on Monday, it was decided in BAC and the bill would be passed today. This was also decided by BAC itself.

[English]

HON. CHAIRPERSON: The question which Mr. Premachandran has raised is that if the Government is willing to put the financial matters at a later time, then he is willing. That is what the Rules provide for.

[Translation]

SHRI ARJUN RAM MEGHWAL: We have made a request to take it on Monday….*(Interruptions)*

[English]

HON. CHAIRPERSON: I do not think he has any objection. It is about the priority of the business.

THE MINISTER OF PARLIAMENTARY AFFAIRS, MINISTER OF COAL AND MINISTER OF MINES (SHRI PRALHAD JOSHI): Today being a Friday, we just have one hour. Since it is a very small Bill, we would like to take this Bill and on Monday, we will continue with other work.

[Translation]

DR. NISHIKANT DUBEY (GODDA): Shri Premachandran Ji is a senior Member of this House and he is well aware about rules. Rule 389 clearly states that the Speaker has the right on all issues. If the Speaker has allotted this time after holding discussion with the government, then there should be no further discussion on it……*(Interruptions)*

[*English*]

HON. CHAIRPERSON: I would give the benefit of doubt to Mr. Premachandran. He has raised a valid point and the Government has responded to it. Let us proceed.

Hon. Minister

14.38 hrs

CENTRAL UNIVERSITIES (AMENDMENT) BILL, 2019

[Translation]

THE MINISTER OF HUMAN RESOURCES DEVELOPMENT (DR. RAMESH POKHRIYAL NISHANK): I beg to move:

"That the Bill further to amend the Central Universities Act, 2019 be taken into consideration."

Sir, I rise also to congratulate the people of Andhra Pradesh. There was a provision in the Andhra Pradesh State Reorganization Act, 2014 to establish one central university and one central tribal university in Andhra Pradesh. Sir, as you know this country once was at the top position in the field of education. The universities like Takshashila and Nalanda were in this country. It has always been said about this country that 'Eted Desh Prasootasya Sakashadagra Janmanh Swam Swam Charitra Shiksheran Prithivyaan Sarva Manavah' which meant the people from the entire world came to our country to get education and followed it.

Sir, education is the foundation, and backbone of any individual, family society and the nation. If the education system is upto the mark, the entire system, family, society and country will also progress well and I am feeling

proud to say that the Government of Shri Narendra Modi ji is seriously focussing its attention on upgrading the education system. While making a new initiative in all directions, may it be primary education, secondary education, higher education, technical education or all types of research in all scientific sectors, the Government is committed to take the country to new heights. With this commitment, this Bill has been moved in this House for consideration and getting it passed. Along with other things in the 13th Schedule of the Andhra Pradesh Reorganization Act, there was a provision to establish these two universities. The Government of Andhra Pradesh had proposed to provide 491.23 acre of land for establishing the Central University and 525.08 acre of land for Tribal University . Thereafter, the Ministry of Human Resource Development had sent its selection committee there and after seeing all the locations, the committee recommended to establish the Central University in Anantpur district and the Central Tribal University in Vijaynagaram district. The Ministry accepted it and directed 'EdCIL' to prepare its DPR. After the preparation of DPR by EdCIL, the Expenditure Finance Committee approved it, the Cabinet has given its consent on it and to open both the universities. On 16 May 2018, the Union Cabinet, which had provided rupees 450 crore in the first phase for establishing the Central University in Anantpur district of Andhra Pradesh gave in principle approval to run it in a temporary campus till the Act is duly passed. At the same time, the Central University Act, 2009 was moved in the Parliament but it could not be passed. The Tribal University which was to be established along with the Central University was also approved by the

Cabinet on 08th November 2018 and 420 crore rupees was allocated for this purpose..... *(Interruptions)* The first one is Central University and the second one is Tribal University. Both are different. Rupees 450 crore has been provisioned for the former and Rs. 420 crore for the later ….*(Interruptions)* After that we brought the Central University Amendment Bill 2018 for establishment of a Central University and a tribal University jointly in Andhra Pradesh and this Bill was presented in the House on 14th December, 2018. After that, the year 2018 passed and the year 2019 arrived. Since an amendment was necessary, our Government amended it with immediate effect on 28th January, 2019 and it was presented in Lok Sabha on 12th and 13th February 2019 for discussion but the discussion on this Bill could not take place. After the dissolution of the 16" Lok Sabha, this Bill got lapsed. When the 17th Lok Sabha was formed and since the approval of Cabinet was necessary, our Government approved it in the 2nd meeting of the Cabinet after which we brought this Bill again. The Bill was moved on 8th July and after that today we have come with the request for a discussion on it. I am happy to say that our Government has worked for the development of Andhra Pradesh..... *(Interruptions)* Our Government has taken this strong and efficient step to strengthen education system in Andhra Pradesh and today we have brought this Bill.

When a Central University and a Central Tribal University are being established in the history of Andhra Pradesh then I humbly request that the Bill should be considered and passed.

[English]

HON. CHAIRPERSON: Motion moved:

> "That the Bill further to amend the Central Universities Act, 2009, be taken into consideration."

[English]

SHRI KODIKUNNIL SURESH (MAVELIKKARA): Thank you, Chairman, Sir, for giving me this opportunity to speak on this important Bill, the Central Universities (Amendment) Bill, 2019, further to amend the Central Universities Act, 2009.

Sir, we are going to discuss a very important Bill in this august House. The Bill seeks to amend the Central Universities Act, 2009 to establish two Central Universities in Andhra Pradesh. Apart from Goa, Andhra Pradesh is the only State in India which does not have any Central University. The establishment of the Central University in Andhra Pradesh is mandatory under the Andhra Pradesh Reorganisation Act, 2014.

According to the Bill, the objective of establishing two universities will increase access and quality of higher education and also promote avenues of higher education and research facilities for the people of Andhra Pradesh. But, there is nothing special in this Bill. It has an unclear Statement of Objects and Reasons. There is no mention of funding pattern for universities.

HON. CHAIRPERSON: You do not have it in the Bill. The detailed funding is never done in the Bill.

SHRI KODIKUNNIL SURESH: Sir, ensuring quality education and reducing funding in Central Universities remains a big issue. These are lacunae in this Bill. The Government wants to promote higher education by establishing new Central Universities in all parts of the country, especially, in backward areas.

This Bill does not give details of establishing both the Universities. It only states: “The aim would be to enhance education and research in two Universities.” For example, there is no mention about the curriculum and administration of the Universities.

As far as establishment of the Tribal University is concerned, it is unclear whether the University would be reserved for tribals or not. What percentage of tribal population will get the benefits of this University? In what way the university will promote advance knowledge by providing instructional and research facilities in tribal art, culture and customs and advancement in technology to the tribal population of India? It is also unclear. The Bill is silent on crucial details like separate curriculum of the University.

The NDA Government is known for reducing grants for Central University. Besides that, the NDA Government has unduly interfered with the administration of many Universities in India. There have been attempts to re-formulate curriculum for these Universities.

The Central Universities in India are vastly understaffed. As on July, 2018, a total of 12 Central Universities, out of 40, have more than 75 per cent vacancy of professors, while for two of the Universities, the vacancy is 100 per cent. For example, the Central University of Haryana and Odisha have 10 per cent vacancies of professors.

I would like to give some examples. The Central University of Orissa in Koraput, Odisha is one of the 15 Central Universities established by UPA

Government during the UGC XI Plan period to address the concerns of 'equity and access' and as per the policy of the Government of India,. …(*Interruptions*). I would not like to go through all the Universities. I would only like to give some examples regarding the number of sanctioned posts and vacant posts in the Central University of Orissa. Sanctioned posts of Professors are 23 and Professors posted are nil.

HON. CHAIRPERSON: That was the position as on 1st April, 2018.

SHRI KODIKUNNIL SURESH: These are the details according to the various papers available in the library also. Sanctioned posts of Associate Professors are 43 and only one Associate Professor is posted; 42 posts are lying vacant. Sanctioned posts of Assistant Professors are 88 out of which 16 Assistant Professor are posted; 72 posts are lying vacant. This is the position in the Central University of Orissa. … *(Interruptions)*

HON. CHAIRPERSON: I think, this is the reply, which the former Minister Shri Prakash Javadekar has given in this House in the last Lok Sabha. When he was HRD Minister, he had given this answer in this House.

SHRI KODIKUNNIL SURESH: Till now, that is the situation; there is no change. No appointment has been done so far.

I wish to highlight the serious lapses that the Government is conveniently side-lining. Higher education is the key and the gateway to the nation's progress. The allocation for higher education needs to be in parallel

with the increase in Gross Enrolment Ratio (GER). As per the All India Survey on Higher Education 2017-18, Gross Enrolment Ratio in higher education in India is 25.8 per cent, which is calculated for 18 to 23 age group. In 2016-17, the GER was 25.2 per cent.

Based on the increased ratio, I reiterate the position of Kothari Commission that six per cent of GDP must be allocated for education sector. The fact however remains that the share of spending in education in the whole Union Budget has decreased from 4.6 per cent in 2014-15 to 3.5 per cent in the Interim Budget 2019-20.

The spending on education sector as a percentage of GDP has reduced under the NDA Government in the past five years. The Ministry of Education, renamed as the Ministry of Human Resource Development, failed to spend over Rs. 4 lakh crore made available to them between 2014-15 and 2018-19, failing to meet the budgetary targets. According to a report of the Centre for Monitoring Indian Economy, the underspending by the NDA Government was nearly 17 per cent in 2014-15, which was the highest in the last 10 years. In the Central Universities, we have to ensure the quality of education.

In Kerala also, a Central University is established in Kasargod. It is a very backward district. In that Kerala Central University, a serious problem is being faced by the teachers. A large number of vacancies are vacant there. Our Ministry has not taken note to fulfil the teachers' vacancies. Without

teachers, without professors and without associate professors, how can they run the University?

HON. CHAIRPERSON: Your point is taken. You have another Member from your party to speak.

SHRI KODIKUNNIL SURESH: Yes Sir, I am concluding. I am not going into the details.

In Central University of Kerala, the BJP leaders have promised one thing. It is not only the BJP leaders but also the Ministers who have promised to change the name of the Central University as Narayana Guru University. This was the promise. But so far, no action has been taken.

So, I would like to request the hon. Minister to rename the Central University, Kasargod as Sree Narayana Guru University.

Hon. President of India in his speech has mentioned about Sree Narayana Guru. So, if you want to honour us, please honour Sree Narayana Guru and rename the Central University.

I have the last point. Sri Ayyankali is a great social reformer in Kerala. During the UPA Government period, Ayyankali Chair was established in Kasargod Central University. After that, the NDA Government came to power. This Chair was cancelled. So, I would like to request the hon. Minister to reinstate that Chair and sanction sufficient fund for this Chair so as to make students aware of this great social reformer.

SHRI RAJIV PRATAP RUDY (SARAN): Hon. Chair has asked another Chair to sit down!

SHRI KODIKUNNIL SURESH: I am concluding Sir.

SHRI RAJIV PRATAP RUDY: One Chair has asked another Chair to sit down! …(*Interruptions*)

SHRI KODIKUNNIL SURESH: I am talking of the Central University Chair. …(*Interruptions*)

SHRI RAJIV PRATAP RUDY: Your mike is off! . …(*Interruptions*)

SHRI KODIKUNNIL SURESH: I can put the mike on. …(*Interruptions*)

In my Constituency, there is one Raja Ravi Verma Arts School. That school can be taken over by the Central University.

[Translation]

SHRI RAJIV PRATAP RUDY (SARAN): Hon. Speaker Sir, this a minor amendment to the Central Universities Amendment Bill. When I went through the Bill, a political issue came to my mind that our Government which is government of the country and our vision for Andhra Pradesh after its partition and whatever we decided for it resulted in trust for the Government, the trust for the Prime Minister of the country which is visible. Those who have belied the trust of the Prime Minister are neither in the State Government nor any of their members is sitting here. *... (Interruptions)* The people of the country understand this. Whenever the loyalty of the Prime Minister is challenged, the people of the country will reply in the same coin.

This is very good Bill. An amount of Rs. 900 crore has been allocated for a tribal and a general university through this. The place selected is also good which is very nice. It is necessary to go down the memory lane relating to this issue.

The oldest university in the world was in Morocco in 859 AD and subsequently it was Bulgana University in Italy. We have been carrying forward this tradition in our country since the Vedic age and several thousands of years. After the Vedic age, the modern education was introduced during British era. The East India Company came to India and established Universities in India to fulfil their own purposes.

15.00 hrs

In India, the East India Company established first university in Kolkata in 1781. After that, Asiatic society was established in Bengal in 1784. There is a long history of Bengal. Dada, let's listen. Although the role of Bengal has changed today but it has major role in the history of the country. The Fort William College was established in the year 1800. Now, these figures and the ancient universities of India. Sir, if the Hon. Minister is allowed to continue, we will not get an opportunity to speak because he has real knowledge on this subject and it feels good to listen to him. Takshila University which is situated near Islamabad of present Pakistan was established way back in 7th century. Nalanda University located in Bihar is dear to us. As universities, Central University was set up in 450 AD and at Udanpuri Bihar in 450AD and Sonpur is in West Bengal and Jagdala is in Bangladesh. Bengal has always done wonders. Nagarjunkonda falls in Andhra Pradesh and Vikramshila is in Bihar. Nishikant ji is not present here. The Central University has been approved there too. Vallabhji in Gujarat, Banaras University (BHU) in Varanasi, Uttar Pradesh, Kanchipuram, Manikhet in Karnataka, Shardapeeth in Kashipur, Pushpagiri in Odisha are in our history. Three official universities were established after 1857. Dada has rightly said that these were in Mumbai, Kolkata and Madras. All these had been founded on the patterns of British University so there was not much contribution of India.

Sir, now the issue to which I am coming is that immediately after the freedom of India, there were 20 universities and around 496 colleges but if we go through the syllabus of universities, we will see that the syllabus of many such universities and colleges have not been changed for the last 40 years. The study pattern happens to be one only the same. Today, we are talking about the establishment of Central Universities because somewhere the Government of India and Modiji are concerned about the quality of University education. There are 14-15 separate central universities established till now and two will be approved today. The UGC was established in 1956 with the purpose of determining and maintaining standard in teaching and creating model education. Today, there are around 700 universities and 40,000 colleges in India but we see that despite so many colleges being in place on which 43 thousand crores rupees is spent annually, a large number of students go abroad for studies. This is a big issue and despite this, large number of students study in Indian Universities. You too have studied in a university. Many commissions have been constituted for higher education. Today, around 14 crore students are studying in universities all through the country. India is at third position after America and China. Actually, this is a big number.

Hon'ble Minister, this data is important because the issue I am about to address can make you understand the reason for concern and what is happening in India? There are around 3 crore 66 lakh students pursuing higher education. There are around 700 colleges in India which are affiliated to

Universities. There are around 37 thousand affiliated colleges and 12 lakh 84 thousand teachers engaged in higher education. We give 80% of our education budget as a salary to the teachers.

Sir, I never understand the importance of coaching centres, so I formed a team and asked them to contact the students of coaching centre. I was surprised to find that the number of students in coaching centres is more than those enrolled in universities. Whenever any student used to come to me and say that it is a matter of concern that exams are not being held on time, and they are not getting degrees on time, I used to wonder that he is not the student of the college he is talking about, and I have never seen him studying in the college then why is he worried about the certificate?

Why is he worrying about the certificate? He is worried about the certificate because the student takes admission come in the college, when the exam is round the corner, he is found sitting outside the office of the Registrar. If he wants to apply for any job, he would be required to have the degree of graduation and post-graduation. In fact he is studying at the coaching institute. Bihar, UP and the city of our Hon'ble Speaker Sir, is famous because a student takes admission in intermediate and heads to Kota directly. This is not wrong, there is no harm in it. But there is a change in the educational scenario. It occurred to me that the college buildings are lying vacant and if you really want to give them degree, you call the people of such coaching classes and tell them that so many classrooms are lying vacant, you bring the students to

these classes after bidding, we will give you the building for free, you bring students to the colleges. If you tell these coaching that they are allowed to start coaching classes in the grand buildings having huge campus and football ground free of cost, the students studying elsewhere will return to these campuses. It is time to think about the shortcomings in our educational system. The tuition industry is to the tune of 40 billion US dollar in India and 35% is CAGR. [English] Compounding growth of admission and teaching in private institutions of coaching categories is 35 per cent.*[Translation]* Nowadays, there are websites like Edukart, Bridges and others which tell you which coaching centre is good. We will establish 15 or 20 central universities or if we request the Prime Minister then even 30.

HON. CHAIRPERSON: There are 40 central universities now and these two more are under the process of being set up.

SHRI RAJIV PRATAP RUDY: I am saying that we can establish 40, 50 or 60. But when the colleges of universities are not upto the mark, how will we standardise it or bring quality excellence to them. How long will this continue in the country? I am not saying that the quality of education is bad everywhere. I have received my education from the Punjab University and I know that the education quality was good at that time and will be so today also. But I see the situation of many universities that the classrooms of constituent colleges and affiliated colleges are lying empty and only at exam times, there is huge queue

for filling up exam forms. Sanjay ji, Nityanand ji are sitting here and all of us have seen how long queues were there earlier. I used to teach in a University but I joined politics. I could not teach economics. I was a lecturer in AN college in Patna. I have been in politics for the last 30 years and am on leave even today but that is another issue. I am lecturer today also. *[English]* NSSO data says that one out of every four students in this country goes for a tuition. The total number of children who go for tuition in this country is 7.1 crore, which includes four crore boys and three crore girls. This is the number of children going for tuition. *[Translation]* There are study groups also. How these tuitions run and all this is legitimate and children of our families must be attending the tuition classes . There are study groups in class rooms, and home tutorial. Online education accounts for 3500 crore rupees. I must congratulate the Prime Minister of the country that all of you are from academic tuition, if there is the largest enrolment in India in any non academic tuition then you can very well guess the field and this field is yoga where Yoga teacher takes on non academic classes. This is commendable. At least people are inclining to receive training in Yoga after changing their stream. Adhir ji, please do not laugh; this is actually a big thing. Government of India is spending 33,000 crore rupees on higher education.

15.10 hrs

(Shrimati Rama Devi In The Chair)

The Government has also increased 7-8 thousand crore rupees. Madam, the University of your area is in our neighbourhood and we know about it. The primary schedule is of around 55,000 crore rupees. We are spending around 85,000 crore rupees on education in this country. Hon'ble Minister, I am saying the right thing. The Government has given almost the same amount in this Budget.

Now, let's talk a bit about Bihar. The people were asking for the setting up of about three Central Universities in Bihar also. One is Nalanda University wherein work has been started and is continued at pace. It should be given further impetus. Then, there is Mahatma Gandhi University. Radha Mohan Singh Ji is an MP from Motihari. The Government of India and Hon'ble Prime Minister has given grants for it in package. But, Sir, one University is left.... (*Interruptions)*

Madam, through you I would like to request that we have asked about Takshila and Bhagalpur Universities. It is remarkable that the first vice-Chancellor of the world happened to be belonging to Bihar who acted as the vice-chancellor of Takshashila University. The then Vice Chancellor was from Bihar and the Registrar of Nalanda University who used to have a control over

education was from Takshila. I would like to tell you that when Takshila was burning in 1194, Oxford University was set up in London at that time. It is history now. Now I come to it.

Hon'ble Minister, you are very cheerful person and a Minister in the Government of India. I come from district Saran, Chhapra, Bihar. At some point of time, I used to win by the margin of 25-30 thousand votes and 10,000 votes but thanks to the Prime Minister of the country this time I have won by the margin of 1,32,000 votes. It was out of the question and we have been contesting the elections*.....(Inferruptions)*

HON. CHAIRPERSON: This is a small Bill, therefore, let others also take their time.

...(Interruptions)

SHRI RAJIV PRATAP RUDY: I am telling you honestly. Hon'ble Minister has taken my time and the chair has also taken my time. Shri Premchandran Ji who is sitting that side has also taken my time. I cannot ignore the words of chief Whip. He has asked me to speak for 10 minutes and it's been only 8 minutes since I started.

HON. CHAIRPERSON: It's been 14 minutes since you have started speaking.

….. (Interruptions)

SHRI RAJIV PRATAP RUDY: Madam, you have to set your watch right. ... *(Interruptions)*Please give me two more minutes. If the subject is not completed, there is no point in holding a debate over in this August House. ...*(interruptions)*

HON. CHAIRPERSON: Two more Members are yet to speak.

...(interruptions)

SHRI RAJIV PRATAP RUDY: Madam, I would convey their views also ….*(Interruptions)* I would like to tell that there exists Jai Prakash University near saran, Chhapra, Bihar, Ganga, Ghagra, Gandak. Madam, you know about Jai Prakash Ji. Dr. Rajendra Prasad Ji, the first President of India hailed from there, Jai Prakash University has been established there. Don't give us anything. Don't facilitate me with the authority of recommending admissions in Central Schools. Please give a proposal to grant Jai Prakash University the status of a Central University to the Government. ... *(Interruptions)*

HON. CHAIRPERSON: Ok. It's good.

...(*Interruptions)*

SHRI RAJIV PRATAP RUDY: Madam. Heena Ji is sitting here. Our Hon'ble Members of Parliament also are present here. Patna University is a good University and we have demanded for that also. Alongwith it, grant the status of central univesity to Patna University also. It is a long drawn demand. Patna University is very famous in the country. Hon'ble President also visited there last year.

Madam, you have a big heart and the Hon.Prime Minister is also committed to good work. You must have heard what Piyush Goyal have said how the target was 700 and the actual production done was 1400. …*(Interruptions)*

HON. CHAIRPERSON: Hon'ble Member of Parliament, Prof. Sougata Ray ji.

…..(Interruptions)

SHRI RAJIV PRATAP RUDY: Madam, alongwith the quality of education in the country, there is also a need for the setting up of more Central Universities. I, for my constituency, for my district and for my State alongwith all the Members of Parliament would like to make a demand that Patna University should also be accorded the status of a Central University. Alongwith Jai Prakash University, where the students of our area and of course from across Saran, Siwan, Gopalganj and Muzaffarpur go to for study. *…(Interruptions)* It is the land of the former Prime Minister Chandra Shekhar ji and Jai Prakash ji. A Central University may be set up for the children there. *... (Interruptions)*

HON. CHAIRPERSON: These are granted to you.

....(Interruptions)

SHRI RAJIV PRATAP RUDY: Madam, our Nityanand Ji is in favour. Sanjay Jaiswal Ji is also in its favour and the entire House is in favour....(*Interruptions)*

HON. CHAIRPERSON: Please do the welfare of Bihar.

...(*interruptions)*

SHRI RAJIV PRATAP RUDY: Madam, I would like to request you to send a proposal in this regard.

[English]

PROF. SOUGATA RAY (DUM DUM): Madam, I rise to speak on the Central Universities (Amendment) Bill, 2019. This Bill proposes to set up two new Universities in Andhra Pradesh – one general and one for the tribals. This is part of the Andhra Pradesh Reorganisation Act, 2014. I thank the hon. Minister for fulfilling the commitment made in this Act. Andhra Pradesh has bled from partition and so, it should be made up. The Minister has allocated Rs. 450 crore for one university and Rs. 420 crore for another university in the first phase. More money will be allocated later.

This tribal university will be the first tribal university in India. So, we have to devise new courses, especially on tribal anthropology, social anthropology etc., and I am sure that all that will be done very well.

I have one difference with the concept of Central Universities being confined to one State. I feel that a university means *Vishwavidyalaya* where you bring the whole world's knowledge to one place. I feel that a Central University may be in a State, but it should appeal to the whole country and students from all over the country should come to the Central University. That will be the model. For example, Delhi University is the best university in the country and students from all over the country are coming here. It is a Central University, but cut-off marks for admission are 99 per cent or 99.5 per cent. Unless the Delhi University increases the number of seats in the colleges, this terrible pressure on Delhi University will stay.

There is another university in Delhi, namely Jawaharlal Nehru University, which truly attracts students and scholars from all over the country. The Government does not like it because it has the likes of Kanhaiya Kumar and others, but I think, it is an excellent centre for studying social sciences and other sciences.

While speaking on this Bill, I may say that there is only one Central University in Bengal – Visva-Bharati University. It is the legacy of the freedom struggle. Gurudev had requested Mahatma Gandhi to take over Visva-Bharati. Mahatma Gandhi had requested Jawaharlal Nehru and that is how Visva-Bharati University came into being, but now that University is in a very bad state. There are infinite numbers of vacancies for the posts of teacher. So, Visva-Bharati University should be looked after quickly. There is a demand for another full-fledged Central University in Bengal. I would request the Minister to give attention to the same.

Lastly, I want to say a word about curriculum. I read in the newspapers two days back that a university in Nagpur is including the history of RSS in the curriculum. I am strongly opposed to this. RSS was not a part of our freedom struggle and its history should not be taught in universities and colleges. They did not participate in Quit India Movement, or in the 1930s movement.

Another thing is that Jawaharlal Nehru had said that universities should foster scientific temperament. Pseudo-sciences like astrology should not be taught in the universities, whatever be the Minister's personal inclination. I

want the new universities to be real centres of modern scientific knowledge in both science and humanities. Only then, the purpose for which so much money is being spent will be fulfilled. Let the universities work not to the RSS agenda but work to the national agenda.

Thank you.

[Translation]

DR. NISHIKANT DUBEY (GOUDDA): Madam, they can only see RSS….*(interruptions).* Please remove the name of RSS.

HON. CHAIRPERSON: It does not matter. Let it be. It has happened so because of this.

[English]

SHRI LAVU SRIKRISHNA DEVARAYALU (NARASARAOPET): I thank the Chair for giving me this opportunity to speak on this Central Universities (Amendment) Bill, 2019.

On behalf of the YSR Congress Party, we welcome this Bill as it helps my State of Andhra Pradesh. As Andhra Pradesh was divided after 2014, we were left with no Central University in our State, but after passing of this Bill, we will be having one Central Tribal University and also a Central University established in our State in the coming years.

Everyone sitting here will agree to the point that a Central University should attract students from across the country, faculty from across the globe as well as establish modern laboratories and do research which will take the society and the country forward. We all agree to that.

We should all remember that the State of Andhra Pradesh was divided in the year 2014. After the State got divided, we waited for almost four and a half years for this to happen. These two Universities have already been functioning for the last one year in Andhra Pradesh. They do not have the legal sanctity till now. But with this Bill, they are getting the legal sanctity.

I want to make a few more points, through the Chair, to the hon. Minister here. The Ministry of Human Resources Development has sanctioned Rs. 420 crore three years back to the Central Tribal University. Last year the Vice-

Chancellor sent a DPR for almost Rs. 952 crore. So, I urge upon the Minister, through the Chair, to re-do the sanction that the MHRD has done.

In 2018, the MHRD has allocated Rs. 10 crore in the Budget and this year it has allocated Rs. 8 crore in the Budget to run the Central Tribal University, which is supposed to attract faculty and students from across India. So, I urge upon the Minister, through you, to be more liberal, to be more magnanimous towards the University. Where is Rs. 952 crore that was asked for and where is Rs. 10 crore that is being allocated every year? We want this to be hastened up so that we can establish the infrastructure sooner or later.

In Andhra Pradesh the literacy among Scheduled Tribes who should be getting into these Universities is around 46 per cent whereas the national average is almost 59 per cent. Why am I mentioning this? We established Ekalavya schools in areas where tribal population is more. The Budget that is allocated for these schools, where tribal students will go, get educated and do the further education in the universities, in 2017-18 was Rs. 241 crore. But somehow in 2019-20 Budget you have reduced the Budget from Rs. 241 crore to Rs. 31 lakh. If I am wrong please correct me. If the Budget is allocated under some other Head, please correct me. …(*Interruptions*) Give me one more minute. I will complete my speech. So, you please correct me if I am wrong. Unless we strengthen the schooling system where the students can go, study and then go for further studies, we cannot expect the Central Tribal Universities to be successful.

The hon. Minister has already accepted that 500 acres of land has been allocated in Ananthapur. But this Central University is conducting only one course, which is B.A. (Political Science) and some vocational courses. So, we expect the University to run with few more courses wherein faculty and students can actually come in and take their research forward.

[Translation]

SHRI RAHUL RAMESH SHEWALE (MUMBAI SOUTH CENTRAL): Hon'ble Chairperson, Madam, thank you for giving me the opportunity to speak on the Central University Bill, 2019. The Central University and the Central Tribal University have been sanctioned for Andhra Pradesh under the Andhra Pradesh Re-organisation Act, 2014. I extend my thanks to the Hon'ble HRD Minister as for the last five years, the Members from Andhra Pradesh were demanding for it. I would also like to request the Government to fulfill the commitments given to Andhra Pradesh in the coming days under Andhra Pradesh Re-organisation Act.

Madam, our Finance Minister while addressing the House during the budget mentioned that through this budget we will try to attract the foreign students to get education in our country and will encourage them to take admission in the universities of the country. Through you, I would like to tell the Hon'ble HRD Minister that we should concentrate more on our students rather than the foreign students. Through the discussion being held on this Bill, I would like to put the problems of the Mumbai University before the Hon'ble HRD Minister. The condition of Kalina campus of Mumbai University is very bad. The history of Mumbai University goes back to 162 years i.e. it is 162 years old university. There are 86 posts of Professors out of which 59 posts are vacant. There are 129 posts of Assistant Professors out of which 57 are vacant. Due to so many vacant posts, the students face lots of difficulties. Also

because of this, revenue is not generated from Mumbai University and Vice-Chancellor appoints Professors on contract basis. Since they have to be paid as per the 7th Pay Commission, they are appointing all the Professors on contract basis. I would like to request the Hon'ble HRD Minister to appoint the Professors on the vacant posts in Mumbai University as soon as possible. Mumbai University needs a special fund. Redevelopment plan of Mumbai University, Kalina campus has already been submitted and its budget is of 500 crore rupees. Mumbai University or the State Government does not have this much fund. Through you, I would like to request the Union Government to grant special fund of 500 crore rupees to the Mumbai University. Mumbai University has also applied for distance education fund to the Union Government. It has also given the proposal for the sports complex to be constructed in the Kalina campus. Also a proposal to start a sports specialised degree course through Mumbai University has been submitted by the University.

Madam, through you, I would like to request the Union Government to improve the condition of Mumbai University. If you will see the record of Mumbai University for the last 2-3 years, you will find that earlier work of paper checking was used to be done manually in the Mumbai University but now it is being done online and due to this, students had to face problems in these 2-3 years. A case of online scam in admission process came into the light which

also caused problems for the students. All these things should be probed through the Ministry.

Lastly, I would just like to tell you that Aaditya Thackeray ji, the Shiv Sena leader and President of Yuva Sena, has raised the issue of Mumbai University before the HRD Minister time and again. He has raised this issue before the Union Government also. Through you, I would like to request the HRD Minister to grant special funds for Mumbai University. The Union Government earns more revenue from Mumbai. 40 per cent revenue from Mumbai goes to the Union Government, so it is the responsibility of the Union Government to grant special funds for Mumbai specially for the Mumbai University whose history is 162 years old.

Madam, through you I would once again like to request the HRD Minister to sanction the proposals submitted by the Mumbai University.

Thanks.

[English]

SHRI BHARTRUHARI MAHTAB (CUTTACK): Thank you, Madam. There is nothing much to say about. This Bill relates to Andhra Pradesh. But three issues have arisen from this Bill. *[Translation]* I have a question. It would be better if the Hon. Minister replies to that. A Bill was passed in 2014 and Andhra Re-organisation (Amendment) Act was enacted. It has been committed in the

Act to open Central University and Tribal University in Andhra Pradesh. You remained in power for 5 years but recently in year 2018, it was decided to open Central University and Central Tribal University. I have been told that the transit office of the University was established somewhere in Anantpur. Why did this Government not proceed with the proposal for 5 years? I want reply for this question. We welcome your step. It is better late than never. *[English]* There is another issue relating to Central Universities which Shri Suresh has already brought out in this House regarding the lack of faculties in Central Universities.

[Translation]

We do not get faculties in Central Universities. I remember that when Doctor Sahab was the Prime Minister, he used to tell several times that enough faculties are not there. So, we are not being able to open 'University of Higher Learning'. However, if we open IIM, IIT and Central Universities, we can attract them. We can bring back people to the country, who go abroad to teach. It has been started from the year 2008-09. IITs, IIMs, Central Universities have been set up in every State but the condition is still same that most of the faculties are not coming there. Why are they not coming? We need to think about it and discuss about it. Do they get less salary or are there other problems? Is there no "security of service"? we need to look into the reasons behind that. This time no discussion is taking place in respect of Demands for

Grants of Ministry of Human Resource Development but if you wish you can tell about this in your reply.

HON. CHAIRPERSON: Mahtab Ji, you please stop for a while.

THE MINISTER OF STATE IN THE MINISTRY OF PARLIAMENTARY AFFAIRS AND MINISTER OF STATE IN THE MINISTRY OF HEAVY INDUSTRIES AND PUBLIC ENTERPRISES (SHRI ARJUN RAM MEGHWAL): Madam, now it is time for Private Member's Bills. If the House agrees and you permit, its time may be increased till the passing of Bill. After passing of the Bill, the Private Member's Bill may be taken.

DR. NISHIKANT DUBEY: Madam, please fix a time for this. Hon'ble Minister may reply till 4 O' clock.

SHRI ARJUN RAM MEGHWAL: Yes, it will be done.

SHRI ADHIR RANJAN CHOWDHURY (BAHRAMPUR): Madam, as Shri. Premachandran had raised the issue that financial matter is being discussed and this Bill has been brought in between. There has been violation of rules in this. Again rules are going to be violated. Private Member's Bill should be taken up by 3.30p.m. It is our right and it is also going to be violated. This is not right. It is not good to violate the rules in such manner.

HON. CHAIRPERSON: The House has agreed to this. It has been extended upto 4 O'clock.

SHRI BHARTRUHARI MAHTAB: Madam, now I come to the second point. In the discussion on this budget we had yesterday, there has been mention of study in India in. It has been announced in a big way. It means that maximum foreign students come in our universities for higher studies. But, we need to discuss whether our central universities or other universities have the environment suitable for studies. It is important that most of the faculties should come from abroad. Also the students who are going abroad for studies should study here.

[English]

The last point is that when Mr. Arjun Singh was the Minister for HRD, at that time the concept of having Central Tribal University was mooted. Odisha had asked for having a Central Tribal University in Odisha because Odisha is the repository of more than 24 tribes in Odisha itself whereas in other States there are limited numbers of tribes. There are large numbers of people or tribals in those States no doubt, but the varieties of tribes are more in Odisha. Subsequently, it went to Madhya Pradesh, and division of Madhya Pradesh also happened.

Now, the first Central Tribal University is in Madhya Pradesh, and I think that the second Central Tribal University is going to be established in Andhra Pradesh. My request to the hon. Minister is this. …(*Interruptions*)

[Translation]

DR. NISHIKANT DUBEY: Tribal population is less in your state. It is more in our states.

SHRI BHARTRUHARI MAHTAB: Telangana has more tribal population. Madam, Prakash Javdekar ji introduced a Bill on 3 December, 2018. It was mentioned there that one tribal university will be set up in Andhra Pradesh and it was mentioned in the Act passed in 2014 that a Central Tribal University will be set up in Telangana also. I don't know why any Member from Telangana is not discussing this matter? I would like to tell the hon'ble Minister that it has been announced that a Central Tribal University will be set up in Warangal. But, it has not been implemented till date. I have a demand that just like a Tribal University is being opened in every state, a central Tribal University should be opened in tribal dominated states also. Besides, I would like to say that Traibal University is not only for tribals. Those who want to do research on them, their living style, their civilization can opt for such curriculum. You can keep a percentage like 60 or 70 for it. But, other people can also study in Tribal University. I would like to draw the attention of the Hon. Minister towards the issue and conclude my speech.

HON. CHAIRPERSON: If you keep your speeches brief, then everyone will get the opportunity to speak.

[English]

SHRIMATI SUPRIYA SADANAND SULE (BARAMATI): Madam, I stand here in support of this Bill. Justice delayed is justice denied. The Government could have brought this Bill because Andhra Pradesh and Telangana are going through difficult times. I am glad that it's better late than never. It has come. I have two or three quick questions to ask. For me, education is something passionate, whether you sit on this side or that side. I don't think we disagree on anything when it comes to education. I think, the hon. Minister is bringing these Bills on piece by piece basis. Last week, we discussed the Central Universities Reservation for Teachers bill. Now, you have brought the Central Universities Bill. When we are looking at world class education, we need a New Education Policy for which the country is crying for. Why are you bringing these Bills on piece by piece basis? Why can we not have an integrated discussion on education and include all these Bills? I can't see why this is required in piece by piece basis. I urge the hon. Minister to bring a comprehensive education plan.

About autonomy, which even Shri Mahtab *ji* has talked about, we have to have education for all in an inclusive manner. We have brought the Right to Education for that. We brought it so that all children can study in an integrated manner. So, I would like to second Shri Mahtab *ji*'s point.

Shri Krishna spoke specifically about tribal university. I would like to state here that there is a Central Government Programme called Kasturba

Gandhi *Balika Vidyalaya,* which is specifically for tribal girls and only from 5th standard to 8th standard. Why do you not extend that in the entire country up to 12th, and then integrate it? I think, that is the only way. *[Translation]* 8 Tribal Universities are going to be established there and Kasturba Gandhi Balika Vidhyalaya functioning in the country has nothing to do with it. *[English]* I would like to urge the hon. Minister to kindly bring in a comprehensive plan; you take them from the 5th standard all the way up to post-graduation. Otherwise, it would not serve the purpose and would not serve the cause of making inclusive education for all.

Is this going to help in other States? Can we have an integrated programme so that we could have universities like this in the country, and in my State, Melghat in Amravati district, and Palghar in Thane district? Even from the State I come, there are tribes like the dhangar community. If there is an integrated programme, we would be happy to welcome it.

Who are the stakeholders whom you have consulted in forming this tribal university? Worldwide there is no great programme; there are a few in isolation. If you are starting something new, we are happy. But then we need to discuss the methodology of it, and the autonomy should not only be with the Vice Chancellor, it should be with the teachers and students. Now, change in education globally is giving autonomy not to the institutions but to the students. So, I take this opportunity, and request the hon. Minister to form an integrated programme for the entire country and to bring in a New Education

Policy. Please do not get trapped into bureaucratic procedures by bringing one small piece of legislation. Please bring in the whole policy. We are happy to work as long as you want and take some good ideas but come up with a comprehensive programme. Thank you.

[Translation]

SHRI RAM MOHAN NAIDU KINJARAPU (SRIKAKULAM): Madam Chairperson, I thank you for giving me the opportunity to speak on this important Bill.

Madam, this topic pertains to our state, so I would request you to spare extra two minutes for me to speak. First of all, we are talking about two universities, because at the time of division of Andhra Pradesh under the A.P. Reorganization Act which was passed in this House, at that time some institutions were from Erstwhile Andhra Pradesh, and all those institutions are in or around Hyderabad, which were going to Telangana at that time. As per reorganiasation , some institutions which Andhra Pradesh should get, were included in the A.P. Reorganization Act, among them the two important universities are Central Tribal University and Central University. Bill for both the universities has been brought in the House today, for this I would like to thank the hon. Minister. There were many speakers who rose to speak on this Bill, I would like to thank all of them. I would like to thank all those Members for understanding the pain we were facing regarding Andhra. *[English]* Like Supriya ji has also mentioned, justice delayed is justice denied. I would like to

say that this should have been brought earlier itself. It should have been done faster but better late than never.

[Translation]

I would like to reiterate the concerns that we have. Our former Chief Minister Chandrababu Naidu had arranged about 525 acres in Ralli Village in Vizianagaram District for this purpose and sent the proposal to the Central Government. The amount given for this is only Rs 18 crore. Rs 10 crore was given last time and Rs 8 crore in this budget. You have just said that the estimation for the first phase is around Rs 420 crore. We will only ask when will it be executed as per the timeline. Many institutions were promised. IIT was also promised to Andhra Pradesh. We tried to establish it in Tirupati. Out of the budget estimate for this, only a very small percentage of the amount has been released so far. NIT is also in the same condition. IIM which is opened in Visakhapatnam is in the same condition. All of them are operating in temporary campuses. We will not agree completely just by introduction of the Bill. Until these are fully built, a permanent facility is fully established there and the faculty is fully in place, we cannot fully discuss its impact or importance.

At the Central University, currently there are only 6 courses at graduate and post graduate level. The faculty in the university is very less. It is written on the website that a permanent faculty cannot be established there for the next 3 years. We would request that this be done as soon as possible. A timeline should be given as to when all these institutions will be built in Andhra

Pradesh? It is not just these two institutions; there are IIT, IIM, ICAR also. There are many institutions which come under the HRD Ministry for which we want a timeline.

Hon'ble Member Rudy ji was showing a lot of concerns about us. I also want to tell that BJP's vote share in Andhra Pradesh is only .9%. The BJP fielded candidates on 25 MP seats and 175 MLA seats ….*(interruptions).* NOTA got 1.5% votes there. BJP's vote share was even less than that. BJP should worry about why they did not get vote there? *....(Interruptions).*

HON. CHAIRPERSON: Please take your seat.

...(Interruptions).

HON. CHAIRPERSON: Please, do not speak like that. Take your seat.

...(Interruptions)

SHRI HANUMAN BENIWAL (NAGAUR): Hon. Chairperson, thank you for giving me the opportunity to present my views before the House on the Central University Amendment Bill, 2019. Certainly a huge initiative was taken between 2014 and 2019. Within all those areas, be it the tribal belt or the people sitting at the extreme end of North-East, the Bharatiya Janata Party government led NDA Government has worked with this thought that everyone should have equal right to education, every person should be educated, every society should be educated. The NDA government took a huge initiative. I would like to thank the hon. Human Resource Development Minister for

making a provision for setting up two universities within Andhra Pradesh, one a Central University and the other a Tribal University by the name of Andhra Pradesh Central Tribal University. The Bill says that the Central Universities Act, 2009 enacts for the establishment and incorporation of new universities for teaching and research in various states and for matters connected therewith. This Bill will ensure the establishment of one Central University and one Central Tribal University in the state of Andhra Pradesh. This will increase access to higher education and its quality. This will pave the way for higher education and research facilities for the public.

I have been the President of students' union of Rajasthan University. We had launched a huge movement in Rajasthan University 20 years ago to get the status of a Central University. At that time, most of the governments were of Congress. If the university gets the status of a Central University, it also gets additional grants from the UGC, all the money is given by the Central Government, all the subjects also become available, it does not have to depend solely on the State Government. There is less interference from the state government. I support this Bill on behalf of my party RLP. I support this initiative taken by the Government. I would also like to thank the hon. Minister for allowing 10 admissions on MP's recommendation in the Central Schools and perhaps now he is planning to raise it to 50 admissions. The hon. Minister has a very big heart. Our fights have also increased a lot. More than a thousand people visit us, how to select just ten people among them?

I have a request to the hon. Minister. Maximum number of central schools were opened within five years. Announcement has also been made in the cabinet meeting for 87 central schools. He has a big heart. There is reservation for SCs and STs in Navodaya schools but there is no reservation for OBCs, you should also consider this seriously. The matter of Tribal University has been mentioned in it. The Tribal University aims to promote the tribal art and culture of India by providing education and research facilities to explore advanced knowledge through technology. All states except Goa have one or two separate universities. A central university has been opened in Rajasthan. Rajasthan University, which is in Jaipur, should be accorded the status of a central university.

HON. CHAIRPERSON: Now you have expressed your views, so please sit down.

SHRI VINOD KUMAR SONKAR (KAUSHAMBI): Hon. Chairperson, I thank you for giving me an opportunity to speak on the Central Universities Amendment Bill, 2019. This is certainly a Bill that everyone will support and I also support it.

Hon. Chairperson, please make him sit, this is not the way.

HON. CHAIRPERSON: Please, sit down, your mike is off, your speech is not being recorded.

...(Interruptions)

SHRI VINOD KUMAR SONKAR: Hon. Chairperson, this will definitely fulfill the commitment of the people of Andhra Pradesh and the government there. The

government intends that foreign students should also come here to study. The government has also announced Rs 400 crore for this in the budget. Through this, the quality of education will improve.

Another matter is my concern. Hon. Prime Minister Narendra Bhai Modi ji has made arrangements for ten percent reservation for the upper castes of the country. I am not saying this baselessly. I want to know this on behalf of this society and bring it to your notice. I want your protection and the House's protection. Earlier there was reservation in the university and then suddenly it was abolished. The Modi government gave ten percent reservation to the poor belonging to the upper castes of the country, will this reservation to them be safe in the university or not? Between 2004 and 2014, when the UPA 1-2 government was in power, not only the means and resources of this country were looted but the poor from the SCs, STs, OBCs and upper caste communities were also deprived of their rights. In the year 2006, the government suddenly granted the status of minority university to the Jamia Millia Islamia University. Due to this, reservation for SCs, STs and OBCs ended there. This story is not new. The Congress Party has always done this in the country. In the year 1920, Aligarh Muslim University and Banaras Hindu University were first opened through an Act of the British Parliament.

An illusion was spread in the country that this is a minority university. When the country became independent, an amendment bill was brought in this House in the year 1951. On this amendment Bill, the then Education Minister

had clearly said that Aligarh Muslim University and Banaras Hindu University are not minority universities.

Hon'ble Chairperson, you are not giving me time to speak, but I want to say one thing that the way the rights of SCs, STs, OBCs of this country have been played with regarding Aligarh Muslim University.

I would like to request the hon. Minister through you that a white paper should be brought out in respect of Aligarh Muslim University... *(Interruptions)*

DR. AMAR SINGH (FATEHGARH SAHIB): Hon'ble Chairperson, thank you very much. I would put forth my views in brief.

[English]

Hon'ble Chairperson, I want to draw the attention of the hon. Minister. I will speak only for 2-3 minutes. I am not going to take much time.

Madam, I want to request the Minister to have a look at these two Reports, *[Translation]* which are of his government. Dr. Satyanarayan Jatiya was the Chairman of the Standing Committee on HRD, he had given the report. I want to request the hon. Minister through you that Chapter 8 of last year's Economic Survey is Transforming Science and Research, I want it to be looked again. Although Jatiya ji has said five-six things but in this he has said two main things. *[English]* First, all over the country, there is a lot of shortage of

funds. Secondly, there is distortion also. There are a large number of students under the State Universities but more funds are being given to the Central Universities. Hon. Minister, you have to look into the reason behind this and see whether you can make a balance between them. He has also mentioned that more than 40 percent vacancies are there in the universities. Madam, the hon. Minister has replied to a question on 4th July, itself. *[Translation]* The Government has admitted that out of 17,834 posts, 6719 are vacant. *[English]* Then, you are saying that filling of vacancies is a continuous process. *[Translation]* It is continuous. If there is retirement, but retirement is five to ten percent only and not 45 percent. *[English]* This needs the attention of the Government. This is a very serious issue.... *(Interruptions)*

Madam, this is my maiden speech. Please allow me. *[Translation]* I am speaking for the first time, please listen. *[English]* I support you on this Bill because you are bringing this Bill for Andhra Pradesh. It is a good Bill. *[Translation]* We are talking about a five trillion economy, it is a very good thing. India should become a ten trillion economy, not just five trillion economy. *[English]* The might of the West has been built with the help of research and innovation. It has not been made only by the funds.*[Translation]* Our condition is very bad.

I have one more request. Punjab University is 100 years old. The Government should look into it as its condition is very bad.

PROF. S. P. SINGH BAGHEL (AGRA): Hon. Chairperson, I would like to start my speech with these lines:

Khudi sukrat ki ho yaki ho judad Gandhi ki

Sadakat jindagi ke morche par maar jaati hai

Fate kapdon mein tan dhaake dikhta ho- jahan koi

Samaj lena wah pagdandi aadiwasi ke gaon jaati hai

Hon'ble Minister, Sir, you are bringing a university that too at a cost of Rs 900 crores for the tribal boys and girls who unsuccessfully try to cover their bodies with torn clothes.

This is called *'Antyodaya'* where the last person gets a smile on his face and gets education.

"Uttam Kheti, Madhyam Baan, Nishidh Chakri Bheekh Nidan".

We had a misunderstanding and did not go to school considering farming to be better. Then someone said it and we accepted it-

"Padhoge likhoge toh banoge kharab, kheloge koodoge toh banoge Nawab

That' why we could not become a Newab and got spoiled.

<u>15.54 hrs.</u>

(Hon. Speaker *in the Chair*)

Hon'ble Speaker, Sir, I have a request to you with folded hands that the university is being set up in Hyderabad, Andhra Pradesh. Please take care that this does not become another JNU. There must be some restrictions in the admissions that slogans should not be raised there. Slogans are raised in Jawahar Lal Nehru University that Afzal we are ashamed, your murderer is alive, Bharat will be broken into thousands parts, Inshallah, Inshallah. It must be kept that in mind because such children should not be admitted in any university of India. If they are not able to become nationalists, what will we do with their MSc, LLB, Ph.D, MBA, BBA, BCA, Hotel Management degrees? I feel ashamed that people having JNU degree raise such slogans. India is not a piece of land, it is a living and thriving nation. Kashmir is its forehead, Himalaya is its crown and *Gauri Shankar* is its hair. Punjab and Bengal are its strong shoulders, Vindhyachal is its waist, Narmada is its girdle, Eastern and Western Ghats are its two strong thighs and Kanyakumari washes its feet. Every pebble of this is rock stone and every drop is Ganga water. This is a land of worship and greetings. We will live for this and die for this. Therefore, you must impose some conditions on admission. I talk about Nalanda, Vikramshila, Takshshila, Vallabhi, Jagaddala and Andalpuri in Orissa. The Acharyas founded Vikramshila and Takshshila which are flourishing today....*(Interruptions)* Hon'ble Minister, Sir, Agra University was established in 1827 and Agra College came into existence in 1823. *[English]* It was affiliated with Kolkata University. *[Translation]* Kanpur University, Sahu Ji University, Kanpur, Chaudhary Charan Singh University, Meerut, Rohilkhand University,

Jaunpur University, Meerut University, Bareilly University, Jhansi, and Bundelkhand University were created from our Agra University. 26 universities were formed from our university and we are still there. Only the name of Agra University was changed to Dr. B.R. Ambedkar University. Agra is the capital of Dalit community. There is a university in the name of B.R. Ambedkar Saheb, whose three words have more power than the atom bomb - stay organized, get educated, and fight. Why didn't Baba Saheb say to stay organized, become educated, fight? He knew that unless we are educated, we cannot get organized and unless we are organized, we cannot fight. Therefore, as a tribute to Baba Saheb, the name of Agra University changed to his name, where two Presidents, the current President and Shankar Dayal Sharma, three Prime Ministers, Chaudhary Charan Singh, Gulzari Lal Nanda and Atal Bihari Vajpayee and two Chief Ministers - Kalyan Singh and Mulayam Singh Ji studied from this university which was set up in the year 1827. Right now it has only been named. If you want to pay true tribute to Baba Saheb, then make it a Central University. My college dates back to 1823 and has 10 thousand students. NET has accorded it a B Double Plus recognition. Not a single penny has to be invested in this, there is plenty of land for this, there are plenty of buildings, all that has to be done is to open a Central University and make Agra College a Deemed University. This is what I wanted to tell you. Thank you very much.

SHRI JASBIR SINGH GILL (KHADOOR SAHIB): I will say two things right away. This is a good Bill. I would urge the Hon'ble Minister that whatever tribal

universities are set up, there must be tribal schools of sports. *[English]* They have made their fortune in India. *[Translation]* Their athletics is also the best, so they should be promoted in sports.

Secondly, I have seen that the big corporate houses of India *[English]* have made their fortune in India. *[Translation]* But whenever it comes to giving money for research, three people who are the richest here, have given billions of dollars to American universities. Just today I was reading that there is another corporate house which gave 7 billion dollars to a university in Scotland. Will the Minister make such a provision, give some percentage of money to Indian universities, because they are making money from here, but when it comes to giving grants, they give it to foreign universities.

16.00 hrs

HON. SPEAKER: If all the Members agree, then the time should be extended till this Bill is passed, after that we will take up the Private Bill. Yes, we can take private Bill even after 6 pm. The decision of the Speaker is the final decision here. If the Speaker's Ruling is final then we will extend the time. It feels good when Members like you sit in the House. Many other Members are also sitting here.

SHRI JASBIR SINGH GILL: The corporate houses which fund foreign universities, such a provision should be made so that they fund our Indian universities and the second question is that I want to talk about Tarn Taran district, which is a backward district and also a border area. There is neither

any institute of excellence nor any government or private university there. Through you, I request the Hon'ble Minister to please give a Central University to Tarn Taran district. If you give then I and 25 lakh people who live there will also say that if there is Modi, it is possible. Thank you.

[Translation]

THE MINISTER OF HUMAN RESOURCE DEVELOPMENT (DR. RAMESH POKHRIYAL NISHANK): Hon. Speaker Sir, around 13 Members have expressed their views on this important Bill. Shri Suresh ji, Respected Rajiv Pratap Rudy ji, Sougata Ray ji, Shri Krishna ji, Rahul Shewale ji, B. Mahtab ji, Supriya Sule ji, Ram Mohan Naidu ji, Hanuman Beniwal ji, Vinod Kumar Sonkar ji, Amar Singh ji and Jasbir Sing Gill Saheb have given very important suggestions. I don't think that there was any time constraint because there were quite important suggestions too.

HON. SPEAKER: Hon'ble Minister, there is time constraint, and hence, make your points briefly. All are scholars.

DR. RAMESH POKHRIYAL NISHANK: Everyone might have different answers because this is related with the implementation of Andhra Pradesh Reorganization Act, 2014. I am pleased to state that it is a matter of happiness for reorganisation of any state after independence. Sir, my state was also reorganised but after independence, only the Narendra Modi Government has set up the institutions of national and international level within such a short span of period after reorganization of any state. Andhra Pradesh was reorganised in 2014. Thereafter, our Government opened IIT, NIT, IIIT, ICAR, IIM and after these five important institutions, the this Bill has been moved par passing after consideration. Today, the Government of Modi ji has dedicated 7 important institutions including two universities to the people of Andhra

Pradesh. It appears to me that Mahtab ji asked as to why it was delayed with reference to Andhra Pradesh? The truth is that actions continued to be taken in this regard. If there had been time, then I would have explained it to Mahtab ji as to how many times correspondence was made constantly but the land for the same was to be provided by the Government and only after determining the location and availability of land, these institutions could have been in established.

Sir, Suresh ji is not here but many hon'ble Members along with him raised their doubts on the budget. I would like to tell them that the budget for education for the year 2013-14 was Rs. 66,000 crore but my Government has given the budget of Rs. 95,000 crore this time and if I include the budget for scholarship which is not a part of the budget and which amounts to Rs.30,000 crore it becomes a budget of Rs. 1.25 lakh crore for education department which is beyond anyone's imagination.

We are continuously working towards establishing big higher institutions. I think that the Nalanda University in Bihar, Vikramshila University or Takshila University about which I mentioned were the top institutions in the world. These universities were in existence at the time when there was no mention of education in the world, and these learning centres illuminated the whole world.

Sir, Sougata Da said that there was no provision for tribal university in that. It is not so, there are all provisions in this regard. So far as provisions

regarding the Universities are concerned, all sorts of provisions have been made for the university. He expressed his concern for the Vishwa Bharti University. I think that our Government is making all out efforts to develop the Vishwa Bharti University. Vishwa Bharti is our top priority. Hon'ble Member, Shri Krishna ji too talked about savings and mentioned Eklavya but that is being covered under another scheme and if the need arises, I would elaborate them also. Rahul ji talked about the foreign students and Mumbai University. Our first priority is for these.

Sir, I am happy to say that today our three institutions have reached the top positions in the global ranking while five years ago, our educational institutions used to stand nowhere in the global ranking. These institutions are- IIT Mumbai, IIT Delhi and IISC Bengaluru. These three institutions are in the top rankings of the world and 23 institutions have touched that standard. We are moving ahead at fast pace in the education sector. Hon'ble Mahtab ji said this. The second thing he talked about was the study in India programme. You are well aware of the fact and you yourselves said that the majority of our students are going abroad. Both the students and the teachers abroad are from our country. So, with the study in India programme, we will bring the students and teachers back and take our education system at its height. This is its aim and we are becoming successful in this. Another Member asked as to what is in it. We are taking it ahead in a nice way.

The appointments that Supriya ji mentioned about, were discussed earlier also, and you asked as to why we were dealing with the issue in a

piecemeal manner. You said that first we brought the Bill to fill the vacant posts then brought second and third Bill. You are right but at least we are bringing it and in such a short time. We brought four Bills in one month and are continuously doing so. We have told that the vacant posts would be filled in the next six months. We have done it very fast and brought the Bill for it. We made whatever amendment was required to be made. The Hon'ble Member expressed his concern and it is natural concern that if there are no teachers then how will the education be imparted. There were some legal difficulties in it earlier but now we have solved it and we will do it at war footing level... *(Interruptions)*

SHRI RAJIV PRATAP RUDY: Have you assured the House about it?*....(Interruptions)*

DR. RAMESH POKHRIYAL NISHANK: Yes, I have assured the House. I have mentioned it in the Act itself. And now, I am repeating that all posts will be filled at the earliest.

Hon'ble Member, Rammohan Naidu ji has said something, so I would like to say that I accept that it is token money. I am happy to say that there is provision for sufficient funds for this. A sum of Rs.1700 crore has been sanctioned in principle for these two institutions. For now, we are providing Rs. 420 crore and Rs. 450 crore as token money. It would be utilised within four years. Its time is fixed. In the first phase, Rs. 420 crore and Rs. 450 crore

have been allocated as first installment.....*(Interruptions)* It's okay. It would be done.

Sir, I think that Hon. Member Shri Ram Mohan Naidu ji has a doubt. I would like to say to him that if anyone has worked, it is our Government only and 100 per cent result would be achieved by it.

Next time, no one else but our party will form the Government in Andhra Pradesh because we have worked and given proof of it. We have done that work and this is the proof of it. We didn't speak, we didn't deliver speech, we have worked on the ground and the outcome of this endeavour would start coming just from here. Hanuman Beniwal ji has made a mention of it. I would like to thank him. It is a fact that our Government has paid most attention to education. We have paid most attention to it to ensure that no state lags behind in any sector, be it Kendriya Vidyalaya, Central University, IIT, NIT. IIIT or IIM. Hence, we have accorded top priority to such states. The concern expressed by Shri Vinod Sonkar ji, is important enough in itself. You have suggested some points to be followed by the Government in future. The Government will surely consider what you have suggested. The concern of Satyanarayan Jatiya, expressed by Amar Singh ji and Guillotine, I think that I have addressed the concern raised by you about the budget. But, yes, the top most priority of our Government is that the education system may be

strengthened. The point raised by Baghel ji that we should not develop a JNU here, I agree to this…..*(Interruptions)*

KUNWAR DANISH ALI (AMROHA): JNU has contributed very much to this country. *...(Interruptions)*

DR. RAMESH POKHRIYAL NISHANK: Sir, I would like to say that JNU is the topmost research University in the world. We will take care of JNU and run it efficently. JNU is not an ordinary institution. It is at its pinnacle in the world insofar as research is concerned. A few people have maligned it, this Government would not let those few people succeed in their motives. We will run JNU in an efficient manner. We will take it forward. I know that JNU is a very good institution. JNU has its own place in world in the sphere of research and that status of JNU will be kept intact. It would be taken to the top. No question of keeping it out of the main stream of the nation arises.

Our elder brother has expressed his concern about coaching, and I understand that there is competition, and this is not true that colleges are not doing anything in this respect. I would like to tell you how many of our institutions are on top ranking of the world. The faculties engaged in imparting education in the world including the American Universities have studied in India and became faculty members there. I accpt that because of competition, the students are going to the coaching institutions but generally, it is a state subject.

Sir, I think that Gill saheb also talked about the backward region. Generally, everyone has expressed concern about education and the Government is surely determined that the education system of this country would be strengthened. India was *Vishwaguru* in the past and the status of '*Vishwaguru*' will be restored back to India. I would like to humbly request that on the subject of education, I congratulate the people of Andhra Pradesh and all the Hon. Members of Andhra Pradesh that a new light has come to Andhra Pradesh. There would be the atmosphere of festival there today. Therefore, I urge upon you to give unanimous support to this Bill and pass it. Thank you.

HON. SPEAKER: The question is:

"That the Bill further to amend the Central University Act 2009 be taken in consideration."

The motion was adopted.

HON. SPEAKER: Now, the House would consider the Bill clause-wise.

Clause 2 Insertion of new section 3C and 3D. *[English]*

[English]

SHRI N. K. PREMACHANDRAN (KOLLAM): Sir, I did not speak on the Bill. I fully support the Bill. Access to higher education and quality of education both are equally important. This is a Bill that seeks to provide tribal community to have access to higher education for special arts, their talents and their tradition

etc. Nowadays disciplines also are being given the status of universities. So, my only submission through this amendment is to have an Ayurvedic University. There are medical universities, engineering college universities, there are the IITs. So, many universities in the name of their disciplines are being formed in the country. My suggestion, through this amendment, is to establish an Ayurveda University which shall be a body corporate to be known as the Central Ayurvedic University. The State of Kerala is a traditional centre for Ayurveda. Particularly Kollam, my Parliamentary constituency is the best place for having an Ayurveda University. That is the amendment I would like to propose. The hon. Minister for AYUSH is also here. I know it is very difficult to accept the proposal but if any assurance comes from the Government, then definitely I will withdraw my amendment.

[Translation]

HON. SPEAKER: Shri Premchandran ji, do you want to move the amendment?

[English]

SHRI N. K. PREMACHANDRAN: Sir, I am moving my amendment No. 3 to clause 2 of the Bill. Let it be on record.

I beg to move:

Page 2, *after* line 4,--

Insert "3CA. There shall be established an Ayurveda University, which shall be a body corporate, to be known as the Central Ayurveda University, Kollam, Kerala, having its territorial jurisdiction extending to the whole of the State of Kerala as specified in the First Schedule to this Act to provide avenues of higher education and research facilities in Ayurveda".

(3)

[Translation]

HON. SPEAKER: Now, I put the amendment number 3 to clause 2 moved by Shri N. K. Premchandran to the vote of the House.

The motion was negativated.

HON.SPEAKER: The question is:

"That clause 2 stand the part of the Bill".

The motion was adopted.

Clause 2 was added to the Bill.

Clause 3 was added to the Bill.

Clause 4 Substitution of new schedule for First Schedule.

HON. SPEAKER: Shri Kodikunnil Suresh, do you want to move the amendment?

[English]

SHRI KODIKUNNIL SURESH (MAVELIKKARA): Sir, during the course of my speech I requested the hon. Minister to rename the university in Kasaragod in Kerala in the name of Sree Narayana Guru. I am moving my amendment no. 1 to clause 4 of the Bill.

Sir, I beg to move:

Page 3, line 4,--

For "Central University of Kerala"

substitute "Sree Narayana Guru Central University of Kerala".

(1)

[Translation]

HON. SPEAKER: Now, I put amendment no.1 to Clause 4 moved by Shri Kodikunnil Suresh to the vote of the House.

The motion was negativated.

HON. SPEAKER: Shri Adhir Ranjan Chowdhury, do you want to move the amendment?

SHRI ADHIR RANJAN CHOWDHURY (BAHARAMPUR): Hon. Speaker sir, after the submission of Sachchar Committee Report, a campus of Aligarh Muslim University was proposed to be opened at places in India such as

Malappuram, Murshidabad, Kishanganj etc. where the magority of Muslim population dwell. I hail from Murshidabad district. Though Aligarh Muslim University exists here but no infrastrcture has been developed for it. Though the land is available but education is not being imparted in the way it should. Murshidabad district was the former capital of Bengal, Bihar and Odisha. While drawing the attention of the Hon. Minister, I would like to say that Murshidabad district which is very backward is incorporated in your list of aspirational district. Kindly consider the request of making a quality arrangement for education in Aligarh Muslim University and Mushidabad Central University in this district.

Page 3, after line 16--

Insert "17. West Bengal, Murshidabad Central University, entire West Bengal State." (2)

HON. SPEAKER: Now, I put the amendment no.2 to clause 4 moved by Shri Adhir Ranjan Chowdhury to the vote of the House.

The motion was negativated.

HON. SPEAKER: Shri N. K. Premchandran, do you want to move your amendment?

[English]

SHRI N. K. PREMACHANDRAN: Sir, I am moving my amendment no. 4 to clause 4.

Sir, I beg to move:

Page 3, *after* line 5,--

Insert	"12A. Kerala	Central Ayurvedic University Kollam, Kerala.	Whole of the State of Kerala."
			(4)

[Translation]

HON. SPEKAER: Now, I put amendment No. 4 to clause 4 moved by Shri N. K. Premchandran to the vote the House.

The motion was negitavated.

HON. SPEAKER: The question is

" That this clause 4 be the part of Bill.

The motion was adopted.

The clause 4 was added to the Bill.

Clause 1, enactment formulae and long title of the Bill were added to the Bill".

DR. RAMESH POKHRIYAL NISHANK: I beg to move:

"That the Bill be passed".

HON. SPEAKER: That the question is:

"That the Bill be passed".

The motion was adopted.

16.20 hrs

PRIVATE MEMBERS' BILLS- Introduced

(i)Payment of Financial Assistance to the Families of Martyrs Bill, 2019*

[English]

SHRIMATI SUPRIYA SADANAND SULE (BARAMATI): I beg to move for leave to introduce a Bill to establish an Authority to oversee the payment of financial assistance including ex-gratia lump sum honorarium of rupees two crore, provision of medical facilities, education and housing allowance, reservation upto five per cent in schools and institutions of higher education and five per cent reservation in jobs in both public and private sector for the dependents of martyrs and implementation of such other welfare measures as are necessary to enable them to lead a dignified life and for matters connected therewith or incidental thereto.

[Translation]

HON. SPEAKER: The question is:

"That the leave is granted to introduce a Bill to establish an Authority to oversee the payment of financial assistance including ex-gratia lump sum honorarium of rupees two crore, provision of medical facilities, education and housing allowance, reservation up to five per cent in schools and institutions of higher education and five per cent reservation in jobs in both public and private sector for the dependents of martyrs and

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* Published in the Gazette of India, Extraordinary, Part-II, Section-2, dated 12.07.2019.

implementation of such other welfare measures as are necessary to enable them to lead a dignified life and for matters connected therewith or incidental thereto".

The motion was adopted.

[English]

SHRIMATI SUPRIYA SADANAND SULE: I introduce* the Bill.

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* Introduced with the recommendation of the President.

16.20 ½ hrs

(ii) Indian Post Office (Amendment) Bill, 2019*

(*Insertion of new Chapter IIA)*

[English]

SHRIMATI SUPRIYA SADANAND SULE (BARAMATI): I beg to move for leave to introduce a Bill further to amend the Indian Post Office Act, 1898.

[Translation]

HON. SPEAKER: The question is:

"That the leave be granted to introduce a Bill further to amend the Indian Post Office Act, 1898."

The motion was adopted.

[English]

SHRIMATI SUPRIYA SADANAND SULE: I introduce** the Bill.

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* Published in the Gazette of India, Extraordinary, Part-II, Section-2, dated 12.07.2019.

** Introduced with the recommendation of the President.

16.21 hrs

(iii)Companies (Amendment) Bill, 2019*

(Amendment of section 135, etc.)

[English]

SHRIMATI SUPRIYA SADANAND SULE (BARAMATI): I beg to move for leave to introduce a Bill further to amend the Companies Act, 2013.

[Translation]

HON. SPEAKER: The question is:

"That the leave be granted to introduce a Bill further to amend the Companies Act, 2013".

The motion was adopted.

[English]

SHRIMATI SUPRIYA SADANAND SULE: I introduce the Bill.

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* Published in the Gazette of India, Extraordinary, Part-II, Section-2, dated 12.07.2019.

16.21 ½ hrs

(iv) Youth Skill Training Bill, 2019*

[English]

SHRIMATI SUPRIYA SADANAND SULE (BARAMATI): I beg to move for leave to introduce a Bill further to impart skill training to every youth to make them more employable; to provide an alternative path for those pursuing higher education as part of corporate social responsibility and to expand education opportunities for the young and socially disadvantaged section and for matters connected therewith or incidental thereto.

[Translation]

HON. SPEAKER: The question is:

"That the leave be granted to introduce a Bill further to impart skill training to every youth to make them more employable; to provide an alternative path for those pursuing higher education as part of corporate social responsibility and to expand education opportunities for the young and socially disadvantaged section and for matters connected therewith or incidental thereto".

The motion waa adopted.

[English]

SHRIMATI SUPRIYA SADANAND SULE: I introduce** the Bill.

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* Published in the Gazette of India, Extraordinary, Part-II, Section-2, dated 12.07.2019.

* * Introduced with the recommendation of the President,

16.22 hrs

(v) Hindu Adoption and Matintenance (Amendment) Bill, 2019*

(Amendment of section 18)

[English]

SHRI RAHUL RAMESH SHEWALE (**MUMBAI SOUTH-CENTRAL**): I beg to move for leave to introduce a Bill further to amend the Hindu Adoptions and Maintenance Act, 1956.

[Translation]

HON. SPEAKER: The question is:

"That the leave be granted to introduce a Bill further to amend the Hindu Adoptions and Maintenance Act, 1956 ".

The Motion was adopted.

[English]

SHRI RAHUL RAMESH SHEWALE: I introduce the Bill.

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* Published in the Gazette of India, Extraordinary, Part-II, Section-2, dated 12.07.2019.

16.22 ½ hrs

(vi) Motor Vehicles Amendment Bill, 2019*

(Amendment of section 184)

[English]

SHRI RAHUL RAMESH SHEWALE (MUMBAI SOUTH-CENTRAL): I beg to move for leave to introduce a Bill further to amend the Motor Vehicles Act, 1988.

[Translation]

HON. SPEAKER: The question is:

" That the leave be granted to introduce a Bill further to amend the Motor Vehicles Act, 1988.''

The Motion was adopted.

[English]

SHRI RAHUL RAMESH SHEWALE: I introduce the Bill.

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* Published in the Gazette of India, Extraordinary, Part-II, Section-2, dated 12.07.2019.

16.23 hrs

(vii) Protecton of Rights of Wrongful Convicts Bill, 2019*

[English]

DR.(PROF.) KIRIT PREMJIBHAI SOLANKI (AHMEDABAD WEST): I beg to move for leave to introduce a Bill to establish a procedure for safeguarding the rights of wrongful convicts and for matters connected therewith or incidental thereto.

[Translation]

Hon. Speaker: The question is:

"That the leave be granted to introduce a Bill further to establish a procedure for safeguarding the rights of wrongful convicts and for matter connected therewith or incidental thereto".

The Motion was adopted.

[English]

DR.(PROF.) KIRIT PREMJIBHAI SOLANKI: I introduce** the Bill.

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* Published in the Gazette of India, Extraordinary, Part-II, Section-2, dated 12.07.2019.

* * Introduced with the recommendation of the President,

16.23 ½ hrs

(viii) Scheduled Tribes and other Traditional Forest Dwellers (Recognition of Forest Rights) Amendment Bill, 2019*

(Amendment of section 2, etc.)

[English]

DR.(PROF.) KIRIT PREMJIBHAI SOLANKI (AHMEDABAD WEST): I beg to move for leave to introduce a Bill to amend the Scheduled Tribes and other Traditional Forest Dwellers (Recognition of Forest Rights) Act, 2006.

[Translation]

HON. SPEAKER: The question is:

" That the leave be granted to introduce a Bill further to amend the Scheduled Tribes and other Traditional Forest Dwellers (Recognition of Forest Rights) Act, 2006."

The Motion was adopted.

[English]

DR.(PROF.) KIRIT PREMJIBHAI SOLANKI: I introduce the Bill.

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* Published in the Gazette of India, Extraordinary, Part-II, Section-2, dated 12.07.2019.

16.24 hrs

(ix) Compensatory Afforestation Fund (Amendment) Bill, 2019*

(Insertion of new section 6A, etc.)

[English]

DR.(PROF.) KIRIT PREMJIBHAI SOLANKI (AHMEDABAD WEST): I beg to move for leave to introduce a Bill to amend the Compensatory Afforestation Fund Act, 2016.

[Translation]

HON. SPEAKER: The question is:

"That the leave be granted to introduce a Bill further to amend the Compensatory Afforestation Fund Act, 2016."

The motion was adopted.

[English]

DR.(PROF.) KIRIT PREMJIBHAI SOLANKI: I introduce the Bill.

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* Published in the Gazette of India, Extraordinary, Part-II, Section-2, dated 12.07.2019.

16.25 hrs

(x) Wild Life (Protection) Amendment Bill, 2019*

(Insertion of new Chapter IVD, etc.)

[English]

DR.(PROF.) KIRIT PREMJIBHAI SOLANKI (AHMEDABAD WEST): Sir, I beg to move for leave to introduce a Bill further to amend the Wild life (Protection) Act, 1972.

[Translation]

HON. SPEAKER: The question is:

"That the leave be granted to introduce a Bill further to amend the Wild Life (Protection) Act, 1972 .''

The motion was adopted.

[English]

DR.(PROF.) KIRIT PREMJIBHAI SOLANKI: Sir, I introduce** the Bill.

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* Published in the Gazette of India, Extraordinary, Part-II, Section-2, dated 12.07.2019.

* * Introduced with the recommendation of the President,

16.25 ½ hrs

(xi) National Agriculture Policy Commission Bill, 2019*

[Translation]

SHRI NIHAL CHAND CHOUHAN (GANGANAGAR): I beg to move for leave to introduce a Bill to provide for establishment of a National Agriculture Policy Commission to formulate policies on improvement and development of agriculture in the country and for matters connected therewith or incidental thereto.

HON. SPEAKER: The question is:

"That the leave be granted to introduce a Bill to provide for establishment of National Agricultural Policy Commission to formulate policies on improvement and development of agriculture in the country and for matters connected therewith or incidental thereto".

The motion was adopted.

SHRI NIHAL CHAND CHOUHAN: I introduce** the bill.

---

* Published in the Gazette of India, Extraordinary, Part-II, Section-2, dated 12.07.2019.

** Introduced with the recommendation of the President,

16.26 hrs

(xii) National Sports Development Commission Bill, 2019*

[Translation]

SHRI NIHAL CHAND CHOUHAN (GANGANAGAR): I beg to move for leave to introduce a Bill further to provide for constitution of National Sports Development Commission for the overall development of Sports,improving the quality of basic Sports facilities in the country and for matters connected therewith or incidental thereto.

HON. SPEAKER: The question is:

"That the leave be granted to introduce a Bill further to provide for constitution of National Sports Development Commission for the overall development of Sports, improving the quality of basic Sports facilities in the country and for matters connected therewith or incidental thereto.''

The motion was adopted.

SHRI NIHAL CHAND CHOUHAN: I introduce** the Bill.

---

* Published in the Gazette of India, Extraordinary, Part-II, Section-2, dated 12.07.2019.

* * Introduced with the recommendation of the President,

16.26 ½ hrs

(xiii) National Malnutrition Policy Commission Bill, 2019*

[Translation]

SHRI NIHAL CHAND CHAUHAN (GANGANAGAR): I beg to move for leave to introduce a Bill further to provide for constitution of National Malnutrition Policy Commission and for matters connected therewith or incidental thereto.

HON. SPEAKER: The question is:

"That the leave be granted to introduce a Bill further to provide for constitution of National Malnutrition Policy Commission and for matters connected therewith or incidental thereto".

The motion was adopted.

SHRI NIHAL CHAND CHOUHAN: I introduce** the Bill.

---

* Published in the Gazette of India, Extraordinary, Part-II, Section-2, dated 12.07.2019.

* * Introduced with the recommendation of the President.

16.27 hrs

(xiv)Constitution (Amendment) Bill, 2019*

(Substitution of new article for article 9, etc.)

[English]

DR. SHASHI THAROOR (THIRUVANANTHAPURAM): Sir, I beg to move for leave to introduce a Bill further to amend the Constitution of India.

[Translation]

HON. SPEAKER: The question is:

" That the leave be granted to introduce a Bill further to amend the Constitution of India ".

The motion was adopted.

[English]

DR. SHASHI THAROOR: Sir, I introduce the Bill.

---

* Published in the Gazette of India, Extraordinary, Part-II, Section-2, dated 12.07.2019.

16.27 ½ hrs

(xv) Constitution (Amendment) Bill, 2019*

(Insertion of new article 14A, etc.)

[English]

DR. SHASHI THAROOR (THIRUVANANTHAPURAM): Sir, I beg to move for leave to introduce a Bill further to amend the Constitution of India.

[Translation]

HON. SPEAKER: The question is:

"That the leave be granted to introduce a Bill further to amend the Constitution of India".

The motion was adopted.

[English]

DR. SHASHI THAROOR: Sir, I introduce the Bill.

---

* Published in the Gazette of India, Extraordinary, Part-II, Section-2, dated 12.07.2019.

16.28 hrs

(xvi) Indian Penal Code (Amendment) Bill, 2019*

(Omission of sections 354 and 509)

[English]

DR. SHASHI THAROOR (THIRUVANANTHAPURAM): Sir, I beg to move for leave to introduce a Bill further to amend the Indian Penal Code, 1860.

[Translation]

HON. SPEAKER: The question is:

"That the leave be granted to introduce a Bill further to amend the Indian Penal Code, 1860."

The motion was adopted.

[English]

DR. SHASHI THAROOR: Sir, I introduce the Bill.

---

* Published in the Gazette of India, Extraordinary, Part-II, Section-2, dated 12.07.2019.

16.28 hrs

(xvii) States and Union Territories Reorganisation Commission Bill, 2019*

[English]

DR. SHASHI THAROOR (THIRUVANANTHAPURAM): Sir, I beg to move for leave to introduce a Bill to provide for the establishment of a States and Union territories Reorganisation Commission to recommend the reorganisation of States and Union territories to the Central Government through periodic review of demands of new States or Union territories on the basis of administrative efficacy and related grounds and for matters connected therewith or incidental thereto.

[Translation]

HON. SPEAKER: The question is:

" That the leave be granted to introduce a Bill to provide for the establishment of a States and Union Territories Re-organisation Commission to recommend the reorganization of States and Union Territories to the Central Government through periodic review of demands of new States or Union Territories on the basis of administrative efficacy and related grounds and for matters connected therewith or incidental thereto."

The motion was adopted.

[Engish]

DR. SHASHI THAROOR: Sir, I introduce** the Bill.

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* Published in the Gazette of India, Extraordinary, Part-II, Section-2, dated 12.07.2019.

** Introduced with the recommendation of the President,

16.29 hrs

(xviii) Reservation for Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes in Private Sector Bill, 2019*

[English]

SHRI SURESH KODIKUNNIL (MAVELIKKARA): Sir, I beg to move for leave to introduce a Bill to provide for reservation for the person belonging to the Scheduled Castes and the Scheduled Tribes in private sector and for matters connected therewith.

[Translation]

HON. SPEAKER: The question is:

"That the leave be granted to introduce a Bill to provide for reservation for the person belonging to the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes in private sector and for matters connected therewith."

The motion was adopted.

[English]

SHRI SURESH KODIKUNNIL: Sir, I introduce the Bill.

---

* Published in the Gazette of India, Extraordinary, Part-II, Section-2, dated 12.07.2019.

16.29 ½ hrs

(xix) Designation of Islamic Republic of Pakistan as State Sponsor of Terrorism Bill, 2019*

[Translation]

DR. SANJAY JAISWAL (WEST CHAMPARAN): I beg to move for leave to introduce a Bill to designate Islamic Republic of Pakistan as state sponsor of terrorism and for matters connected therewith or incidental thereto.

HON. SPEAKER: The question is:

"That the leave be granted to introduce a Bill to designate Islamic Republic of Pakistan as State sponsor of terrorism and for matters connected therewith or incidental thereto."

The motion was adopted.

DR. SANJAY JAISWAL: Sir, I introduce the Bill.

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* Published in the Gazette of India, Extraordinary, Part-II, Section-2, dated 12.07.2019.

16.30 hrs

(xx) Vexatious Litigation (Prevention) Bill, 2019*

[Translation]

DR. SANJAY JAISWAL (WEST CHAMPARAN): I beg to move for the leave to introduce a Bill to prevent the institution or continuance of vexatious proceedings in Civil and criminal matters in the High courts and courts subordinate thereto and for matters connected therewith or incidental thereto.

HON. SPEAKER: The question is:

‘‘That the leave be granted to introduce a Bill to prevent the institution or continuance of Vexatious proceedings in civil and criminal matters in the High Courts and Courts subordinate thereto and for matters connected therewith or incidental thereto."

The motion was adopted.

Dr. Sanjay Jaiswal: Sir, I introduce the Bill

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* Published in the Gazette of India, Extraordinary, Part-II, Section-2, dated 12.07.2019.

16.31 hrs

(xxi) Representation of the People (Amendment) Bill, 2019*

(Insertion of new section 29AA)

[Translation]

SHRI GOPAL SHETTY (MUMBAI NORTH): Hon. Speaker, I beg to move for leave to introduce a Bill further to amend the Representation of the People Act, 1951.

HON. SPEAKER: The question is:

"That the leave be granted to introduce a Bill further to amend the Representation of the People Act, 1951."

SHRI GOPAL SHETTY: Sir, I introduce the Bill.

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* Published in the Gazette of India, Extraordinary, Part-II, Section-2, dated 12.07.2019.

16.31 ½ hrs

(xxii) **Constitution (Amendment) Bill, 2019***

(Amendment of the Third Schedule)

[Translation]

SHRI GOPAL SHETTY (MUMBAI NORTH): I beg to move for leave to introduce a Bill further to amend the Constitution of India.

HON. SPEAKER: The question is:

"That the leave be granted to introduce a Bill further to amend the Constitution of India".

The motion was adopted.

SHRI GOPAL SHETTY: Sir, I introduce the Bill.

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* Published in the Gazette of India, Extraordinary, Part-II, Section-2, dated 12.07.2019.

16.32 hrs

(xxiii) Press Council (Amendment) Bill, 2019*

(*Amendment of section 14*)

[Translation]

SHRI GOPAL SHETTY (MUMBAI NORTH): I beg to move for leave to introduce a Bill further to amend the Press Council Act, 1978.

HON. SPEAKER: The question is:

"That the leave be granted to introduce a Bill further to amend the Press Council Act, 1978".

The motion was adopted.

SHRI GOPAL SHETTY: Sir, I introduce the Bill.

---

* Published in the Gazette of India, Extraordinary, Part-II, Section-2, dated 12.07.2019.

16.33 hrs

(xxiv) Constitution (Amendment) Bill, 2019*

(*Amendment of article 85*)

[Translation]

SHRI GOPAL SHETTY (MUMBAI NORTH): I beg to move for leave to introduce a Bill further to amend the Constitution of India.

HON. SPEAKER: The question is :

"That the leave be granted to introduce a Bill further to amend the Constitution of India".

The motion was adopted.

SHRI GOPAL SHETTY: Sir, I introduce the Bill.

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* Published in the Gazette of India, Extraordinary, Part-II, Section-2, dated 12.07.2019.

16.33 ½ hrs

(xxv) Constitution (Amendment) Bill, 2019*

(*Amendment of the Eighth Schedule)*

[Translation]

SHRI RAVI KISHAN (GORAKHPUR): Hon. Speaker, I beg to move for leave to introduce a Bill further to amend the Constitution of India.

HON. SPEAKER: The question is:

"That the leave be granted to introduce a Bill further to amend the Constitution of India".

The motion was adopted.

SHRI RAVI KISHAN: Sir, I to introduce the Bill.

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* Published in the Gazette of India, Extraordinary, Part-II, Section-2, dated 12.07.2019.

16.34 hrs

(xxvi) Ban on Cow Slaughter Bill, 2019*

[Translation]

SHRI RAVI KISHAN (GORAKHPUR): Hon. Speaker, I beg to move for leave to introduce a Bill to prohibit the slaughter of cow and its progeny.

HON. SPEAKER: The question is:

"That the leave be granted to introduce a Bill to prohibit the slaughter of cow and its progeny".

The motion was adopted.

SHRI RAVI KISAHN: Sir, I introduce the Bill.

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* Published in the Gazette of India, Extraordinary, Part-II, Section-2, dated 12.07.2019.

16.34 ½ hrs

(xxvii) Constitution (Amendment) Bill, 2019*

(Amendment of article 1)

[Translation]

SHRI RAVI KISHAN (GORAKHPUR): Hon. Speaker, I beg to move for leave to introduce a Bill further to amend the Constitution of India.

HON. SPEAKER: The question is

" That the leave be granted to introduce a Bill further to amend the Constitution of India".

The motion was adopted.

SHRI RAVI KISHAN: Sir, I introduce the Bill.

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* Published in the Gazette of India, Extraordinary, Part-II, Section-2, dated 12.07.2019.

16.35 hrs

(xxviii) Constitution (Amendment) Bill, 2019*

(*Omission of article 44, etc.)*

[Translation]

SHRI RAVI KISHAN (GORAKHPUR): Hon. Speaker, I beg to move for leave to introduce a Bill further to amend the Constitution of India.

HON. SPEAKER: The question is:

" That the leave be granted to introduce a Bill further to amend the Constitution of India".

The motion was adopted.

SHRI RAVI KISHAN: Sir, I introduce the Bill.

* Published in the Gazette of India, Extraordinary, Part-II, Section-2, dated 12.07.2019.

16.36 hrs

(xxix) Constitution (Amendment) Bill, 2019*

(*Insertion of new article 324A)*

[English]

SHRI P. P. CHAUDHARY (PALI): Sir, I beg to move for leave to introduce a Bill further to amend the Constitution of India.

[Translation]

HON. SPEAKER: The question is:

" That the leave be granted to introduce a bill further to amend the Constitution of India".

The motion was adopted.

[English]

SHRI P. P. CHAUDHARY: I introduce the Bill.

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* Published in the Gazette of India, Extraordinary, Part-II, Section-2, dated 12.07.2019.

16.36 ½ hrs

(xxx) Constitution (Amendment) Bill, 2019*

(Insertion of new article 21B)

[English]

SHRI P. P. CHAUDHARY (PALI): Sir, I beg to move for leave to introduce a Bill further to amend the Constitution of India.

[Translation]

HON. SPEAKER: The question is:

"That the leave be granted to introduce a Bill further to amend the Constitution of India".

The motion was adopted.

[English]

SHRI P. P. CHAUDHARY: I introduce the Bill.

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* Published in the Gazette of India, Extraordinary, Part-II, Section-2, dated 12.07.2019.

16.37 hrs

(xxxi) Constitution (Amendment) Bill, 2019*

(*Amendment of article 370*)

[English]

SHRI P. P. CHAUDHARY (PALI): Sir, I beg to move for leave to introduce a Bill further to amend the Constitution of India.

[Translation]

HON. SPEAKER: The question is:

"That the leave be granted to introduce a Bill further to amend the Constitution of India".

The motion was adopted.

[English]

SHRI P. P. CHAUDHARY: I introduce the Bill.

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* Published in the Gazette of India, Extraordinary, Part-II, Section-2, dated 12.07.2019.

16.37 ½ hrs

(xxxii)Constitution (Amendment) Bill, 2019*

(*Amendment of article 66*)

[English]

SHRI P. P. CHAUDHARY (PALI): Sir, I beg to move for leave to introduce a Bill further to amend the Constitution of India.

[Translation]

HON. SPEAKER: The question is:

"That the leave be granted to introduce a Bill further to amend the Constitution of India".

The motion was adopted.

[English]

SHRI P. P. CHAUDHARY: I introduce the Bill.

[Translation]

HON. SPEAKER: Item No. 46

Shri Vishnu Dayal Ram: not present.

* Published in the Gazette of India, Extraordinary, Part-II, Section-2, dated 12.07.2019.

16.38 hrs

(xxxiii) Bi0-degradable Packaging Materials

(Compulsory Use in Packing Commodities) Bill, 2019*

[English]

SHRI PARVESH SAHIB SINGH VERMA (WEST DELHI): Sir, I beg to move for leave to introduce a Bill to provide for the compulsory use of bio-degradable packaging material in the supply and distribution of certain commodities with the aim to curb the usage of plastic and such other non-degradable material in packing, and in the interests of the environment.

[Translation]

HON. SPEAKER: The question is:

" That the leave be granted to introduce a Bill to provide for the compulsory use of bio-degradable packaging material in the supply and distribution of certain commodities with the aim to curb the usage of plastic and such other non-degradable material in packing and in the interests of the environment."

The motion was adopted.

[English]

SHRI PARVESH SAHIB SINGH VERMA: I introduce** the Bill.

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* Published in the Gazette of India, Extraordinary, Part-II, Section-2, dated 12.07.2019.

** Introduced with the recommendation of the President

16.40 hrs

(xxxiv) Indian Penal Code (Amendment) Bill, 2019*

(Substitution new section for section 497)

[Translation]

SHRI JAGDAMBIKA PAL (DOMARIYAGANJ): Hon. Speaker Sir, I beg to move for leave to introduce a Bill further to amend the Indian Penal Code, 1860.

HON. SPEAKER: The question is:

"That the leave be granted to introduce a Bill further to amend the Indian Penal Code, 1860".

The motion was adopted.

SHRI JAGDAMBIKA PAL: Sir, I introduce the Bill.

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* Published in the Gazette of India, Extraordinary, Part-II, Section-2, dated 12.07.2019.

16.41 hrs

(xxxv) Pre-Examination Coaching Centres Regulatory Authority Bill, 2019*

[Translation]

SHRI JAGDAMBIKA PAL (DOMARIYAGANJ): Speaker Sir, I beg to move for leave to introduce a Bill to provide for the constitution of a Regulatory Authority for regulation of pre-examination coaching centres and matters connected therewith.

HON. SPEAKER: The question is:

"That the leave be granted to introduce a Bill to provide for the constitution of a Regulatory Authority for regulation of Pre-examination Coaching Centres and for matters connected therewith".

The motion was adopted.

SHRI JAGDAMBIKA PAL: Sir, I introduce** the Bill.

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* Published in the Gazette of India, Extraordinary, Part-II, Section-2, dated 12.07.2019.

** Introduced with the recommendation of the President

16.41 ½ hrs

(xxxvi) Backward Areas Development Bill, 2019*

[Translation]

SHRI JAGDAMBIKA PAL (DOMARIYAGANJ): Hon. Speaker Sir, I beg to move for leave to introduce a Bill to provide for the establishment of an autonomous Board for the overall development of economically backward areas of the country.

HON. SPEAKER: The question is:

"That the leave be granted to introduce a Bill to provide for the establishment of an autonomous Board for the overall development of economically backward areas of the country".

The motion was adopted.

SHRI JAGDAMBIKA PAL: Sir, I introduce** the Bill.

HON. SPEAKER: Item No. 56, 57 and 58

Shri Ravneet Singh – not present.

….(interruptions)

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* Published in the Gazette of India, Extraordinary, Part-II, Section-2, dated 12.07.2019.

** Introduced with the recommendation of the President

16.42 hrs

(xxxvii) Welfare of Homeless Persons Living Near Railway Tracks, Railway Yards and Railway Land Bill, 2019*

[Translation]

SHRI AJAY MISRA TENI (KHERI): Hon. Speaker Sir, I beg to move for leave to introduce a Bill to provide for welfare and rehabilitation measures to be undertaken by Central Government for the homeless citizens living near railway tracks, railway yards and railway land in metropolitan cities and other urban areas and for matter connected therewith or incidental thereto.

HON. SPEAKER: The question is:

"That leave be granted to introduce a Bill to provide for welfare and rehabilitation measures to be undertaken by Central Government for the homeless citizens living near railway tracks, railway yards and railway land in metropolitan cities and other urban areas and for matter connected therewith and incidental thereto."

The motion was adopted.

SHRI AJAY MISRA TENI: Hon. Speaker Sir, I introduce** the Bill.

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* Published in the Gazette of India, Extraordinary, Part-II, Section-2, dated 12.07.2019.

**Introduced with the recommendation of the president.

16.43 hrs

(xxxviii) National Board for Welfare of Flood Victims Bill, 2019*

[Translation]

SHRI AJAY MISRA TENI (KHERI): Hon. Speaker, Sir, I beg to move for leave to introduce a Bill to provide for the constitution of a national Board for welfare of flood victims by making provisions of providing permanent shelters to flood victims, suggest measures to control floods and for matters connected therewith and incidental thereto.

HON. SPEAKER: The question is:

"That leave be granted to introduce a Bill to provide for the constitution of a national Board for welfare of flood victims by making provisions of providing permanent shelters to flood victims, suggest measures to control foolds and for matters connected therewith and incidental thereto.''

The Motion was adopted.

SHRI AJAY MISRA TENI: Speaker Sir, I introduce** the Bill.

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* Published in the Gazette of India, Extraordinary, Part-II, Section-2, dated 12.07.2019.

**Introduced with the recommendation of the president.

16.43 ½ hrs

(xxxix) Compulsory Establishment of Government Women College Bill, 2019*

[Translation]

SHRI AJAY MISRA TENI (KHERI) : Hon. Speaker, Sir, I beg to move for leave to introduce a Bill to provide for compulsory establishment of Government Women College at block level and for matters connected therewith and incidental thereto.

HON.SPEAKER: The question is:

"That leave be granted to introduce a Bill to provide for compulsory establishment of Government Women College at block level and for matters connected therewith and incidental thereto".

The motion was adopted.

SHRI AJAY MISHRA TENI: Speaker Sir, I introduce** the Bill.

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* Published in the Gazette of India, Extraordinary, Part-II, Section-2, dated 12.07.2019.

**Introduced with the recommendation of the president.

16.44 hrs

(xl) Supreme Court and the High Courts (Use of Official Language and Other Provisions) Bill, 2019*

[Translation]

SHRI AJAY MISRA TENI (KHERI): Hon. Speaker, Sir, I beg to move for leave to introduce a Bill to provide for the use of official language in the proceedings of the Supreme Court and the High Courts and certain other provisions and for matters connected therewith and incidental thereto.

HON. SPEAKER: The question is:

"That leave be granted to introduce a Bill to provide for the use of official language in the proceedings of the Supreme Court and the High Courts and certain other provisions and for matters connected therewith and incidental thereto".

The motion was adopted.

SHRI AJAY MISRA TENI: Hon. Speaker, I introduce** the Bill.

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* Published in the Gazette of India, Extraordinary, Part-II, Section-2, dated 12.07.2019.

**Introduced with the recommendation of the president.

16.45 hrs

(xli) Small and Marginal Farmers (Welfare) Bill, 2019*

[Translation]

SHRI RAMAPATI RAM TRIPATHI (DEORIA): I beg to move for leave to introduce a bill to provide for certain welfare measures for the small and marginal farmers of the country and for the constitution of a welfare fund for their benefits and for matters connected therewith and incidental thereto.

HON. SPEAKER: The question is:

"That leave be granted lto introduce a bill to provide for certain welfare measures for the small and marginal farmers of the country and for the constitution of a welfare fund for their benefits and for matters connected therewith and incidental thereto".

The motion was adopted.

SHRI RAMAPATI RAM TRIPATHI: I introduce** the Bill.

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* Published in the Gazette of India, Extraordinary, Part-II, Section-2, dated 12.07.2019.

**Introduced with the recommendation of the president.

16.45 ½ hrs

(xlii) Payment of Subsistence Allowance to Farmers and Agricutural Labourers Bill, 2019*

[Translation]

SHRI RAMAPATI RAM TRIPATHI (DEORIA): I beg to move for leave to introduce a Bill to provide for the payment of subsistence allowance to farmers and agricultural labourers and their family members in order to provide social security to them and for matters connected therewith or incidental thereto.

HON. SPEAKER: The question is:

"That leave to be granted to introduce a Bill to provide for the payment of subsistence allowance to farmers and agricultural labourers and their family members in order to provide social security to them and for matters connected therewith or incidental thereto."

The motion was adopted.

SHRI RAMAPATI RAM TRIPATHI: I introduce** the Bill.

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* Published in the Gazette of India, Extraordinary, Part-II, Section-2, dated 12.07.2019.

**Introduced with the recommendation of the president.

16.46 hrs

(xliii) Constitution (Amendment) Bill, 2019*

(Amendment of article 83, etc.)

[English]

SHRI RAJIV PRATAP RUDY (SARAN): I beg to move for leave to introduce a Bill further to amend the Constitution of India.

[Translation]

HON. SPEAKER: The question is:

"That leave be granted to introduce a Bill further to amend the Constitution of India".

The motion was adopted.

[English]

RI RAJIV PRATAP RUDY: I introduce the Bill.

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* Published in the Gazette of India, Extraordinary, Part-II, Section-2, dated 12.07.2019.

16.46 ½ hrs

(xliv)Constitution (Amendment) Bill, 2019*

(*Substitution of new article for article 48A, etc.*)

SHRI RAJIV PRATAP RUDY (SARAN): I beg to move for leave to introduce a Bill further to amend the Constitution of India.

[Translation]

HON. SPEAKER: The question is:

"That leave be granted to introduce a Bill further to amend the Constitution of India.''

The motion was adopted.

[English]

SHRI RAJIV PRATAP RUDY: I introduce the Bill.

[Translation]

HON. SPEAKER: Shri Manoj Rajoria – not present.

Prof. Sougata Ray – not present.

Hon'ble Members, before I call Shri Janardan Singh Sigriwal to move a motion for consideration of his private Member's Bill, Compulsory Voting Bill, 2019, this House is required to allot time for discussion on this Bill. If all of you agree, the time may be extended for two hours.

* Published in the Gazette of India, Extraordinary, Part-II, Section-2, dated 12.07.2019.

THE MINISTER OF STATE IN THE MINISTRY OF PARLIAMENTARY AFFAIRS AND MINISTER OF STATE IN THE MINISRY OF HEAVY INDUSTRIES AND PUBLIC ENTERPRISES (SHRI ARJUN RAM MEGHWAL): Sir, the time may be extended for two hours.

SEVERAL HON. MEMBERS: Yes, Sir.

HON. SPEAKER: Item no- 77, Shri Janardan Singh Sigriwal, you please speak on Compulsory Voting Bill, 2019.

16.47 hrs

COMPULSORY VOTING BILL, 2019

SHRI JANARDAN SINGH SIGRIWAL (MAHARAJGANJ): I beg to move:

"That the Bill to provide for compulsory voting by the electorate in the country and for matters connected therewith or incidental thereto be taken into consideration".

Hon. Speaker, Sir, first of all I would like to express my gratitude to you for allowing me to participate in the discussion being held on an important Bill which has been piloted in the interest of country and which sends out a message to the world.

16.48 hrs.

(Shrimati Meeenakshi Lekhi *in the Chair*)

You have allowed me to participate in the discussion on Compulsory Voting Bill, 2019. It is well known that India is the largest democratic country in the world.

And a slew of electoral reforms have already been witnessed here to cater to the democratic needs of the country. However, a lot more reforms are yet to be made and Compulsory Voting happens to be one of them.

Hon. Chairperson, , the first election was conducted in the year 1952 in the country in which percentage of voting was 45.67%. Thereafter, the percentage of voting in the elections held in 1957 went up to 47.74%. Subsequently the voting percentage grew to 55.42% in the year 1962. In the election held in the year 1967, vote percentage increased to some extent and the vote percentage reached 61.33% in the election. Then, elections were conducted

during the years 1971, 1977, 1980, 1984, 1985, 1989, 1991, 1992, 1996, 1998 and 1999. The percentage of voting in the elections held in the year 2004 was 57.19%. In the elections held in the year 2009, 58.19% voters cast their votes. A slight increase was witnessed in the percentage of voting in the elections held in 2014 in which 66.44% voters cast their votes. When elections were conducted in 2019, the percentage of voting was increased to 67.6%. It means that even today 33% voters of the country are not exercising their franchise. It seems to me that it is a matter of concern when 33% of voters remained absent from casting their votes for such a government which is functioning for the welfare of the country. It requires serious consideration.

Madam, this Compulsory Voting Bill has been brought to ensure more than 90% of percentage of voting in the elections. Through you, I would like to submit that the population of the country was 133 crore 63 lakh 44 thousand 6 hundred and 31 at the time of elections held in 2014. At that time, the number of total registered voters was 83 crore 41 lakh one thousand four hundred eighty nine. Out of the above, only 55 crore 38 lakh one thousand eight hundred one voters cast their votes. Today, the number of voters in the country is about 90 crores. About 67% of voters out of the above are exercising their right to vote. In fact, it is a matter of concern for all of us which requires improvement.

Madam, the largest number of voters exercised their right to vote in the elections of 2019 since the introduction of election process in the country till date. The voter turnout has been the highest ever. Even today, 100% voters do not reach polling booths to cast their votes. We ought to act in tandem with the Government in order to strengthen the democracy. We do not exercise our constitutional right i.e. right to vote. Therefore, the government should lend a serious thought to make the voting compulsory through legislative means.

Madam, the issue of fundamental rights of the citizens is raised strongly in the country which is one of the essential and important factors to strengthen democracy. But as a citizen, we do not discharge our fundamental and civil duties. That is why, even today 33% people do not take part in the process to elect the Government. They do not discharge their fundamental duties. Seventeen Lok Sabha elections have been held right since first General Elections till date and the situation more or less has been the same in all the elections. Sometimes 40% people do not exercise their foranchise in the elections and sometimes 33% people do not cast their votes. It is a matter of concern. Therefore, awareness is required to be created among such voters through this Compulsory Voting Bill to cast their votes.

Madam, it is against the basic spirit of inclusive democracy and it also affects inclusive development adversely. That is why, there has been demand in this august House earlier also to make the voting compulsory. I am not flagging my point for the first time, the fact remains that it has been discussed earlier also. Today, I would like to submit that more than 50% Members of this House have been elected for the first time. They should express their views freely about enactment of law to make voting compulsory.

Madam, we consider it necessary to pay tax, extend cooperation in delivery of justice to attain and disseminate education, etc. We are supposed to do such type of work. But we do not discharge our duties as a citizen at the time of voting. It is definitely a matter of concern for us. Since some percentage of people do not discharge their duties on their own, we have to it resort to legal process to make it compulsory.

Madam, it is said that right to vote is similar to other rights but it is not so. I am of the view that right to vote is a different type of right. We can term it foundation of all rights because we elect the government by exercising this right. We cast our votes for the election of Government. Which type of system, Governance and country do we want in future? Which type of development should be there in the country and what should be pace of development? All these things can be ensured through voting. Therefore, we can term it foundation stone. You can have rights in democracy only. The rights of citizens do not have any recognition in feudalism, dictatorship system of Government.

17.00 hrs.

Contrary to it, democracy system of Government is accountable. That is the best democracy wherein 100% voters cast their votes i.e. each and every person is person takes in the formation of Government. If it is voluntary, it is best. If 80 or 90 per cent voters cast their votes, it is good but if only 50-60% registered voters cast their votes, it is not good. The voting by only 67% voters in the elections held in 2019 is not justified in any way. To my mind it is not acceptable in the interest of the country.

Madam, I would like to refer to the year 2009 when Gujarat became the only State of our country where Legislative Assembly passed laws in 2009 making the voting compulsory in the elections of local bodies. It is more coincidence that, our leader, popular leader of the country and the world, the present Prime Minister of the country was the Chief Minister of Gujarat at that time. The Government had passed it in 2009 under his leadership. However, the then Governor had returned it framing it violative of Article 21 of the Constitution. He was of the view that enactment of such law would impose voting on the people which will be against the spirit of the Constitution, whereas, the erstwhile Chief Minister, Hon'ble Shri Narender Modiji had termed it a step taken to strengthen the democracy through it. He is of the view that

political leaders should rise above the vote bank politics and corrupt practices espoused to lure voters should be checked.

Madam, this was the thinking of our hon'ble Prime Minister. Therefore, he had introduced this system in the elections at local bodies held in 2009. I would like to submit before you that today black money is being utilised on large scale to take the voters to polling booths, to attract them and to divide them on the basis of castes and religions. I am of the view that if we want to check the utilization of black money in the elections, we should consider seriously to make the voting compulsory.

Madam, it is not being discussed in our country only, rather, 32-33 countries of the world have already enacted law relating to compulsory voting. I would like to tell you about some countries. There are some small and big countries. Such law has already been enacted there. This law is being followed there. Today, the countries like Argentina, Australia, Belgium, Bolivia, Brazil, Chilli, Cyprus, Egypt, Fiji, France, Greece, Italy, Mexico, Philippines, Singapore, Swizerland, Thailand, Turkey have made voting compulsory and have enacted law in this regard. The system of compulsory voting is in place there. The people who do not follow this system, are fined or asked to render community service.

Madam, the persons aged 18 to 70 years are required to cast their votes compulsorily. The voters of more than 70 years old have been exempted from compulsory voting. The voters who are sick or live at the distance of more than 500 kms have also been exempted from it. Certain measures like arrangement of mobile polling booths have also been taken. Such arrangement of mobile polling booths has been made there. If any person is not able to reach polling

booths for any reason in such State, the polling booth is taken to such people. It shows the seriousness of their Government about voting.

As far as enforcement of this law in India is concerned, we will have to face some challenges. I agree with this view. Crores of voters in our country are victims of internal migration. We are connecting people through many technological interfaces like Aadhar and email. If arrangements are made for the people to cast their votes froms the places where they live, I think there would be no matter of distance. In this way, they would get the facility of casting their votes from places where they live. I think that we would be able to do so by enactment of law instead of punishing anyone.

Madam, sometimes the voters living in urban areas do not reach polling booths due to two reasons. They show unwillingness in this regard. Public holiday is declared by the Government on that day. The Government had provided many types of facilities at polling booths. This time model polling booths were set up. These would have been set up in your Lok Sabha constituency also. The facility for seating and drinking water was provided to voters on these polling stations. The Government also provided vehicles to aged voters and pregnant ladies so that they may go to polling booths and come back. We witnessed a radical reform in this election. We would like to thank especially to Election Commission for showing concern towards such voters.

In spite of providing all these facilities, if someone does not go to polling booths and gives time for other works, I consider it playing fast and loose with democracy. Public holiday is declared on the day of voting. Some people do not go to polling booths and waste their time in other works. Public holiday is declared to cast votes but some people give their time to other works on that it

day. I would like to say it misuse of time because it can be utilized properly only by going to polling booths on that day.

The elections are considered to be great festival (Mahaparva) of democracy. We come to home after covering distance of thousands of kilometers despite inconvenience caused to us during journey after availing leave at the time of any festival. Be it festival of Chhatt, Holi, Diwali or marriage ceremony in the house, we reach our house. But we do not reach at the time of this great festival which shows lack of seriousness in people towards this nation and elect better Government. I think we can celebrate this festival by enacting law providing for compulsory voting .

It can be seen in the metros that a large number of government employee opt for picnics on the day of voting instead of casting their votes, as it is declared as public holiday on account of elections. In view of all these things, the arguments given by Election Commission to make a provision for e-voting are right to a great extent. Such provision would enable every person to cast his vote while living anywhere. It would lead to qualitative improvement in the percentage of voting and thrust will also be given for enforcement of law relating to compulsory voting in an efficient and democratic manner.

The issue of making voting compulsory is being considered seriously in the other developed countries like America, Britain and other countries of world besides India. In addition, analysts are expressing their exact analysis about making voting compulsory.

Madam, we cannot compare our country with them on the basis of population but they have separate identity in the world. As the leadership of

India is leaving its imprint and impact on the world through his works and initiatives, I want that voting should be made compulsory legally so that it has an impact throughout the world. The voters across the world elections in their respective continues could go to their polling booths to cast their votes such a practice should be introduced in India and spread throughout the world.

Through you, I would like to make a request that such a system can help in eliminating many evils from the country like India. When the governments of other countries are enacting law to make provision for e-voting and making voting compulsory in their respective countries, I request you that we also should enact such a law in the country. Publicity is made through electronic and print media on large scale in order to ensure participation in the elections in the country, on which a lot of expenditure is incurred. The expenditure is increasing on all elections conducted so far right from the first elections conducted in 1952 in the country. Less expenditure was incurred in the elections held in 1952 but thereafter it kept on increasing. We could utilize this fund for other works. This fund is being spent on elections instead of spending it for the development of country. At that time, only Rs. 10 crores were spent but today thousands of crores rupees are being spent. Rather, more than thousand of cores rupees are being spent. There is different system for the States. I do not want to give figures of each year but expenditure has increased consistently and continuously. Less expenditure was incurred during the period from 1952 to 1962. The expenditure of Rs. 11, 61,000 was incurred in 1971 but it increased to Rs. 54 crores in 1980. An amount of Rs. 154 crores was spent in 1989 which increased to Rs.597 crores in 1996. The expenditure of Rs. 947 crores was incurred in 1999 which rose to Rs. 1483 crore in 2009. I mean to say that expenditure on elections is increasing. Different methods are being adopted by the Government for publicity. The slogans are written on the walls of schools, the rallies are organized to create awareness with, the help of administrative

officers but even then the percentage of voting did not increase. Therefore, I am requesting this House to make voting compulsory legally so that we may go to our respective booths to cast our votes. The Government also provides security at the polling booths. If all these things are taken into consideration, the Government should make arrangements to ensure their safety. A list of names of those voters should be prepared who did not cast their votes. I wish to submit that such a list should be published district- wise. It may contain the list of the names of one or two lakh voters and may required to publish part-wise but it will give a message that despite being the voter, so and so did not participate in this great festival of democracy.

Besides, the Government have made special arrangements for senior citizens. We will have to find out the number of voters who are senior citizens, pregnant ladies and physically handicapped at each polling booth who find it difficult to go to polling booths to cast their votes. We have to see how to take them to polling booths. The Government will have to bear some expenditure in this regard but thousands of crores of rupees being spent on publicity will be saved and it will facilitate the above voters to cast their votes. Two things will be ensured with the help of this expenditure. Firstly awareness will be created and secondly, the people will feel that they have participated in formation of the Government.

Today, we are running the Government properly. Each and every citizen of the country is enjoying the benefit of development. But, even today 33% people are still unaware. They do not feel that they have contributed to the formation of the Government. I do not ask you to cast your votes in someone's favour. The Election Commission a made providion of NOTA in the year 2013. The people are voting NOTA through this provision. You can go in any Lok Sabha constituency and see that more than 10,000-20000 people have pressed the button of NOTA.

HON. CHAIRPERSON: Sigriwal ji you have spoken earlier also, please be short, because other Members are sitting here. It has been discussed earlier.

SHRI JANARDAN SINGH SIGRIWAL: Hon. Chairperson, I have said that laws are passed through discussion in the House.

HON. CHAIRPERSON: Sigriwalji, the participation of rest of the Members should be ensured. Time will be given to you again for speaking.

SHRI JANARDAN SINGH SIGRIWAL: This is a great festival. We happen to do something by making a law but this Bill requires serious consideration.

I am fortunate that I have got an opportunity to bring the Private Member's Bill which has also been listed for discussion. It might be my fortune. All of us try to bring the Bills but they are not listed for discussion but mine has been listed for discussion.

I. through you, would like to tell the hon'ble Members that they should rise above the party politics and talk about proper system. It is for the country. It is not meant for only internal matters. No party or caste should come in the way. We have to ensure as to how to rise above all these things and make the people aware of compulsory voting. Therefore, I request repeatedly to enact a law making voting compulsory.

Through you, I would like to make an appeal and request the voters of the country from here that there should be no legal binding on them but they should be made aware that they are supposed to go to polling booths to cast their votes. It is essential. It is necessary to hold discussion on this Bill in detail.

Through you, I would like to make a request to the Government to enact a law making the voting compulsory. I would like to submit again. Thank you.

SHRI AJAY MISRA TENI (KHERI): Thank you, Hon. Chairperson, Shri Janaradan Singh Sigriwal has introduced Compulsory Voting Bill, 2019 and it is being discussed today. I think that our country is ancient and prosperous from cultural and educational point of view. There has been a spirit of democracy in our country since independence in 1947. Therefore, we chose the democratic system of governance after independence. Every single citizen of this country who has the capacity to think and decide has right to vote so as to ensure participation of all people in the democracy. That's why, we have fixed a minimum age of voting. All these people have to elect such Government or public representatives by exercising their right to vote in which they repose faith. But the basic feature of democracy is self- motivation. I can understand that laws are enacted to deal with crimes or maintain law and order but I think that there is no need to enact law on whome to vote, whom not to vote or cast one's vote or not. The issue to make voting compulsory.....*(Interruptions)*. I am expressing my views. Our country has adopted such a democratic system that envisages people will suo-moto start casting their votes with self-motivation. Shri Janardanji has just now said in his speech that the percentage of voting is increasing. The highest number of people cast their votes in the elections conducted recently. The reason behind it is that people are understanding their responsibilities from the educational and social point of view. The people have got the alternative as political party, political leaders or public representative which inspired them to go to polling booths. As he stated just now that population of this country is 125 crores and there are many classes. There are many places in our country where there is no means of trains or bus to go up to 20 km distance. Lot of people are backward from educational and social point of view. We often see that influential people try to influence the voters with money or other methods in the local elections, be it the elections of Pradhan or delegates. In such a state of affairs, making the voting compulsory

will lead to anarchy on one hand, voters will be influenced with the money in the elections of Gram Pradhan or the other. The provision of making the voting compulsory will increase this competition and the candidates will have to secure more than 50% vote of the total votes. I think voting is a healthy practice. The Constitution and law of our country have given right to vote without any discrimination to every person, be he poor or rich, literate or illiterate so that they can understand their responsibilities and make their contribution to take the country to the path of development. He has given many examples and taken the name of many countries but when the issue of democracy is discussed in the entire world, ours is always termed as healthy democracy.

It is believed in the entire world that ours is largest democratic country in the world. When we see in our country, one speaks something and the other speaks something else and sometimes without any base. Hence, I think that it is not possible to make voting compulsory in such a situation. As we will make progress from the educational and social point of view…….*(Interruptions)* As we progress, the interest of the people to cast their votes will increase. When the people would feel their responsibilities, they will definitely go to polling booths to cast their votes. It is my opinion. As we learnt it just now that once our hon'ble Prime Minister tried to make it compulsory in Gujarat but it was negated by the then Governor due to constitutional compulsion. We should understand that it is not possible without bringing an amendment in the Constitution. Secondly, when there is a provision in the Constitution for this, it definitely has some meaning. The law should not be enacted to make the voting compulsory; rather it would be better if people cast their votes

voluntarily. The issue of 'One Nation, One Election' is being widely discussed in the country. When the elections would have been conducted for the first time in the country after Independence, then surely elections for all State Governments would also have been conducted simultaneously. But the State Governments continued to fall due to withdrawal of support by the parties. At times, Government is formed by two parties in coalition. In this backdrop a big challenge is coming up. It is a good idea to conduct elections in the entire country simultaneously. It will yield good results, and at the same time it will enable us to save the expenditure, money and resources and check the misuse of government machinery. But in spite of all these things, some challenges are once being faced. One of them is whether the Government elected once will remain in office for five years? At present, we are witnessing in Karnataka, a political party having only 37 MLAS got the opportunity to form the Government in Karnataka and that political party not only formed the Government but is running the Governement also for the last one year. When some MLAs of that Government withdrew their support, even then the Government is not ready to go. It cannot be ruled out that we will have to face such situations in the country time and again. In such state of affairs, we are required to form such Government or bring such constitutional amendments which inspire us to go for 'One Nation, One Election'. We should discuss this issue also. I think it is right time to think as to what type of improvements, we can bring about in our country. Once elections are over, the elected Government is generally given the opportunity to work for full five years, but in

the above circumstances also, that Government should be given opportunity to work for five years. If any Government is removed due to any reasons, Presidential Rule should be imposed there and elections should be conducted there only after 5 years and it is possible only through constitutional amendment. Secondly, if anyone contests the elections on a party symbol, after winning the elections, if that person, elected MLA or MP is found to be involved in anti- party activities, he is expelled from the party and his membership of Lok Sabha or Legislative Assembly is terminated. Recently, Congress and JDS have formed the coalition Government. It happens many times that a party withdraws support from the Government and gives support to another party which also promotes horse-trading.

Let us make a provision that once an alliance is formed, it will not split within a period of 5 years. If the Government falls, then second largest party should be given an opportunity to form the Government but elections should not be conducted before 5 years. Simultaneous elections were conducted in 1952. If we are required to conduct elections simultaneously, we will have to make some amendments. Hon'ble Prime Minister has given a good idea. It will save resources of our country and the country will also progress. The sense of dedication will be developed in people towards healthy democracy. Many times, we came to know, when we go to our constituency and just now, hon'ble Member was speaking about 'NOTA'. Shri Rajiv Pratap Rudy ji has just now stated that the number of 'NOTA' votes in Gopalganj had crossed 45 thousand.

Why does it happen? It happens only in the circumstances when people feel that there is no one deserving to be elected among them. It is also imperative for us to inspire people to cast their votes that such persons should join politics who are respectable and acceptable in the society and in whom people repose their faith that the person being elected by them will live up to their expectations. Their votes will not go waste and they will get the value of their votes. Then it will definitely lead to increase in the percentage of votes. Besides, I would like to say that all such people*.....(Interruptions).* I will submit my main points and conclude within two minutes.

Hon. Chairperson, the population of our country is 130 crores and there are 30 States. The elections for Central Government are conducted. The way elections are conducted in our country, elections are held for the Central Government, elections are held for three-tier Panchayats, Gram Sabha, Block Panchayat, Zila Panchayat and Cooperatives. We can say that the election process is a continuous process here. While elections have great importance in every person's life, every person's own vote also has great importance. In such a situation, we must definitely talk about these two topics. You have talked about compulsory voting. I believe that voting should be made so simple that people get motivated to go to the polling place on their own, but no mandatory law should be made for this.

Secondly, I want to say that a provision should be made to hold elections in our country only once in five years. In a three-tier Panchayat, the

way Block Panchayat is elected, Zila Panchayat President is elected and delegates are elected, we see that as soon as the government changes in the state, they hijack the delegates and immediately bring a no-confidence motion against it and try to remove it. The President is elected from the party which is in power in the state. There is also a need to reform that once the elections are held in the three-tier Panchayat, no-confidence motion should not be brought in between the tenure for which the elections are held.

The third and most important thing is that our Prime Minister has said that all the elections in our country should be held simultaneously and once in five years, this will definitely be a huge step for our country and will take the country forward. As we are moving towards the 'New India' concept, it will also make a huge contribution in that. I want to tell the government through you that for this we should amend the Constitution. Just as our candidates of political parties are different, in the same way, such a code of conduct should be made for the political parties, due to which they should not bring a no-confidence motion in five years, the government should not be changed and the government that is elected should be given a chance to work for five years. In unprecedented situations, the governments should be run through President's or Governor's rule, but elections should be held only once in five years. I want to tell you that it is not necessary to bring a law for compulsory voting, we should spread the awareness among the people of the country educationally and socially. Awareness campaigns have increased. Good people should

come into politics and efforts should be made so that we can vote easily. Thank you.

HON. CHAIRPERSON: Nishikant Dubey ji, you have 15 minutes to speak.

DR. NISHIKANT DUBEY (GODDA): Hon. Chairperson, there is a verse from Taittiriya Upanishad.

Ajasya grahnato janamanirihasya hatadvasah

Svapto jagarukasyo yatarthan veda kastah.

For the one who takes birth despite not being born and remains unaware despite knowing everything, there is no need for Vedas and Puranas for him. It is mandatory to vote in the election. When you vote in elections, you choose the right public representative for you. The people know that they convey their views through their public representatives at the different levels such as local level, Panchayat, Zila Parishad, Municipal Corporation, Municipality, Legislative Assembly or Lok Sabha, and all these public representatives work or contribute in the constituencies from wherever they are elected as Members and solve the problems being faced by the public. The poor know as well as the rich know this. Despite this, the people do not go to vote or less number of people go to vote. For that, our senior Member Janardan Singh Sigriwal Saheb has introduced this Bill in the Parliament for the second time. He had also brought it in the 16th Lok Sabha. There was a very long discussion on this also. In the 17th Lok Sabha, it was his coincidence and

fortune that the Private Members Bill started with his Bill. I have heard the discussion on both occasions. Sigriwal ji wants that there should be compulsory voting and Ajay ji was saying that there should not be compulsory voting, so I see truth in both the things.

Hon. Chairperson, since you are a good lawyer, I think it would be better if the decision is taken by the Chair or the House. All of us as public representatives contest elections. Shri P.P. Chaudhary Saheb is sitting here, and he is a senior lawyer. I think that among all the honorable Members sitting in Lok Sabha at present, two-three Members which includes Rudy Saheb, Mahtab Saheb and Prahlad Singh Patel Saheb are very senior. The coincidence is such that these people have been elected to Parliament six-seven times. Mahtab Saheb is the best hon. Member of Parliament. I am telling you how to ensure compulsory voting. There are 28 countries in the world where there is compulsory voting and Australia is the only example of compulsory voting. You can say that there is compulsory voting in Australia. Compulsory voting was implemented in Australia after the year 1917-18, which is still going on. The number of problems it has cannot be described. Apart from this, whichever big country tried to implement it, I want to tell that it faced a lot of resentment, issues and people faced problems. In a country like Italy, it was abolished in the year 1993 that there would be no compulsory voting. Similarly, Netherlands abolished it in the year 1967. When those countries abolished it, what was the reason behind it and what problem are we facing? NOTA has become the biggest problem of this country. You send the people to

vote and after that an atmosphere is created that we should not vote. This is the order of the Supreme Court. The Supreme Court decided this in an order. We have always been reading that this Parliament has the right to make laws, but who is making the laws, and kinds of laws being enacted has nothing to do with the elections.

SHRI RAJIV PRATAP RUDY (SARAN): I had also raised that issue once and I had said as to who has the right to enact laws. This topic came up that day also. You are one of the well-known lawyers of the country and it is a matter of good fortune for us that you are currently in the Chair. We would definitely like clarification regarding the right to make laws in the country, like hon. MP Nishikant ji has raised the issue that in the Constitution, who has the right to make laws and for how long will the Parliament have the exclusive right to make laws in this country? If there is regulation on this then a big decision can be taken in the history of the country.

HON. CHAIRPERSON: We will take up that topic, now let Nishikant ji finish his speech.

DR. NISHIKANT DUBEY: You must understand that while giving the judgment on NOTA, the then Chief Justice Shri Sathasvam said that *[English] "*A voter may refrain from voting at an election for several reasons including the reason that he does not consider any of the candidates in the field worthy of his vote. One of the ways of such expression may be to abstain from voting, which is

not an ideal option for a conscientious and responsible citizen. Thus, the only way by which it can ve made effectual is by providing a button NOTA in the EVM." *[Translation]* After this, he did not stop at this only. *[English]* Besides, the Supreme Court also highlighted the need for higher voters' participation in India. I quoter "eventually, voters' participation explains the strength of the democracy lesser voters' participation is the rejection of commitments democracy, slowly but definitely, whereas, larger participation is better for democracy. The voters' participation in the election is indeed the participation in the democracy itself. Non-participation causes frustration and disinterest which is not a healthy sign of a growing democracy like India". *[Translation]* The Supreme Court is contradicting its own judgement and we as Members of Parliament are not so prudent to understand it. We think that the Supreme Court has given the judgment or the Election Commission has given the option to voters. They say that if there is non-participation by voters, then it is frustration which is not good for healthy democracy but same is the case with 'NOTA' which is also a kind of non-participation.

[English]

HON. CHAIRPERSON: Exactly.

[Translation]

DR. NISHIKANT DUBEY: This Parliament should hold discussion on two subjects. This is very important but I believe that in this democratic country you cannot bring such laws and the way the 2009 bill was brought in Gujarat. Our

Prime Minister thinks a lot about this, and he came up with a good Bill. But reagrding the decision that came, he said that the Governor stopped it, but the Bill was passed again on November 5, 2014, but in the year 2015, the High Court struck it down and after that in another decision in the Supreme Court, it was said that we cannot do inhuman work because someone said to cut off someone's electricity, stop the supply of water, and someone said to stop their ration.

SHRI BHARTRUHARI MAHTAB (CUTTACK): I want to know one thing.

[English]

HON. CHAIRPERSON: Mahtab ji, we are running short of time but you can just make one intervention.

SHRI BHARTRUHARI MAHTAB (CUTTACK): I just want to ask a question, which, I think, our learned Member can explain. In 1951, when the Representation of People’s Act was being debated in this House, at that time, an amendment was moved by an hon. Member and the then, Law Minister Dr. Ambedkar said, “Voting is a right and by converting it into compulsory voting, you are making it a duty”. So, there is a difference between right and duty. In the past, the Chief Minister of Gujarat was trying to make it a duty for municipal elections. Unless you make a change in the Constitution that this is not a right alone but it is also a duty, you cannot make it compulsory. It is a fundamental right. *[Translation]* If it is converted into a duty, the court's interpretation will be

different. Unless this becomes a duty, there will be no change in the Constitution, I want to know your opinion on it ?

DR. NISHIKANT DUBEY: We learn a lot from Mahtab Sahab.

I would like to tell you that a debate on it has already taken place before 1951 in the Constituent Assembly. Out of 299 members in the Constituent Assembly, only one Member, Shri Ananth Shyanam Iyyangar was in favour of compulsory voting. In the year 1949, whole of the Constituent Assembly rejected it by 299 versus 1. They said that it was not possible and it should not be done for the sake of democracy. Thereafter in 1951, when this act was being formulated, then Dr. Ambedkar stressed on the same points. I personally think that it is more important for this Parliament that the Bill brought by Shri Rajiv Pratap Rudy ji and for which our Hon. Prime Minister, Shri Narendra Modi is so keen and has convened all party meeting, may be discussed upon. He wants all the parties to agree on holding all the elections simultaneously. This is the most important issue.

If you notice the percentage of votes in the elections of heads of Panchayats, Municipality and Municipal Corporations, it is 80-85 per cent of the voters of those areas. You were citing the example of Australia. The voting percentage is 90 there. This voting percentage has reached to only 90 per cent despite the provision of compulsory voting in Australia. It is not the case that per cent voting is taking place in Australia.

As you were saying, if it is linked with Aadhar, I would like to say that there is a certain way to cast vote by going to the polling station because our

society is feudal society and Sigriwal Sir and I also come from the same state and background.

You know that before the introduction of EVM and before any such restrictions, the downtrodden, women, oppressed and deprived people were not allowed to go to the polling booths. The people who are talking about ballot and advocating that voting should be done through ballot, it is very important for them beacuse the incidents of booth capturing may start again. We have seen the example of Bihar. During the period from 1990 to 2005, imagine if Shri T.N. Seshan and Shri Rao were not been there, the Government in Bihar would never have changed. On the issue of implementing e-ballot, the problem with it will be that let us assume case where someone else might be on possession of the phone on which OTP would be sent for confirmation of the ballot.

HON. CHAIRPERSON: Nishikant ji, we will discuss this, address the issue after taking into the account NRIs etc. who live abroad.

DR. NISHIKANT DUBEY: The Government is serious about giving voting rights to NRIs. I think it is a good thing.

HON. CHAIRPERSON: Is E-ballot possible?

DR. NISHIKANT DUBEY: I am saying that the army personnel and those who are deputed for election duty like presiding officer etc and staff, we have already given them right to vote. They are already casting their votes.

Assuming that the polling is to be held through the ballot and as we are allowing army personnel posted outside their state and in the similar way, we will send ballots to the NRI voters before hand.

I would like to say that this method cannot be adopted for e-platform because when OTP is received, nobody knows the identity of phone holder and to whom it has been sent or if phone is in possession of some other person. So, there is no other alternative to polling booth process.

I would like to say that this method cannot be adopted for e-platform because when otp is received, nobody knows the identity of phone holder and to whom the otp has been sent or if phone is in possession of some other person. So, there is no other alternative to polling booth process.

SHRI P.P. CHAUDHARY: A proposal for extending the E-voting system for NRIs is under consideration. A committee has been constituted keeping in view its seriousness. The Ministry of Law is considering over how to include them so that e-ballot papers may be sent to them and enable them to return postal ballots.

DR. NISHIKANT DUBEY: I have only suggested that the manner in which ballot papers are sent to the Army personnel, similarily these may also be sent to NRIs. But I was asking some other questions and before this compulsory voting, I would also like to request Shri Sigriwal that after he concludes his speech, there should be a comprehensive debate on 'NOTA' in the Parliament.

The second subject on which the discussion should be started and even the Hon. Prime Minister is in the favour of the matter is that if all the elections are conducted simultaneously, there will a large number of candidates from Panchayats, mohallah etc., and they will bring their voters to the booths personally. If they are able to bring them to the booths, the percentage of voting may increase to 80 per cent which we want. We have registered 67 per cent voting, and for this I would like to compliment the workers of my party, the Bhartiya Janta Party. All the workers with voter slips in their hands went to the homes of voters and they made them come out of their homes to cast their votes. I would also like to thank Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh.

I would like to thank Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh that Akhil Bhartiya Vidhyarthi Parishad has decided not to support any political party in elections through voter awareness campaigns but have tried to encourage people to cast their votes in large numbers and the work of Bhartiya Janta Party in the regard is quite significant. It has made a person 'Panna Pramukh' and the work of 'Panna Pramukh' is to encourage all the voters enlisted in the page entrusted to him, to go to booths for voting. I tell you that there is no legal aspect of it. This question needs to be discussed among political parties and we all Parliamentarians. I would like to tell you that our party and some other parties are in the favour of women reservation. But a number of parties oppose women reservation also. A way out of that may be that we may provide 33 per cent, 35 per cent or 40 per cent reservation to women in our party tickets. Mahtab ji's party Biju Janata Dal has initiated this practice. The results of the

elections for 17th Lok Sabha also show that how actively the women Members elected on the tickets of Biju Janta Dal are participating in the discussion and raising the issues or have we brought them only as artificial women representatives? It is a matter to look into.

I congratulate their Chief Minister and their party but when the tenure of 17th Lok Sabha ends, an assessment will be made on it. The question is that... *(Interruptions)*

HON. CHAIRPERSON: I have not come on the basis of reservation. I have come here after defeating two men. It's okay. It is a joke.

DR. NISHIKANT DUBEY: I will conclude as Shri Jagdambika Pal ji has to speak. Fortunately,the Minister of Parliamentary Affairs, Shri Pralhad Joshi is also present here, the Chairperson is here and entire House is also present here. I want to say that it should certainly be discussed once. The discussion should be on the respective roles of the Supreme Court and the Parliament. This should be defined in detail. Article 368 of the Constitution says that the Parliament is supreme but what we could see with regard in NJAC Bill and NOTA that it is nothing but a distortion of the democracy. If the Parliament is not going to discuss NOTA, and if this legislation is not amended, then I must say that we are heading towards anarchy. We are trying to promote such elements who do not believe in democracy. For example if an individual does not like some other person but here party, as well as ideology and manifesto of party fight the election. That person is only a means. We elect the Prime

Minister, and Ministers. Such elements are gradually increasing after the introduction of NOTA and what will happen to the democracy if they increase steadily? This is only because of this democracy that a *chaiwala* is the Prime Minister of this country. This is because of this democracy that a person who wears *chappal* is an M. P. and even minister here. If you take a glance at Pratap Sarangi's journey, then you understand that a person who rides a cycle may also become a Minister. This democracy has given IAS, IPS to the country. This reservation has carried the country forward and abolished the caste system. If there is an atmosphere against democracy in the country which is growing after the Supreme Court's judgement, then it is really matter of discussion in this House. Therefore, I request Shri Janardan Sigriwal Ji and this House and all the Members to ponder over what Dr. B.R. Ambedkar and Shri Tarkunde said. A committee was constitutes under Mr. Tarkunde Committee was constituted. I will quote the speech of Shri Tarkunde and conclude my speech. Justice Tarkunde was a learned and honest person. He said:

[English]

> "We have seriously considered the desirability of making it compulsory for voters to cast their votes in these elections. It appears to us that compulsory voting may be resented by the voters and may on balance prove counter-productive. It is desirable that compliance with the duty to cast one's vote should

be brought about by persuasion and political education rather than compulsion. Moreover, the implementation of a law of compulsory voting is likely to be very difficult and may lead to abuse."

[Translation]

He made such an important recommendation. We agree with Tarkunde Ji' point. I request Shri Janardan Singh Sigriwal, the Hon. Minister and all the Members to discuss NOTA, Judgement of the Supreme Court, NJAC. It should also be discussed that we, the Members of Parliament who enact laws in the Parliament are Supreme or not. It we discuss these points, then I think discussion will be fruitful and we will be able to enact good legislation in every respect. With these words, I conclude. Jai Hind, Jai Bharat.

SHRI BHARTRUHARI MAHTAB: Madam, my question is related to Point of Order. *[English]* which is the nodal Ministry dealing with this Bill?

HON. CHAIRPERSON: The Ministry of Law and Justice. The hon. Minister is here and the noting is also being taken care of.

[Translation]

SHRI BHARTRUHARI MAHTAB: Sir, there is collective responsibility and this is Private Member's Bill [ENGLISH] there should be someone.

HON. CHAIRPERSON: Sir, I can show you the authorization letter of Shri Ravi Shankar Prasad and he has authorised the Hon. Minister. He is in the Rajya Sabha right now.

SHRI BHARTRUHARI MAHTAB: Yes, but who is there?

HON. CHAIRPERSON: The Minister of Parliamentary Affairs is there.

[Translation]

SHRI JAGDAMBIKA PAL (DOMRIAGANJ): Hon. Chairperson Madam, I am thankful to you that you have given me an opportunity to speak on this important issue. You have seen that while Nishikant Ji was speaking, Mahtab Ji could not stop himself from seeking some clarification. Rudy Ji and other Members have spoken also. It indicates that the House should pass the legislation moved by Shri Janardan Singh Sigriwal for compulsory voting by all the voters. I think that all of us support this and I also rise to support this. I think that some Hon. Members have said in their speech that how it can be practically possible. This House is concerned about those also who have gone out of the country due to certain reasons and circumstances or who come under the category of NRIs, should also be given right to vote. It is evident by this that it is the ardent desire of our elected Government along with the citizens and voters that everyone should vote in the country and if the original residents of this country are there in other countries and they are NRI due to certain reasons should be given right to vote also. This proves that we want compulsory voting so that there should be maximum participation in elections.

The matter of rights and duties aws also discussed. It is true that if you talk about right to vote, this right has been given by the Constitution of India. *[English]* Right to vote is provided by the Constitution of India and by the Representation of Peoples Act, 1951 subject to certain disqualifications.

[Translation] Except one should not be convicted and bankrupt and other such provisions made, every citizen of the country has been given the right to cast vote by the Constitution and the Representation of the People Act, 1951. Madam, you are a learned person. You are a lawyer in the Supreme Court and in the High Court. Article 326 guarantees the right to vote to every citizen above the age of 18 years. Article 326 of our Constitution guarantees that every young person above the age of 18 years, has right to vote. Section 62 of the Representation of the People Act states that every person who is in the electoral roll of the Constituency will be entitled to vote. Even a single person should not be deprived of right to vote, so much safeguard has been provided in the Constitution of India whether it is Article 326 or the section 62 of the Representation of Peoples Act, 1951. Therefore, our Constitution and Representation of the Peoples Act, 1951 have given rights to every citizen of India to participate in the elected Government and his rights may be protected. How much rights are we providing them through compulsory voting. We were talking about NOTA. Today one decision has been taken on NOTA and there must be a discussion on this issue.

Today, NOTA is available for voting in some of the countries whether these are France, Belgium, Brazil, Greece or Chile, and there is compulsory voting system in there countries. It would be an irony that due to the provision of NOTA, a situation may arise in future that it may become the reason for victory or defeat. ...*(Interruptions)*

HON. CHAIRPERSON: Hon. Members, does the House agree that the House may be adjourned now? Hon. Jagdambika Pal Ji will continue his speech next time.

SOME HON. MEMBERS: Yes.

HON. CHAIRPERSON: The House is adjourned to meet again on 11' O clock on Monday, 15th July, 2019.

18.00 hrs

The Lok Sabha then adjourned till Eleven of the Clock

on 15th July, 2019/ 24 Ashadha, 1941 (saka)

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